Cars and Calories

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Not Rated

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Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Melog (She-Ra)

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Model Adora, Semi-Famous Adora, Semi-Famous Best Friends Squad, Magicat Catra (She-Ra), melog is a cat, Not sure if he is regular, or magical, Cars, first meets, Alternate Universe, no powers, Glimmer is a Good Friend (She-Ra), Bow Is a Good Friend (She-Ra), Adora is a Dork (She-Ra), Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), catradora

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Cars and Calories

by masternoveller

Summary

Adora is not looking for love.
She's not.

And then...
Adora meets Catra, a waiter at one of the party events she's attending.
They make a connection in a surprising way.

Melog comes along for the ride.
Bow and Glimmer are around too for emotional support.

Notes

As per usual, tags will prob not get updated.
Maybe I'll add characters in the tags when they come into the story.
Chapter count is fluid - I'm starting with 5.

Enjoy!

All kudos is appreciated as are comments.

See the end of the work for more notes

Chapter 1: On Purpose

Adora.

The model.

Rich.

The face of the biggest car brand in the world.

And super alone.

Everybody wants something from her.

Fame.

Money.

…sex.

It’s not that she hasn’t been with anyone, well, maybe just one.

One time.

And it wasn’t good.

And she’s glad that whoever the other woman was didn’t even know who she was.

Especially with how horrible it was.

So, she’s sworn off love or lust for that matter.

The idea of being with anyone else at all makes her shiver with fear.

“Adora! Over here!” Bow calls out from the open bar, waving his arms in the air.

“Hey guys.” Adora walks over to her friends, Bow and Glimmer, the party around them buzzing with lots of people, the sound of chatter surrounding them as she smooths down her dress, “Lots of people tonight.”

“Yeah. It’s crazy!” Glimmer agrees as her lavender dress shines in the lights, “Can you believe Bow managed to get in wearing a crop top tux?! How crazy?!”

“I know, right?! Guess I’ve really made it if I can walk in like this.” Bow grins widely as he looks at himself in one of the reflective surfaces around the party, “Oh, there’s an after party later at that new nightclub down the street. Are you going to come with us?”

“I don’t know, Bow.” Adora replies shyly, “I mean, we’re already at a party and you’re already thinking about an after party?”

Adora laughs out at the thought herself, Glimmer wrapping her arms around both her friends, “Well, we just need to get through this party first before we can really go have some fun.”

Still unsure about whether she wants to go out again after, Adora bites her bottom lip, “Yeah, we’ll get through this one first and then maybe I’ll come to the after party.”

“Yes! That’s practically a yes!” Glimmer cheers as Bow sends her a reassuring look, “It’ll be so fun! I heard they’ve got drag shows lined up!”

“You’re not going to be part of the show, are you?” Adora teases.

“Girl, I’m too pretty to fake.” Glimmer does her best pose, “And I don’t think it’s like an open mike night sort of thing.”

Adora laughs as Bow nods, the latter says, “I don’t have my make up kit tonight anyway. And you know how specific I am about what products I use.”

“Of course, babe!” Glimmer says pressing a kiss on his cheek, “Besides, no free shows, or management will have a field day.”

Bow laughs this time, “Right. Can’t keep anything quiet anymore, can we?”

“Not with phones and cameras everywhere!” Glimmer groans out.

“Come on, guys.” Adora rolls her eyes at her friends, “We wouldn’t be where we are now without the phones and cameras though, would we?”

Glimmer nods, “It’s crazy that they took all three of us!”

“I know!” Bow agrees with a smile, “Guess they just really love our content.”

“I think they really loved Adora.” Glimmer corrects.

“What?” Adora shrugs, “If they wanted me, they’d need all of us to launch their product.”

“I can’t believe that was two whole years ago when we were spruiking a fruit cup company!” Bow recalls, “And now we’ve all got our own gigs!”

“I still can’t believe you the face of the Swift W series cars!” Glimmer says proudly, “Those are the coolest cars ever! And you’re their model for the next two years!”

“I know!” Adora preens, “Guess that driving stunt that we pulled really got their attention.”

“You mean, your lack of driving skills?” Glimmer teases and Adora pouts, “How’s the driving going anyway?”

Looking at Glimmer sheepishly, Adora shyly admits, “I’ve been too scared to take my car out. Like, what if I scratch it or worse! What if I accidentally crash it?”

“I can teach you to drive.” A low and harsh voice says from behind the trio, they all turn around to see a large woman with short blue hair in a suit that shows off her bulging muscles, the woman

smirks at the trio staring at her, "I overheard your conversation. I hope I'm not overstepping in offering my driving expertise, miss."

Adora just stares at the newcomer, mouth open and speechless apart from a silent, "Wow…"

Glimmer rolls her eyes before stepping forward, "Hello. I'm Glimmer, this is Bow."

Bow waves in greeting.

"And this is Adora." Glimmer nudges Adora and the blonde snaps out of it.

"Oh, right. Yes. Me. I'm Adora." She smiles cheerily, even throwing in a wave before Glimmer slaps her arm down and she winces.

"And you are?" Glimmer asks.

"Toni." The larger woman extends her hand out to Adora and then raises an eyebrow at the blonde, Adora gingerly takes the hand and then stumbles forward when Toni tugs on her hand and presses her lips onto the back of it, "It's very nice to meet you, Adora."

Adora's eyes widen as she just awkwardly laughs, "And, yeah. You too."

Toni releases Adora's hand and it flops back down against the blonde's thigh, "So, are you enjoying this party?"

"It's alright." Adora replies as Toni gets her one on one, a step or two away from her friends, "Um, what about you?"

"Not really my scene to be honest." The larger woman replies cooly, "But now that I've met you, it seems to have gotten a whole lot better."

Adora smiles back, a blush forming on her face, "So, are you a model too?"

“Stars, no.” Toni replies like it’s an insult to even think she was, “I’m an actor. Mostly action movies. You may have seen me in a couple of movies.”

“Oh, I can’t say that I have…” Adora admits shyly, “I’m not really into action movies.”

That seems to dampen Toni’s smirk slightly but she brushes it off quickly, “So, Adora. I’ve seen you in quite a few magazines and billboards. Love the new car ad. Very… sexy.”

Adora blushes again, “Thank you.”

“I think I preferred the one you did for the R series.” Toni adds with a purr and Adora blushes more at recalling that ad being quite revealing, “You should do more of those ones. Show off your… assets.”

Adora shuffles a little uncomfortably as Toni simply laughs, her eyes flit over to her friends, but they’ve seemed to have wandered off somewhere else and then she feels a warm hand on her waist, her head snaps back to Toni who’s got a cocky look on her face now.

Gently peeling the unwanted hand off her body, Adora shoves it back into Toni chest, “No. No, thanks.”

“What’s the matter, baby?” Toni tries a different tact to cover up the almost scene, “I thought you liked me. We can get out of here and go back to my place and I can show you a good time. Better than this party. A party just for us, baby.”

“No, thanks.” Adora repeats a little more sternly as she takes a step back, “I, uh, better get back to my friends.”

Toni reaches out again, this time wrapping her fingers around Adora’s wrist and grits out a little angrily, “That wasn’t a request, sweetheart.”

SLAP!

“Let go of me!” Adora slaps Toni hard against the cheek, the sound loud enough to make a few heads turn to see what happened and Adora wrenches her arm out of Toni’s grasp, “Leave me alone, please.”

Toni puts a hand on her cheek, the slap wasn’t so much as hard, just more of a surprise as she quickly regains her composure, a glare fixated at Adora as as the people around them watch on, trying to play it off, Toni huffs out a laugh, “No need to get all huffy, babe. If you’re not in the mood, just say so.”

Adora can’t believe the audacity and as she’s about to speak, a waiter comes through and walks right into Toni, spilling the entire contents of their food tray onto her.

And for once, Adora is thankful for someone else’s blunder to save her from this situation.

“Hey! Watch where you’re going!” Toni growls out at the poor waitstaff that’s doing their best to pick up and clean up the mess, “Look what you fucking did! Are you a fucking idiot or just blind?!”

That’s when the waiter growls out.

A magicat waiter dressed in the formal slacks and a white shirt, covered in the orange mess that was whatever was on her tray straightens up, challenging the larger woman despite being quite a lot shorter, her jaw clenches as does her fists, “What did you say?”

“Oh, you must be deaf and stupid too.” Toni wipes the food off her shirt and then uses the magicat waiter’s sleeve to clean her hand, “Do you have any idea how much this suit costs?!”

“Yeah, I do.” The magicat snarks right back, “I said pass to it at the op shop, guess you liked the bargain price of five bucks

because it’s got a shit stain wearing it.”

“Why you little…” Toni goes for a swing as the magicat waiter just holds up their tray to defend themselves when Adora goes into stop the fight, tugging the magicat waiter back as Toni misses everything and nearly topples over from the force, “Hey!”

The magicat waiter growls back as Toni goes for another swing, this time Adora’s shoved back behind the magicat as Toni’s fist hits the tray the waiter was carrying and then the sound of the tray hitting something different sounds and Toni makes a grunting sound, stumbling backwards.

“Fuck. I shouldn’t have done that…” The magicat waiter grumbles lowering their tray down after smacking Toni across the head with it.

Security comes rushing in and grabs both Toni and the waiter, hauling them both out of the venue, Adora quickly following behind doing her best to defend the waiter as they finally get to the front doors.

They are both separated as each of them is interviewed by security once outside.

Toni gesturing wildly and angrily towards Adora and the waiter as the guards continue to speak to her before pointing to the exit in a clear gesture for her to leave, lest they get the police involved.

Adora watches as Toni storms out, knocking over a standing display poster on the way out.

“It was an accident.” The magicat waiter grits out, “I didn’t mean to walk straight into that asshole with a tray of hot curry hors d'oeuvres, she just came out of nowhere. I was just trying to do my fucking job.”

The waiter is reminded again about their language, before Adora jumps in.

“She’s telling the truth. It was an accident.” Adora says.

The magicat waiter doesn’t look at Adora, instead picking at the food on her white shirt, “Can I go now?”

Security let her go after Adora’s supporting statement.

They watch as security head back to their posts, the magicat waiter looks over to Adora, “It wasn’t an accident. And I’d do it again.” She says and winks with a smirk before nodding and then walks away.

Adora just stares after her as Glimmer and Bow rush to her side once security have cleared the area.

“Adora! Are you alright? We heard about the ruckus, but we didn’t see anything.” Bow starts to explain why they’d disappeared.

“Where were you guys?” Adora asks her friends with a small frown on her face at them disappearing, “One minute you were behind me and the next, poof, you’re nowhere to be seen.”

“Sorry babe.” Glimmer says sincerely, “But I was really hungry and the food wasn’t coming our way. So, when I saw one of the waiters come out with a tray, we went in pursuit.”

Bow reaches into his suit jacket pockets and pulls out a baggy and shakes it, “Meatballs!”

Adora laughs as he hands it over to her, “Have you been carrying these bags around all the time?”

“Of course!” Bow nods as she grabs a second bag out of another pocket, “We are pros at this, after all.”

“And we also know how stingy they can be with food when it comes to these parties.” Glimmer adds as she plucks a piece out of the bag and pops it into her mouth, “Yum!”

“So, what happened?” Bow asks through a mouthful of food, “What happened with Toni?”

“Toni…” Adora says the name angrily, “She grabbed me.”

“Oh, where is she?! I’ll punch her for grabbing you!” Glimmer looks around angrily.

“It’s okay. Security kicked her out.” Adora calms her best friend down, “Good riddance to that.”

“Did it have something to do with that waiter that you were talking to with security?” Bow asks and Adora nods, “Seems like they were in the right place at the right time for you.”

“I feel bad though.” Adora admits looking back inside the party doors, “I hope she doesn’t lose her job for me.”

“Wait, I thought you said it was an accident…?” Glimmer says, “It was an accident, right Adora?”

“I’m not too sure.” Adora furrows her brow.

“Come on, we’ll go back in, do one more round and then go to the after party.” Bow suggests.

“Yeah, Adora. Maybe we’ll meet some better people at the after party.” Glimmer adds, “Besides, at least we can actually have a proper dance floor to dance on with better music than the classical stuff at this joint.”

“I don’t mind the music here.” Adora says much to her friends shocked faces, “Don’t look at me like that, you know I’m not into clubs and all of that.”

Her friends just smile back at her as they head back in.

“Okay, let bail!” Glimmer whisper shouts to her friends, gesturing for them to leave.

Bow nods and the trio start to make their way out.

As they step outside into the cool air to wait for a ride to get to the after party, Adora spots the magicat waiter from earlier in the night.

She turns to her friends, “Hey, that’s the waiter that helped me out before. I’m just going to go talk to her. I’ll meet you at the after party after.”

“Are you sure?” Bow asks, “We can wait for you. It’s really not a problem.”

Glimmer catches the look in Adora’s eyes, “You don’t want to come out tonight, do you?”

“Is it really that obvious?” Adora concedes and Glimmer nods once, “Look, I’m just really tired and I really don’t want to be rubbing up against sweaty people tonight.”

“Or do you just want to talk to that waiter?” Bow waggles his eyebrows and then laughs at his own joke, “Oh, or we can be your wing people!”

“Stars, no.” Adora chuckles and shakes her head, “Please don’t.”

“But you’re hopeless!” Glimmer whines out, “We can help! Let us help!”

“I can’t have you two hovering. You’re going to scare her away.” Adora chastises, “Look, go have fun. I’ll text you when I get home.”

“And everything that happens with that magicat waiter!” Bow barters, “You better at least get her name.”

“Stars…” Adora groans out as she watches the waiter start to walk away from the venue, “Please don’t stalk me tonight. I’ll be alright.”

“Yeah, you will be, babe.” Glimmer nods in agreeance, “Because you’re Adora. National car modeller or whatever your title is.”

“Be safe! Text us when you get home!” Bow calls out as Adora starts to walk away.

Adora waves to her friends once more, watching as they jump into their ride.

She turns around, expecting to see the magicat waiter still at the exit of the venue but she’s not there anymore.

“Shit. Shit. Shit. Shit.” Adora curses under her breath as she stands at the now closed exit doors, lamenting that she’s missed the magicat altogether and she groans out into her hands, before slumping down against the door.

The blonde yelps out indignantly when the door opens suddenly, she falls backwards until she’s prone on her back and then looks up, flushed to see a familiar magicat staring down at her with an amused look on her face. The magicat has a black jacket over their white work shirt, covering up the stain from earlier in the night.

“Hey. I would advise sitting against this door. It opens inwards.” The magicat waiter rasps out with a shit eating grin on her face before holding her hand out towards Adora, “Need a hand, princess?”

Adora just stares up at the magicat, mouth agape and unmoving in a mix of shock and surprise.

The magicat waiter chuckles under her breath and crouches down, tilting her head with a tinge of concern in her eyes as she

looks at the blonde, “Did you bump your head? You’re not brain damaged, are you?”

The smirk on the end of that question has Adora rolling her eyes but then she can’t help the laugh that comes out next, “No. My head is fine. Sorry. I was just… uh…”

“Just?” The magicat waiter helps Adora to her feet, her hands out just in case the blonde is going to tumble over again, “Are you good to stand on your own or do you need to lean on me?”

“I think I’m okay to stand on my own.” Adora says while she reaches out for the door frame as the magicat chuckles and the blonde blushes a little, “Sorry.”

The magicat looks over Adora quizzically, “Not to rush you or anything, princess... But we kind of need to get out of this doorway.”

“Huh?” Adora says as she lets the magicat usher out of the doorway.

Pointing towards the sign attached to the door, the magicat smiles, “Emergency exit. The alarm sounds if it’s left open for too long.”

“Oh.” Adora says and then laughs nervously as the magicat shuts the door behind them and then puts her hands into her jacket pockets.

“Did you bring a jacket?” The magicat asks and Adora just stares back her dumbly, “Hello?”

“Sorry.” Adora repeats again, mentally slapping herself as she tears her eyes from the magicat’s different coloured eyes, “Uh, no. I don’t. But it’s fine. I’m not really that cold.”

“Tell that to the goosebumps growing on your arm, princess.” The magicat says holding back a laugh whilst peeling off her jacket and then draping it over Adora’s shoulders, “Pretty sure the curry

on my shirt is already dry and didn't wipe off onto the inside of my jacket."

Adora pulls the jacket around herself almost instinctively, "Thank you."

"Too easy." The magicat shrugs, "Are you going to be okay to get home? You did kind of hit your head when I opened the door before."

"Oh, I'll be fine." Adora brushes off the magicat's concern, "Don't need to worry about me."

"Okay." The magicat nods, "Well, get home safe, princess. Stay warm."

"Wait!" Adora quickly turns and takes a couple of steps to catch up with the magicat who's about to walk off, "Um, hi."

"Hey."

"What's your name?" Adora quickly asks before she loses her nerve and then quickly adds, "Just so I can return the jacket to you after…"

"How are you planning to return my jacket with just my name, princess?" The magicat retorts with a wry grin before chuckling, "I'll tell you mine if I get yours."

"Adora."

"Adora?" The blonde nods and the magicat sticks her hand out once more, "Catra."

"It's nice to meet you properly." Adora smiles genuinely as she takes Catra's hand in hers, her smile drops as does her voice as she asks, "You're not going to drag me forward and kiss the back of my hand, are you?"

“Uh, I can if you want me to?” Catra replies unsurely before giving her a cheeky smile, “But I usually leave my kisses for the end of good dates. That’s just me, you know.”

Adora blushes then rolls her eyes when Catra starts to laugh, she can’t help the smile at hearing the high pitch squeak in that laugh, “Can I walk you home, Catra?”

Shaking her head, Catra says, “I’m not in a good neighbourhood, Adora. It’d be safer for me to walk you home than have you walk out of my place.”

“Oh, I don’t mind.” Adora tries again, “I can take care of myself.”

“I don’t doubt that, princess.” Catra says without jest, “But I’d feel a lot better if you didn’t have to walk anywhere near my neighbourhood.”

“Oh, okay.”

“Can I walk you home instead?” Catra asks again, “If you want, I can keep a few steps back if you don’t want me to walk next to you on account I smell like curry from that little spill earlier.”

Adora finds herself laughing again, “Okay, you can walk me home. But you have to walk next to me.”

“If you’re sure?” Catra asks once more just to give Adora an out.

Instead, the blonde nods, “I’m sure. I’m not too far from here actually.”

“That’s handy.” The magicat comments and then gestures for Adora to lead the way before coming to an abrupt stop by the end of the building.

Adora stops as well, not sure why Catra has stopped, “Something wrong?”

Catra shakes her head, furrows her brows and then crouches down, “Where are you, you little shit?”

“What?” Adora says confused, “What are you doing?”

“Come out already.” Catra breathes out, “Or you can sleep outside tonight.”

And just when Adora’s about to question the magicat again she hears…

Meow

A cat comes sauntering out, almost like it was had been waiting for Catra to come back.
Catra picks up the fairly big maroon cat with a grey mane, “Where have you been, dude?”

“Stars…” Adora coos at the interaction between Catra and the cat, she keeps her distance but asks, “Who is this?”

“Melog.” Catra simply says giving him one more pat before lowering him back down, “He sort of lives with me.”

“Sort of?”

“Yeah.” Catra says as she watches him wind around Adora’s legs, “So, which way is your place?”

Adora crouches down and pets Melog, “Stars, he is so soft…”

Catra smiles as she watches Adora pet Melog, the maroon cat happily purring up a storm, “Oh, don’t pick him up or he won’t let you put him down until I get home.”

“Okay.” Adora laughs, “Hi Melog!”

Melog just continues to purr, which then makes Catra's purr start up too.

The magicat tries to tamp it down hoping Adora doesn't notice, but it's too late, Adora's already starting at her with hearts in her eyes, Catra groans dramatically, "Not a word, Adora."

"Oh, we are so talking about this when you walk me home as well as what happened with the 'accident'." Adora laughs as she stands back up again and then gestures down the street, "I'm this way."

"Okay." Catra nods and speeds up a little to walk next to Adora, her hand accidentally knocks against Adora's and she chances a look. The blonde glances down and then over quickly, a small blush on her cheek as Catra chances it and slides her hand into Adora's. The blonde's breath hitches and Catra stiffens slightly, about to pull away, only for Adora to lace their fingers together and Catra just nods back to her as they continue walking.

Melog leaps up and climbs onto Catra's shoulder, between the magicat and Adora and meows again.

Adora laughs, "Is he always like this?"

"Yes." Catra replies with a smile before sending the cat a playful glare and then warns the cat, "Don't you dare dig your claws into my shirt, Melog. It's my only nice white one and I need it for work."

Melog just meows at her again making Adora laugh as they continue to walk on.

Chapter 2: Walking Home

Chapter Summary

Catra walks Adora home with Melog.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"So, you said it wasn't an accident?" Adora casually mentions as they walk hand in hand towards her place, "Why in the world would you walk into someone with a tray full of hot food?"

"I think it was pretty obvious." Catra replies as she rubs her cheek against Melog still perched on her shoulder.

"No, I'm pretty oblivious. Humour me." The blonde looks over and coos at seeing Catra interact with the cat on her shoulder, "Also, I have to get a picture of this."

"Stars, please don't." Catra blushes, "I'd rather stay off the internet."

"Oh, yeah, that's cool." Adora's free hand taps against her phone in her pocket, and then she speaks up again, "So… what if I get a picture… like, just for me?"

"You want a photo of me and Melog. Just for you?" Catra replies and stares curiously at the blonde, Adora simply nods with a blush and the magicat rolls her eyes, "Only if I get one of you later."

Adora rolls her eyes and grins, "There's already plenty of photos of me, Catra."

"What do you mean?" the magicat replies genuinely confused, "Why?"

Looking around, Adora spots a billboard and points to it, “Well, for one. I’m like, right there.”

Catra looks up and sure enough there’s a billboard of a fancy looking car and Adora standing next to it looking very beautiful, “Wait. That’s you?!”

Giggling, Adora nods, “What do you mean? Of course it’s me!”

“No, that’s not you. No way is that you.” Catra shakes her head and Adora pouts at her though her hand doesn’t let go, “You’re way better looking than that billboard model, Adora.”

The pout on Adora’s face disappears and is instantly replaced with a stunned look and flushed cheeks, she looks away, “You’re just saying that.”

“I’m really not.” Catra replies, “Besides, I wouldn’t lie to you.”

“But you’d lie for me?” Adora teases.

“Most definitely I would.” Catra nods solemnly, “And I’d do what I did again to stop that creep from putting their grubby hands on you.”

“Oh, you saw that?” Adora asks meekly.

“I *heard* the slap.” The magicat squeezes Adora’s hand once, “And the fact that no one even stood up or said or did anything…” Catra growls a little under her breath, making Melog jump down to the ground and walk a few steps ahead of them, “Sorry, bud.”

“You know, I can handle myself.” Adora says.

“I know you can too.” Adora looks over at Catra at the admission, “But it’s easier for a nobody to make a scene than have your face plastered all over the news and socials for clicks.”

A smirk appears on Adora’s face, “Aha! You do know me!”

“Princess.” Catra deadpans, “Everyone at that party is a somebody. The only people that aren’t anybody special are they people working the event.”

“You’re not a nobody.” Adora softly says not letting the magicat pull her hand away, “Besides, would a nobody do what you did tonight for an utter and total stranger?”

“Totally. Absolutely.” The magicat replies automatically, “Only a stranger with nothing to lose would do something like that.”

“That’s not true.” Adora sighs, “You did have something to lose.”

“My dignity? My pain sensors? My shirt?” Catra lists off casually and then her ears swirl around when she hears Adora laugh, ‘What’s so funny, princess?”

“You.”

“Me? You’re laughing at me?” Catra asks with a quizzical look on her face, “Why?”

“You say all those things, but you did have something to lose, Catra. Or did you just forget?” Adora says with mirth still in her voice, “What about your job?”

“What about my job?” the magicat repeats, doing the best to mimic Adora’s tone and voice, earning herself an amused look from the blonde, “It’s just a job, Adora. They come and go.”

“You seemed a little pissed about losing it before when we were talking to the security staff.” Adora points out.

“Just playing to the role.”

“You literally growled at them.” The blonde smirks.

“I growl at everyone.” Catra shrugs like it’s an everyday thing to say.

“Not me, you haven’t.” Adora stops abruptly, tugging Catra to stop too, “If you growled at me… does that mean you were playing me too?”

“I’d never lie to you.” Catra blurts out despite herself.

“You just lied to me then.” The statement has Catra tilting her head at Adora, the blonde quirking an eyebrow up at her, “You said you lie to everyone. And then you said, that you’d never lie to me. So, which is it?”

After a moment, the magicat realises she’s been outsmarted and grumbles out, “Fuck.”

Adora giggles, “What’s the matter, Catra? Cat got your tongue?”

Glaring at the blonde with no heat, Catra just clenches her jaw and shakes her head with a sigh, “See Melog? This is why we don’t have friends. People just like to make fun of us.”

“Oh, no. I am so sorry! I didn’t mean to offend you, Catra!” Adora starts to apologise profusely, “It was just supposed to be a joke and I went way too far. I’m so sorry!”

“Stars. Chill, princess.” Catra rolls her eyes, “I was just messing with you too.”

“Oh.” Adora quickly stops her panicking and then furrows her brows and whacks Catra on the shoulder, effectively ending their hand holding, “Hey!”

The magicat cackles out as she tries to get away from Adora’s swatting hand, Melog getting out of the way as the pair chase each other around the sidewalks under the eyes of other pedestrians also trying to avoid the pair.

Eventually Adora catches up with Catra and puts her into a loose headlock before the magicat twists around and they almost end up falling over.

“Woah!” Adora yelps out, Catra catching her just before she makes contact with the ground in an unconventional dip.

“I got you!” Catra pulls her back up to the feet, practically body slamming the blonde against herself as she takes a step backwards to steady them, “Are you okay, princess?”

Adora’s face is so close that she can see all the freckles on Catra’s face and under the streetlights she can make out the different coloured eyes the magicat sports, “Your eyes…”

Catra looks away, “Yeah. I know.”

“Know what?” Adora cups Catra’s cheeks so the magicat will look at her again.

“I’m a freak.”

“You’re not a freak.” Adora says bemused, “Why would you say that?”

Catra shrugs, looking down this time so she can’t see Adora’s face, “That’ what everyone else says. So, why not you?”

“You’re not a freak, Catra.” Adora repeats, “And if anyone calls you that, they’ll have to deal with me.”

“And who are you exactly?” Catra smirks and then adds, “And is this payback or something? Because it’s really not necessary.”

“Shush you!” Adora chastises, “I’m trying to do a thing here.”

“What thing? And you better not say me.” Catra says seriously before cackling at her own joke and pulling away from Adora’s hold on her face, “Oh, you should have seen your face!”

Adora rolls her eyes, “I did *not* make a face.”

“My bad.” Catra calms herself down and gestures for Adora to continue.

“I mean it though.” The blonde reaches out for Catra’s hand again, gently interlocking their fingers once more, “You’re not a freak.”

“Sure.” Catra says almost dismissively, “It’s really not a big deal, Adora. I’m used to it.”

“But you shouldn’t be though.” Adora sighs, “Hey, Catra?”

“Yeah?”

“Can we be friends?” Adora asks shyly, a light blush covering her cheeks, “I mean, you don’t have to say yes right now. You can totally think about it first or whatever… take all the time you need.”

“Do you always ramble?” Catra asks back amused.

Adora just smiles back in response.

“So… just friends?” The magicat asks biting her bottom lip and waiting for the other shoe to drop where Adora will laugh in her face and say ‘PSYCH!’.

Instead, Adora nods back with a hopeful look in her eyes.

“You really want to be friends? With me?” Catra asks again, giving Adora a way to back out.

“Yes! Yes, I want to be friends, Catra!” Adora practically shrieks before she dissolves into giggles, “And now you’ve got me shouting it in the middle of the street.”

“Sidewalk.”

“Whatever.” Adora bumps Catra’s shoulder, “So?”

Catra pretends to think before she nods and Adora’s face lights up, the magicat grins as then says, “Will there be benefits included in this friendship?”

Adora slaps Catra's shoulder playfully before she looks away and says, "Maybe."

The grin on Catra's face get wider, "Hey, Adora?"

"Hm?"

"Can I take you out on a date?" Catra asks using whatever confidence she's got in her, even though Adora's still holding onto her hand, "As friends. Hoping to get benefits."

"Yeah?" the shy look on Adora's face has Catra melting inside.

"Yeah. Really." Catra nods confidently, "I like you and when I don't smell like curry, I'd like to take you on a date… Preferably with curry."

Adora snorts out a laugh, "Sounds like an interesting date idea…"

"Oh, for sure." Catra nods grinning, "How's your stomach for spiciness?"

"Not the best." Adora admits as they start walking again after Melog had doubled back and meowed at them to hurry up, "He's so cute!"

"He's alright." Catra shrugs, "For a cat."

MEOW!

Adora giggles, "Melog didn't like that." She crouches down to give him a few scratches under his chin, "Did you, Melog. You are so very cute."

Catra mutters something under her breath.

“What was that, Catra?” Adora looks up from where she’s still petting Melog, “Did you say something?”

“Nope. I didn’t say anything. Nothing at all.” Catra refutes quickly.

“No. I swear I heard you say something…” Adora hums to herself and then smirks at Catra, “I’m pretty sure I heard you say…”

“Nope!” Catra reaches over and tries to muffle Adora’s words with her hands, the blonde easily pulling away while laughing.

“Catra!” Adora starts to run away as the magicat chases after her, Melog leaping onto Catra’s shoulder to join the chase, “That’s not fair! Two against one!”

Catra chases Adora until they’re breathless and Adora’s stopped off in front of a rather fancy building, the magicat whistling out, “Woah… even the door has a door guy for it.”

Watching Catra’s eyes widen as she looks around at the front of the building has Adora finding herself enamoured with the magicat a little more, she clears her throat, “Well, this is me.”

“You live here?” Catra asks incredulously.

Adora nods shyly, pushing back a few stray hairs from her face, “Yeah. I do.”

“That’s… cool.” Catra nods again, the magicat gives Melog a quick scratch under his chin and then looks at Adora, “It was nice to meet you, Adora. Have a good night.”

“Thanks for walking me home, Catra.” Adora squeezes Catra’s hand, “And for the ‘not accident.’”

“I’d do it again.” Catra replies honestly as she turns to Melog, “Come on, bud. Give Adora a kiss and we can go.”

Melog meows and leaps down into Catra’s arms, she lets go of Adora’s hand to stop from dropping the cat. Adora coos at the

sight as she reaches out and runs her hand along Melog's fur, "It was really nice to meet you, Melog."

Meow

"Yeah, bud." Catra sighs as Adora grins at her, her hand still in Melog's fur, "Okay well, uh, what are you doing tomorrow?"

Adora smiles back, "Well, I thought you were taking me out on a date."

"I am?" Catra says like she's forgotten that fact and then grins, "I am. Yes."

"You're very cute." Adora says and then she slaps a hand over her mouth as Catra's ears flop down flat on top of her head shyly, "Sorry… that wasn't… I wasn't… ugh!"

"It's okay, princess." Catra rubs the back of her neck, "I mean, you're kind of, uh, hot."

This time Adora turns away with a blush on her cheeks, "Stars…"

"So, uh, date tomorrow?" Catra asks still rubbing the back of her neck, "I'll meet you here around five?"

"Five?"

"Stars… is that too early?" Catra panics slightly, "Or we can go later or the day after or…"

Adora leans in and presses a kiss on Catra's cheek, "Five is fine."

"Five it is then." Catra grins as touches her kissed cheek, "Uh, any preferences?"

“Whatever is fine, Catra.” Adora replies as she goes to take off the magicat’s jacket and holds it out to Catra, “Also thank you for the jacket.”

Catra gingerly takes her jacket back, “It’s no problem, Adora.”

“Okay.” Adora smiles at Catra, “I guess I should…”

Catra watches the blonde stick her thumb towards the doors and the magicat nods, “Oh, yeah, right.” The magicat puts her jacket back on and resists the urge to sniff the collar, “I’ll see you tomorrow. Go on inside. It’s getting late.”

Nodding, Adora sighs with a chuckle as Melog winds through her legs once more before walking off, “Bye Melog.”

Meow

Giggling, the blonde waves to Melog’s departing form as she turns to Catra, wrapping her arms around the magicat and pulling her in for a tight hug, “Mm… you’re so soft…”

A purr starts up in Catra’s chest, and she just doesn’t care as she wraps her arms around Adora’s waist and lets herself breath the blonde in.

And when they eventually part, Adora leans in once more and presses a soft kiss on Catra’s cheek, “Goodnight, Catra.”

Catra just stares starry eyed back at Adora, a soft, “Goodnight, Adora.” Leaves her lips as she waits until she can’t see the blonde anymore once she gets into the lift and the doorman has shut the door.

Smiling, Catra takes a few steps back and stares up at the building and then breathes out, “Best night ever.”

Meow

Catra looks down at Melog now sitting by her feet, "Let's go home, bud."

"Good! You're home!" Glimmer shouts into the phone, the music from the party they're still at thrumming loudly in the background, "Did you get lucky?!"

Adora laughs, shaking her head despite it not being a video call, "Stars, no."

"What about a kiss?!" Bow shouts over Glimmer and the music.

"I kind of kissed her." Adora answers biting her lip as her friends squeal out happily.

"Adora! Oh, my stars! I can't believe you made out with someone!" Glimmer beams, "How was it?! Is she a good kisser?!"

"We didn't kiss, kiss, Glim." Adora replies as she finally lies down on her bed after finishing her night time routine, "I even asked if she was going to kiss the back of my hand like that creep earlier tonight."

"Oh, what did she say?" Glimmer asks as there's some kind of announcement in the background.

"She said she only kisses after dates. Well, I'm assuming good dates." Adora smiles to herself, "But stars, she is so cute…"

"Really?"

"She walked me home, Glim. We, uh, held hands." Adora gushes shyly, "And she didn't even try anything or expect anything in

return.”

“Huh.” Adora’s best friend simply says, “That’s refreshing.”

“I know, right?!” Adora can’t fight the smile on her face, “She’s also got a cat.”

“A magicat with a cat?” Glimmer laughs out on the other end of the phone, “Tell me you got a photo!”

“Yes! Hang on…” Adora starts going through her phone’s gallery and then groans out, “Ugh! I didn’t get one! I was going to take one of her and Melog on her shoulder. But then she distracted me.”

“I can literally hear the pout on your face.” Glimmer says, “Did you at least get her number?”

“No.” Adora groans out again.

“Oh, babe.” Glimmer breathes out, “Are you okay?”

Nodding, Adora huffs and then grins, “I’m going on a date with her tomorrow night.”

“That’s my girl!” Glimmer lights up and in the background she relays the message to Bow, “She’s got a date, Bow!”

There’s a happy squeal in the background and Bow’s voice comes over the phone, “Go girl! I knew you could do it!”

Adora laughs, “She asked me out.”

“Even better!” Bow cheers happily, “Where are you going? Where is she taking you? Do you think it’s going to be fancy? Oh, Oh! Are you going to kiss her, properly?”

The smile on Adora’s face doesn’t dim, “I can’t believe I already kissed her.”

“What?!” Bow’s voice goes up an octave, “You kissed her?!”

“She did!” Glimmer screeches through the phone, still excited.

“Guys! I kissed her on the cheek.” Adora admits again sheepishly and then adds, “Twice…”

Another happy squeal comes over the phone and Adora laughs out again.

The blonde sighs out contently, happy to have spoken to her friends and now can’t wait for tomorrow, “Alright guys. I’m going to sleep now.”

“Goodnight, Adora!” her friends shout back their goodbyes, “Call us after your date tomorrow!”

“Okay. I will.” Adora grins, “Bye guys! Stay safe and text me when you get home.”

“We will!” Bow shouts back before they hang up.

Adora plugs her phone in and then turns off the lights, a smile on her face as she tries to sleep with all the excitement built up inside of her, telling herself that she needed to sleep or she’ll be too tired tomorrow night for her date with Catra.

Eventually, Adora falls asleep.

The smile still on her face.

Chapter End Notes

Next chapter: Date!

thanks for reading, kudos, comments, bookmarking and subscribing!

Chapter 3: Date

Chapter Summary

Catra and Adora go on that date.

Chapter Notes

Posting this today as it's my bday tomorrow and I'm working away. 😟
But it is Adora's bday apparently today... so yay!
Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra paces up and down in front of Adora's building.

She looks at the time on her watch and then paces a little more, doing her best not to mumble to herself.

She does anyway.

The doorman stares at her.

Concern on his face as he asks, "Are you alright? Are you lost?"

Catra tilts her head at him, "What?"

"Are you lost?" He repeats, the same look on his face like he's not sure to help her or to call the police to have her removed.

"I'm waiting for someone." Catra replies as she eyes the name badge of his uniform, "Frankie, is it?"

"Yes. And you are?" The doorman, Frankie asks.

"Catra." The magicat sticks her hand out to Frankie, they shake, "It's nice to meet you."

Frankie nods with a friendly smile, “And… who are you waiting for?”

“Uh… Adora. I’m waiting for Adora.” Catra replies rubbing the back of her neck, “We’re, uh, going on a date.”

“Oh!” Frankie’s eyes light up and then leans in like he’s going to tell Catra something important, the magicat leans in cautiously as he says, “Do not hurt her. Or you will be thrown out of every place with a doorperson in site. And don’t think that’s only if you try walking into one. We’ll throw you out from the street if you hurt her.”

Catra’s eyes widen and she takes a step back, “Hurt her? Why would I do that? She’s… perfect.”

Frankie just points his finger at her in warning, “Don’t fuck it up.”

The magicat holds her hands up and takes a step back, “Yeah. Okay. I won’t fuck it up.”

Someone comes out of the elevator and Frankie quickly goes back to his post and opens the door, “Good evening, Adora.”

“Hi Frankie.” Adora smiles at him.

“You have a suitor waiting for you.” He gestures to Catra.

“Oh, yes. Thank you.” Adora grins as she looks out to see Catra standing outside in a maroon suit, a black button up shirt under and her short hair slicked back, the blonde looks back at Frankie, “That’s Catra, she’s my… uh… date.”

Frankie stares out at the magicat standing outside looking anxiously inside at the pair’s interaction, he sees the blush on Adora’s face, “Have a good night, Adora.”

“Thank you, Frankie.” Adora nods to him as she steps out of the open door.

“Don’t stay out too late, Adora.” Frankie warns teasingly, “Goodnight and stay safe.”

Adora laughs out at that as she waves him goodbye and walks over to Catra waiting for her, stopping just shy as Catra grins at her, the blonde breathes out, “Hi.”

“Hey, Adora.” Catra rasps out trying to keep her voice steady at the sight of Adora in a red sleeveless dress, her hair down and looking so gorgeous, “You look so beautiful.”

Adora blushes, looking away shyly, “You look nice too.”

“Just nice?” Catra replies with a look of faux offense, “I put on my only suit and get a haircut for just nice?”

Adora giggles, nudging Catra with her shoulder playfully, “Fine. You look beautiful too.”

The magicat grins back, “Wasn’t quite the word I was going for, but I’ll take it.”

The blonde bounces on the balls of her feet excitedly, she blurts out, “I haven’t been on a date in a while.”

“Oh. Is that so?” Catra replies genuinely surprised, “Why is that? If you don’t mind me asking?”

“I don’t really date.” Adora admits, looking away once more.

Catra nods, happy to not question the blonde any further, “So, Frankie is uh, kind of protective…”

“Frankie?” Adora glances back at the doorman, “He’s very good at his job. Very protective of who comes in and out, just looks out for the building really.”

“And you too.” Catra adds.

“Is he?” The blonde smiles back at the magicat, “He’s nice. Always polite and friendly. Makes sure no one gets in that shouldn’t get in.”

Nodding, Catra agrees, “Seems like a good man.”

“He’s also very sweet.” Adora adds.

“Yeah.” Catra sighs with another nod, “Do the people in this building stay a while?”

“I guess.” Adora replies slightly amused, “We don’t get too many people moving in and out much. Maybe once or twice a year.”

“Good building.” Catra remarks as she smiles and holds her hand out to Adora, “So, ready to go on this date?”

“Yes.” Adora reaches out and puts her hand in the magicat’s as they start to walk down the street, “Where are we going?”

“Out.” Catra simply replies as she squeezes Adora’s hand.

“Woah. What is this, Catra?” Adora asks with wide eyes as Catra leads her into a small festival in the city streets.

“It’s the city night festival.” Catra raises her arms in presentation as she walks backward with a grin on her face, “Happens every Saturday night until the end of the season.”

“I’ve never been to this before.” Adora looks around at all the stalls and lights, “Is it always this busy?”

“Tonight, it is. The weather has cleared up so everyone is out and about.” Catra replies, “The last couple of Saturday’s have been pretty wet. So, a lot of stalls didn’t open. And because it was raining, the main stage couldn’t go ahead either, as everything is outdoors.”

Adora nods, “What’s there to do here?”

Catra comes back to Adora’s side, sliding her hand back into the blonde’s, “Lots of stuff. And the best part…”

“What’s the best part?” The blonde squeezes Catra’s hand back, her eyes darting around the street stalls and lights and then back to the magicat.

“Most of it is free.” Catra replies with a chuckle, “Well, the entertainment is. The food, not so much. But I’ve got some cash on me so we can get a feed.”

“I can pay for dinner, Catra.” Adora offers, “You don’t need to pay for everything.”

Shaking her head, Catra declines Adora’s offer, “No. I asked you out on this date. So, whatever you want tonight, I will get for you.”

“Catra…” Adora tries.

“Nope.” the magicat raises her hand up, “Not up for discussion. I asked you out, so I pay.”

“That’s silly.” Adora chuckles under her breath as she playfully knocks against her side, “I can cover tonight. You don’t have to.”

“Princess.” Catra drawls and then rolls her eyes, “No. Thank you for your offer, but it’s really not necessarily. I did get paid after all.”

The blonde quirks up an eyebrow at her, “Yeah, but…”

“Nope.” Catra repeats, “I’ve got tonight planned out and I’ve got more than enough to cover whatever activity I have planned for tonight.”

“If you’re sure…” Adora sighs out.

“I’m very sure.” Catra tugs Adora further into the festival’s streets, “Let me worry about my finances, princess. We’re here to have fun after all, aren’t we?”

Conceding, Adora nods, “Okay.” And then she grins at Catra, “So… what are we doing first?”

Catra starts to pull her along, “We’re going to do a lap first, princess.”

“A lap?”

“Yeah, a lap.” Catra repeats, a smile still on her lips, “We’ll go check out everything first before I start spending my hard earned money.”

“Oh… that’s a great idea!” Adora lights up, nodding enthusiastically, “How big is this festival?”

“It’s a couple of streets.” Catra replies, “Essentially the centre of the festival is the crossways, that’s where the main stage is set. And then there’s stalls and other things up and down the streets from the centre point.”

“Lead the way, Catra.” Adora grins and then stops, holding Catra up, “Wait.”

“What’s wrong?” Confusion crossing Catra’s face at the sudden pause.

Adora looks around them with furrowed brows and then back at Catra, “Where is he?”

“He?”

“Melog. Where is Melog?” Adora elaborates, “Isn’t he like your shoulder cat?”

“My what now?” Catra replies confused.

“Your shoulder cat.” Adora repeats, “Is he hiding?”

“Melog is not a shoulder cat.” Catra says amused, “He’s… “

“He’s what?”

“He’s… just a cat.” Catra says, “And he’s not here.”

“Oh.”

“But we might see him again when we head back to your place later.” Catra informs the blonde, “But right now… He’s off doing, Melog things.”

That makes Adora laugh, she squeezes Catra’s hand once more to indicate for the magicat to continue their lap around the festival, “What exactly are Melog things?”

Catra shrugs, “Not sure. Cat stuff, I guess.”

“You don’t know?” Adora sounds genuinely surprised, “But aren’t you kind of…”

“I’m a magicat, Adora.” Catra says with a sigh, “I’m not a cat-cat.”

“Oh, I didn’t mean to offend you.” Adora quickly apologises, “I just thought… well, never mind.”

“Honestly, things would be easier if I was just like Melog.” Catra says as they continue to walk around, not really taking notice of any of the stalls or people around them, “At least I wouldn’t have to work and really only worry about who I can leach off for food and shelter. Being a hybrid is… hard.”

“I’m sorry.” Adora repeats, “I didn’t know.”

“It’s fine, Adora.” Catra brushes it off, “It is what it is.”

“Sounds hard.” The blonde breathes out, “But you seem to carry yourself well.”

“You do what you can to survive. With whatever opportunities you get.” They walk towards the main stage where a band is still setting up and then stop at the small billboard with the line up of performers, “Looks like a good mix of artists tonight.”

Adora nods, letting the topic go for now, looking that the names on the board, “Oh, there’s a magic show tonight.”

“Are you into magic?” Catra asks looking over at Adora who nods back in answer, “We’ll come back and watch them.”

Adora shoots back a beaming smile at the magicat, “That’d be great.”

“Okay.” Catra can’t help mirroring Adora’s enthusiasm, “Shall we keep going?”

“Yes.”

“Did you see any food stalls you want to try?” Catra asks as they complete their lap of the festival, the streets getting busier with more people coming through now that everything seems to be in full swing, “Oh, there’s also food trucks on the outskirts of the festival.”

“There’s just so much!” Adora gushes, “But I’m also on a bit of a strict diet with my job and all.”

“Oh, right.” Catra nods feeling a little silly at bringing Adora to this festival where she probably can’t even eat any of the food they’ve walked past, “I saw a salad place back on that other street, on the right hand side of the stage.”

“Everything here smells so good though.” Adora whines out with a pout, “I mean… if you get the foods I want, maybe I can… I don’t know… sample them?”

“We can share if that’s what you’re asking.” Catra grins “Just point to what you want to try, princess.”

“Okay.” Adora looks around and as they head to one of the food stalls a little further away, she sighs, “Sometimes I hate my job.”

“A car model?”

Adora nods, “Yeah. My meals and exercise is logged daily as part of my contract. It’s exhausting.”

“Yeah? Sounds like a crap contract.” Catra says flatly, “What’s the point of living if you can’t enjoy good food? Or spend a day lounging around doing nothing.”

“It’s not like I can’t enjoy good food.” Adora bites her bottom lip, “It’s just… it feels like I don’t have any control over my life since I signed this contract.”

Catra orders at the food stall she knows Adora was eying, paying for it before stepping back so other people can do the same, “How long is your contract for?”

“Another two years. Or just under.” Adora replies, “I can’t wait for it to end, honestly.”

“So… you just log your food and exercise?” Catra’s ears perk up, “You get paid to keep fit and eat well without the annoyance of competing for anything.”

“Well, when you put it that way, it doesn’t sound so bad.” Adora grumbles out.

“I know.” Catra smiles knowingly, “It never looks bad to the people that aren’t experiencing it.”

Adora nods.

Catra turns her head as her order is called out, “I’ll be right back.”

Someone taps Adora on the shoulder behind, the blonde turning to see who's after her attention, "Hello?"

She's met with a young couple, male and female, the guy who looks like he's dressed to go out to a club and not a festival, smiles at her, "Hey, you're that Swift car girl, right?"

Adora smiles, it's still weird being recognised considering she's on so many billboards and tv ads across the city and social media, she nods, "Yeah, that's me."

"Stars! See, I told you!" The guy preens as his girlfriend smiles back, "I knew it was her." he turns back to Adora, "Can I get a photo with you? The guys at work are going to be so jealous!"

And without waiting for Adora's answer, he moves next to her while pulling his phone out and then wrapping his arm around the blonde's waist to get the photo. And before she's able to push him off, he's snapped a photo before holding it out to his girlfriend.

"Sadie, take a photo of us, would you?" He asks his girlfriend who steps forward and takes the phone, holding it up to take another photo.

"Fuck, you're so hot." He murmurs under his breath as his hand slides down from around Adora's waist and over her ass, chancing a squeeze while his at it, "Yeah… fuck yeah… totally hot…"

"Hey!" Catra's voice startles them as she rips his hand off Adora's body and shoves him back, "What the fuck do you think you're doing?!"

"Woah!" The guy steps back, obviously a little shocked at getting called out, "Chill, dude."

"Chill? Chill?!" Catra says the word angrily, "You fucking felt her up!"

His girlfriend slaps him across the face, "You what?!"

“Hey! I didn’t…” He starts to step back in denial, his eyes dart from his girlfriend to Adora and then the threatening magicat, “She’s lying!”

“Hey, are you alright?” Catra quickly checks on Adora, the blonde nods back, “Don’t do anything. I’ve got this.”

“Catra…”

“No. Remember the whole somebody and nobody stance we talked about?” Sighing, Adora nods again, the magicat turns back to the guy now being yelled at by his soon to be ex-girlfriend, Catra growls at the pair.

The couple turns to Catra upon hearing the low and threatening growl, the girl, Sadie, shoves the guy backwards, grabbing his phones and smashing it on the ground, wiping her hands and then simply says, “Fuck you. We’re done.”

“Sadie!” The guys turns to chase after her, ignoring his smashed device all over the ground.

“No! I should have listened to my friends when they told me you were a creep!” Sadie cuts off whatever apology is on his lips, “Leave me alone! We’re done. Don’t follow me. You can collect all your shit in the driveway tomorrow.”

“Sadie!” He tries again to chase after her only to be held back by his jacket, “What…?”

Catra grabs him by the collar of his jacket and hauls him up and off the ground, another growl and a show of her sharp teeth on display, “You like feeling up women?”

“I didn’t…” He tries desperately to get free, even looking around for someone that might help him, but no one seems to bat an eyelid.

“You’re a fucking liar.” Catra grits out, “Oh, and you must not be a local here, either. Don’t bother trying to convince anyone here of

your lies, no one will believe you."

"What…?" Fear now in his eyes as he looks around once more, only to find a few people standing there watching the situation unfold, unmoving, "Hey! Help me! She's fucking crazy?!"

The onlookers shake their head, just happy to watch on.

"Catra." Adora puts her hand on the magicat's shoulder.

Catra's ears flick around towards Adora's voice, and she narrows her eyes at the guy in her hold, "This is your lucky day, bub." She drops him to the ground and takes a step back, "Get the fuck out of here. You're not welcome here."

The guy stumbles and falls backwards onto the hard pavement of the sidewalk with a grunt. He scrambles back up to his feet, no doubt wanting to say something else, only for the locals and onlookers to circle him, eventually he gets the message and backs down, his arms up in surrender as he practically scurries away with his tail between his legs.

And once he's gone, the crowd of locals all go back to festival, not even acknowledging what just happened, and neither does Catra as she reaches out to Adora, their hands intertwine once more, "Are you okay? Like, for real."

"I'm fine." Adora replies reassuringly, "I just wasn't expecting to get felt up by anyone except you tonight."

The tease has Catra doing a double take as Adora smiles shyly back at her, "Uh, I wouldn't… not without… asking first."

"I know." Adora pulls Catra into her, throwing her arms around the magicat in a tight hug, she presses a soft kiss on Catra's cheek before pulling back, "Also, you took away my chance to punch someone."

"You want to punch someone?" Catra repeats back a little amused before she tugs Adora to the food stand she was meant to pick up

their order when that little incident happened, the magicat waits in the line, the owner gestures for her to come to the front and hands over her still hot food, “Thanks.”

“No, thank you.” The man at the stall says, “That guy was feeling up a lot more people. He’s lucky you stepped in otherwise I would have thrown hot oil on him.”

“Oh, yeah, that would have been bad. Really bad.” Catra replies as she grabs a spoon and a few napkins, “Thanks for keeping it warm.”

“No problems.” He quickly says before attending to a customer.

Catra leads Adora to a few milk crates with cushions strewn around like seats, “Sit. Eat.”

They sit next to each other on the milk crates seats, Catra holds out the steaming cup with the spoon, “Here. I saw you eyeing it before.”

The smile on Adora’s face is so wide it’s almost blinding as Adora takes the cup and spoon from Catra’s hand, “Thank you.”

The magicat watches as Adora scoops up a dumpling in the soup, “Oh, hang on, it’s hot.”

And instantly, Catra’s on her feet, quickly getting a bottle of water from the nearby stall and holding it out to Adora, snickering under her breath, the blonde gratefully accepts the water and downs two big gulps to help with the burn on her tongue and in her mouth, handing the bottle back to Catra and then fanning her mouth, “Wow, that’s really hot.”

“Guess you didn’t notice the steam coming off it, huh, princess?” Catra tries not to laugh, except that she can’t help but smile before furrowing her brows at the blonde, “Wait. Did you just spit that back in there?”

The magicat tries to peer inside the cup only for Adora to quickly move it away from her view, grumbling out, "Maybe… yes."

The magicat just shrugs, "Eh, happens. Give it here. I've never had this before."

"Oh, are you sure? I literally just spat my food back in there…" Adora admits sheepishly before she makes a move to get up, only to be stopped by Catra giving her a strange look, "What? I can get you another one. Just, wait here."

"Adora." Catra simply says with a small smile on her lips and then shakes her head, "It's fine. I'm not picky. Besides, it's not like you spat in there… uh, or deliberately put a loogie in there…"

"But it was in my mouth." Adora replies furrowing her brows, "I can get you another one."

Shaking her head once more, "Don't worry about it, princess."

"Are you sure?"

"Yeah." Catra confirms before looking over at the stall that she got the food from, "They'll be sold out before that line finishes."

"Oh." Adora looks over and her eyes widen at how many people are still lining up, "That's a really long line…"

"Yeah. It's a popular place." Catra shrugs as she cuts the dumpling in half with the spoon, blows on it and holds it out for Adora, "Here. It shouldn't burn you this time."

Adora stares at Catra and then at the spoon held up to her, "Are you… are you feeding me?"

"Yes." The magicat says and then waves the spoon around, "Now open up for the aeroplane."

"Stars!" Adora pulls back with a laugh, "Catra!"

“Open up!” Catra laughs as well, “I’m going to drop it, Adora!”

“Okay! Okay!” Adora grabs onto Catra’s wrist and lets the spoon into her mouth, no longer piping hot, but warm as she closes her eyes and hums out happily, “Mm… wow. This is so good.”

Catra grins, she scoops up the other half and pops it into her mouth and chews, pleasantly surprised with the taste and texture, ‘Wow… where has this been all my life?”

Adora giggles as Catra sits back with her eyes closed and continues to chew happily as she blurts out, “You’re so cute.”

“And you’re beautiful.” Catra throws back without opening her eyes, but knowing there’s definitely a blush on Adora’s cheek, she opens her eyes and sees Adora staring back her with a soft look, “More?”

“Yes, please!” Adora grins, “But you don’t have to feed me.”

“Yes, I do.” Catra replies stoically, “I can’t trust you with hot food apparently.”

“Technically, I can’t trust you with hot food either.” Adora teases back, the magicat tilting her head in question as Adora rolls her eyes to elaborate, “You spilt hot food all over… you know who.”

“That wasn’t an accident, though.” Catra argues.

“My point still stands.” Adora grins, “We can’t be trusted with hot food.”

The magicat sighs dramatically, “So, warm and lukewarm foods from now on?”

“And ice cream.” Adora adds with a laugh.

Catra grins back, “Are you even allowed to have ice cream? What with your diet and all.”

Adora sighs a little sadly, “No. I’m not allowed to.”

“Not allowed to?” Catra questions bemused, “According to who?”

“According to what.” Adora corrects, “And it’s according to the contract I signed.”

“You signed a contract that says you can’t have ice cream?” Adora nods and Catra is taken aback, “That’s a weird clause or condition to put in there…”

“I know.” Adora groans out, “I should have read the contract before I signed it. But I was just so excited about the work and well, yeah.”

“I thought you were famous or whatever before this two year contract thing.” The statement sound more like a question, “Surely when you renewed it you could have gotten that clause thrown out.”

Adora shrugs, “I’m not good with… stuff like that.”

“Stuff like what? Contracts?” Catra asks as she cuts up another dumpling and holds it out to Adora who politely refuses, “Is there something in your contract about dumplings?”

“I’m not supposed to be having anything high in carbs or fat.” Adora replies dejectedly, “Really takes all the fun out of going out, you know?”

“Yeah.” Catra tries again with the dumpling, “You only had half, princess. You’ve got to have at least one whole one.”

Adora chuckles under her breath, “You’re going to make me fat.”

“No, I’m not.” Catra replies and then says offhandedly, “I’ve got barely enough money to feed myself most days, so I don’t think you have anything to worry about.”

“Wait, what?!” Adora eyes widen as she pushes the spoon back to the magicat, “Catra. No. I can’t have you spending all your money on me. That’s… no. We’re not doing this.”

“Adora.” Catra puts the spoon back into the cup, “How I spend my money is my problem. And if I want to spend it on a you, then you should let me. Especially since I asked you out tonight.”

“Catra.” Adora tries again.

The magicat shakes her head and the gives Adora her most reassuring look as she can muster, “It’s really not that bad. I’ve got enough work not to starve.”

“But you go hungry.” Adora points out.

“And so do you.”

“But mine’s by choice. Well, contract, really.” Adora sighs, “I can’t have you spend all your money on me when you need it more. What about your other expenses?”

“This is teetering on like girlfriend territory, Adora.” Catra tries to lighten the situation, but it falls flat as Adora just looks at her with concern all over her face making the magicat a little uncomfortable, “It’s fine, Adora. Really.”

“I think you’re right.”

“About?”

“This venturing into girlfriend territory.” Adora says with a slight smile that Catra instantly mirrors, “Maybe we just focus on first date stuff?”

“Oh, definitely.” Catra agrees as she holds up the half a dumpling again, “And that includes me feeding you at least one whole dumpling.”

Adora snorts out a laugh, “You’re ridiculous.”

“Sure am.” Catra agrees readily, “Now, do I have to make the aeroplane noise again or are you going to be good and eat the other half of the dumpling?”

“Fine.” Adora huffs out playfully, finally accepting the rest of the dumpling and once again hums out happily at the taste.

Catra eats the rest in the cup, “I think it’s nearly time for that magic show on the main stage.”

“Oh!” Adora practically leaps up onto her feet, she grabs Catra’s hand and tugs it forward, the magicat snickers behind her, turning back she asks, “What are you laughing about?”

“I’m loving the confidence, princess.” Catra replies and then juts a thumb behind her, “But we’re going in the wrong direction. Stage is back that way.”

“Oh. Right!” Adora does a 180 and then tugs Catra in the right direction, the magicat speeding up to walk beside her, “I’m having a really good time, Catra.”

“Same.” The magicat squeezes Adora’s hand.

The streetlights illuminate the quiet streets now that they’ve left the festival and walk back to Adora’s place, hand in hand, the blonde playfully swinging their arms as they walk.

They walk in a comfortable silence, happy to bask in each other’s company as Adora’s building comes into sight.

They stop out the front, Frankie tipping his hat to them as they approach the doors that he opens for them, Catra walking Adora through the small lobby and towards the lift.

Adora stops just before they get to the lifts and turns to Catra, “I had a really good time tonight, Catra.”

“Me too.”

The blonde bites her bottom lip and stares up into Catra’s eyes, “Do you…? Would you…? Upstairs?”

“That’s more of a second or third date move.” Catra says much to Adora’s disappointment but at the same time relief as she wasn’t really ready to do more and didn’t want to place expectations for what it may mean. The magicat reaches out and places her hands on Adora’s waist, “But there is something that I’ve been thinking about all night…”

“Yeah?”

Catra nods, “Yeah.”

“And… what’s that?” Adora asks with a nervous but excited grin.

Leaning forward, Catra squeezes Adora’s hips and then whispers just as she’s a hair away from Adora’s lips, “Your number.”

Adora brows furrow before she feels Catra’s lips on hers.

The blonde gasps slightly before leaning into the kiss, humming happily before Catra’s lips pull back and she finds herself chasing and failing to catch them. Instead, she pouts, “Catra!”

The magicat chuckles, “Those kisses that you want are for the second or third date, princess.”

Adora grabs Catra by the collar of her suit jacket and kisses her like a second or third date, the magicat melting into it as the blonde pulls back and smirks, “That’s for being an ass.”

“If being an ass gets me those kinds of kisses…” Catra starts to say and Adora leans and presses a kiss on her cheek, making the magicat sigh happily.

“When can I see you again?” Adora asks shyly, despite the fact she initiated the other kisses.

“You’re such an idiot.” Catra shakes her head and then pulls out her old beat up phone and holds it out to Adora, “Can I grab your number first and then I can start planning the next one.”

“My treat next time.” Adora quickly declares, “And you are not allowed to pay for anything. Deal?”

Rolling her eyes, Catra sighs and agrees, “Deal.”

Adora takes Catra’s phone and puts her details in, sending herself a text before handing it back.

“Hey Adora?” Catra says as she pockets her phone once again.

“Hm?” The blonde hums back smiling.

“I really want to kiss you again.” Catra admits rubbing the back of her neck, “Would that…”

Adora doesn’t let her finish the question as she pulls Catra back in for another kiss.

As they part, Adora leans her forehead against Catra’s, “I like kissing you.”

A purr rumbles out from Catra’s chest, “Yeah, I like kissing you too.”

“No, you don’t understand, Catra.” Adora cups the magicat’s face, “I’ve kissed one person before you and I hated it. But with you…”

Catra’s purr gets louder, she tries to tamp it down but fails, instead she says, “I’m glad you don’t hate kissing me.”

Adora snorts out a laugh before bringing Catra back in for more kisses.

Eventually Adora reluctantly gets into the lift, waving Catra goodbye.

The magicat watches until the doors shut completely and the lift takes Adora higher up.

She turns and walks towards the exit.

Frankie tips his hat to her as he opens the door, “Thank you, sir.”

And just as he shuts the door he calls out, “Hey kid!”

Turning around to Frankie and quirking an eyebrow up at him, “Yeah?”

“Don’t fuck this up.” Frankie points his finger at Catra before he smiles at her, “Have a goodnight, Catra.”

Nodding, Catra smiles back, “Goodnight, Frankie.”

Meow

“There you are.” Catra looks down at Melog, “Adora was looking for you.”

Meow

“Yeah, I know bud.” Melog leaps up and perches himself on her shoulder, “I kissed her.”

Meow

“I know. She’s special.” Catra can’t stop the grin as she talks to Melog, “Think you want to make an appearance on our next date, bud?”

Meow

“Yeah, I know.” Sighing, Catra pets Melog on his head, he playfully swats at her hand as she laughs and then repeats, “I kissed her.”

Chapter End Notes

Girlfriend talk after one date?!
Slow burns? What slow burns? 😂

thanks for reading, kudos, bookmarking, subscribing and if you want, leave a comment.
I usually reply to comments when I post the next chapter 😁
I'm not ignoring you, promise.

I'm also working away for the rest of the week, so writing may or may not happen.
Depends on how tired I am from climbing...
Love working away on my birthday... not.

Chapter 4: Bars and Restaurants

Chapter Summary

Adora takes Catra out on the second date.

Chapter Notes

Enjoy!
Also, there's probably a bunch of spelling and grammar errors...
sorry!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora waits at the bar, she's in her white and gold hoodie and a loose pair of jeans paired with a pair of red and white boots, her hair is pulled back in a ponytail and her signature hair pouf on her head.

Her eyes are on her phone, scrolling through it while she waits for Catra to get off shift at the very same bar.

Her other hand on her glass of ice water, the condensation dripping down the side of the cup as her hand warms it.

She feels a tap on her shoulder and turns thinking it's Catra, only to find it's a guy, wearing a backwards blue cap, black tshirt with a band name she's never heard of and baggy black pants. She lifts her eyebrows in question but doesn't say a word.

"Hey." He says casually while leaning onto the side of the bar next to where Adora is seated, "Is this seat taken?"

Adora looks at the seat next to her. It's empty but she'd rather keep it that way since there are more than enough seats at the bar that are currently vacant.

She sighs, "Yeah, it is taken. Sorry."

The guy turns to look at his friends who seem to be snickering at him seemingly striking out as he doubles down on his efforts and goes for a different tact, this time asking, "What are you drinking?"

"Water." Adora replies boredly and then goes back to her phone.

"Hey. I'm talking to you." He says louder, getting frustrated at how things aren't going the way he wants it to, "Don't you know it's rude to look at your phone when someone is talking to you?"

Adora sighs loudly and very annoyed, "I told you I don't want you to sit there. Okay? Bye."

"No. That's not what you said." He argues, looking smugly at her like he's just won the argument, "You said it was taken. Not that you didn't want me to sit there."

"I'm not interested." Adora then says, "I don't want you to sit there and I don't want to talk to you. Please go away."

"We were just talking. No need to jump the gun." The guy arcs up acting all offended, "Geez, what is with you bitches? Always jumping to conclusions."

"Whatever." Adora grumbles under her breath and goes back to her phone and hoping he'll get the message and leave.

Except he doesn't leave. If anything, he seems determined and dense all at the same time.

"You're pretty. What's your name, pretty lady?" The guy throws out thinking he's being smooth as he continues leaning against the bar and stares intently at Adora, "I'm Cass. Short for Cassanova."

Adora rolls her eyes and sighs loudly again, deciding she doesn't want to waste her breath on him anymore.

“Hey! I’m talking to you.” The guy, Cass, repeats a little more aggressively, “Stop being rude, bitch!”

He reaches for the seat next to her to pull out when Catra comes out of nowhere and shoves him backwards, the magicat dressed up in her waiter attire despite the place being a bar, rasps out to him threateningly, “You’ve got a real pretty face. Bet your mouth would look good wrapped around my dick while I fuck your throat, bitch.”

“Fuck off, I’m not interested.” Cass growls back at Catra, his eyes go back to Adora, “I’m talking to her.”

“Well, I’m talking to you, asshole.” Catra steps in between Adora and Cass, she looks him up and down, “I’ve got an idea. You and me in the bathroom. My dick up your ass while you scream out my name like the little asshole you are. And if you’re good, I’ll even let you suck me off. What do you say?”

“Fuck off! Take a hint and leave me the fuck alone.” Cass glares as he takes a step back from the magicat, like distance is going to stop her, “What the fuck is wrong with you? I already told you to back the fuck off. Unless you want me and my friends to fuck you up.”

“Funny.” Catra laughs out, “Looks like you only understand hints when it’s happening to you, huh?”

“What the fuck are you talking about? We’re just talking, aren’t we?” Cass tries to get Adora on his side, “Tell her.”

“No, *we weren’t.* I’m not interested.” Adora repeats as she stands up behind Catra but doesn’t touch the magicat, “I don’t want to talk to you. Leave me alone.”

The magicat shrugs, “She’s not interested. And also, *we* were also just talking too. Or does it only work one way with assholes like you? Am I making you uncomfortable? Scared? Do you not want to be my cockwarmer?”

He stares at Catra, like the words are making sense but then he says, “Not the same thing. I’m not into that sick shit. I wasn’t even…”

“Yes. It is. It’s exactly the same fucking thing, dickhead.” Catra growls out this time, “And if you don’t want me to make good on me having a good time with your mouth and asshole, you better get the fuck out of here. And if I see you in here again, well… I should also mention my friends don’t take kindly to people like you.”

And at that moment, Scorpia, Perfuma and Huntara step out from behind the bar and stand behind Catra and Adora, their presence terrifying for Cass and his friends as Huntara crosses her arms over her singlet covered chest and flexes her huge biceps before literally snarling at them to leave.

Cass backs up a step.

And then two.

And then falls over backwards as he tries to run out only to be pulled back by Huntara by the back of his tshirt, making him yelp out in fear.

“You haven’t paid for your drinks.” Huntara not so gently reminds him.

“Okay! Okay! Here!” Cass reaches into his pocket and pulls out his wallet, throwing a wad of cash on the bar without counting it, cowering in fear as Huntara stares at the cash and then back at him, “Please don’t kill me!”

Huntara throws her head back and laughs loudly, “Kill you?”

Cass seems to relax a little at hearing that and then almost shrieks when she turns him around and leans in so close that their foreheads nearly bump, “PLEASE! I’m sorry! I’ll never come back! We’ll never come back! I swear!”

“Good.” Huntara grins, all sharp teeth and a look that could kill, “Because maiming comes with less time but a lot of paperwork.”

“Huntara.” Perfuma sings out to the larger woman, “Please don’t kill or maim. I don’t want to clean blood off the bar surfaces again.”

“I could hurt him without him bleeding… outwardly.” Huntara says without looking at the wiry blonde in a pink dress that looks more like a night gown than something that should be worn in a bar of all places, before turning back to Cass, “I hear that’s almost a fate worse than death… want to try?”

“No! Please!” Cass is practically sobbing in Huntara’s grip.

“Not good enough.” Catra grumbles, “And I wanted to see flower girl peg him.”

“Wildcat!” Scorpia says aghast.

The magicat rolls her eyes to indicate she wasn’t being serious.

Huntara takes this opportunity to teach Cass a lesson in life, “Next time if a woman or man or anyone at all, tells you no or they’re not interested, you walk away. Got it?”

Cass nods quickly, his eyes red from crying.

“And if I hear or see you not doing that…” Huntara tightens her grip on him, “Being pegged by a magicat is going to be the least of your problems. Understand?”

“Yes! Yes! I’m sorry!” Cass cries out as Huntara shoves him back, he tumbles onto the floor once more and then looks at Adora, “I’m sorry, miss! I’m… I’m going to go!”

The group watch as Cass runs out, his friends quickly reach for their wallets and drops cash onto the table before rushing out after their friend.

Once the door is shut, Huntara and Catra break out in a cackle.

Perfuma walks over and collects all the money left behind and then returns to the group, “You two are terrifying. But I love you.”

“I didn’t even get to shock them with my powers!” Scorpia whines.

“Yeah, because every time you do that, someone also pisses themselves.” Catra points out.

“I’m not cleaning up piss.” Huntara quickly declares, “No thanks. I’ll leave that to you and Perfuma.”

“Sorry sweetie. As much as I hate to admit it, they’re right.” Perfuma pats Scorpia on the shoulder, “It is a rather unfortunate consequence to getting shocked.”

“Well, feel free to shock bad people outside.” Catra suggests, “Nature will clean it up that way and not Huntara… ow!”

“I’m not cleaning up piss!” Huntara reiterates punching Catra lightly on the arm before looking over at Adora and grinning, “Hey, kid, quit being rude and introduce us to your girlfriend.”

Catra blushes.

Adora blushes.

Scorpia looks at the pair confused.

Perfuma hums out happily.

The magicat clears her throat and introduces the blonde, “This is Adora. And she’s not my girlfriend… yet.”

Adora whips her head to look at Catra smile goofily back at her, “Yet?”

“Well, we’ve only had one date. You might still want to back out of this, now that you’ve met my friends and sometimes coworkers.”

Catra rubs the back of her neck nervously like she's expecting Adora to reject her outright, "Most uh, most people do."

"I'm not backing out." Adora says confidently before turning to the rest of the group, "Hi, I'm Adora. Catra's girlfriend."

Catra almost chokes on air as Adora smirks at her, Scorpia patting her on the back to help and all the magicat can hoarsely say is, "Cool."

"Hi Adora." Perfuma greets back warmly, "I'm Perfuma. That's Scorpia. She's my girlfriend and future wife. And Huntara, my ex."

"Uh." Adora looks between the Catra's friends and waves to them dorkily, "It's really nice to meet Catra's friends."

"Wildcat. You don't have to wear that to work here. We can give you a uniform." Scorpia eyes the orange stain on Catra's white shirt.

"There is no uniform." Catra replies, "And all your clothes are huge or floral."

"Kid, we can take you shopping." Huntara offers, "I know the best spot to get muscle shirts."

"No, thanks." Catra politely declines, "I know that place. And it's pricey as fuck with less material."

Huntara laughs, "More than happy to get you a shirt or two, kid. Show off those furry arms of yours."

"Nope!" Catra quickly replies but there's a grateful smile on her face as Perfuma nudges the magicat and shoves the cash Cass and his friends left behind into her hands, "Perfuma… I can't…"

"You can." Perfuma replies firmly, "Have a good date, you two."

Catra looks between her friends and tries to keep the tears at bay as she nods, her voice shaky as she says softly, "Thank you."

Not wanting to watch the magicat fall apart, Huntara claps her hands together, "Back to work!"

"Hey, I'm the boss! I get to say that!" Perfuma pouts.

"Then go for it, boss lady." Huntara smirks while Scorpia glares at her, "Relax, Scorp. She's yours. I'm just messing with you."

"Good. Because I love Perfuma." Scorpia declares proudly.

"I love you too, Scorpy!" Perfuma brings the scorpini woman in and kisses her before clapping her hands together and getting serious, "Get back to work everyone!"

Not a second later, she's giggling into her hands as she pushes Huntara and Scorpia back to their posts to get back to work.

"Ready to go?" Catra asks, tucking the cash into her pant pocket.

"Yes." Adora smiles, grabbing Catra's free hand and waving to the magicat's friends before they exit out of the bar, "It's my turn to take you out."

Catra chuckles, nodding behind her, "Whatever you want, princess."

At the movies

"I hope you don't think this is too cliché for our date." Adora says shyly as they walk into lobby of the movie theatre, the smell of popcorn fills the air as a loud movie trailer plays on the screen, "Is there anything you want to see?"

"It's not cliché, Adora. Streaming a show and *chilling* would be cliché." Catra says after her eyes finish taking in everything inside, from the bright lights, the smells and the sounds, she smiles at

the blonde, “I haven’t been to movies since… wow, I can’t even remember the last time I came to one of these as a legitimate patron.”

Adora gives the magicat a questioning look and then asks, “A legitimate patron? Like…”

“I snuck in or was snuck in. Take a pick.” Catra shrugs and then laughs, “Almost never got caught.”

Adora looks around concerned before she turns back to Catra, “You’re not on some kind of banned watchlist, are you?”

“Uh, no? I don’t think so.” Catra scratches the back of her left ear, “Pretty sure all the theatres I used to sneak into aren’t there anymore. I’ve never been to this one before.”

“Oh. Okay. So, we should be okay here, right?” Adora bites her bottom lip still a little concerned, “We’re not going to get kicked out, are we?”

“No.” Catra assures with a chuckle, “Like I said, I’ve never been to this movie theatre before so I can’t exactly get banned if I’ve not done anything wrong… yet.”

Adora’s eyes widen, “Yet?”

“I’m joking. I’ll behave. Promise. Probably.” Catra puts a hand over her heart, “Okay, what movie are we seeing?”

“I thought we could pick something together.” Adora suggests brushing a loose strand of hair that’s fallen on her face behind her ear, “Just as long as it’s not horror.”

“Not into scary movies, princess?” The magicat asks with a slight grin as Adora shakes her head, “So, romance or comedy?”

“Not action?” Adora raises an eyebrow up at the magicat.

“Nope.” Catra shrugs the genre off, “I get enough ‘action’ daily and not the fun kind that involves you in bed.” Adora blushes at that as Catra continues, “I would rather take my mind off all of that. So… romance or comedy?”

“How about a romantic comedy?” Adora looks up at the screens displaying what movies are playing, “We can do dinner before or after depending on the time of the movie.”

“Okay, now this is more like a cliché kind of date.” Catra jests before grabbing Adora’s hands, “Still, romantic though.”

“Yeah?” Adora perks up, “You really think so?”

“Well, as long as I get to make out with you when the lights go dark.” The magicat says and then laughs, letting go of Adora’s hands in the process, Adora’s face flushes red again with a blush at the comment, “It’s okay. I can wait until I walk you home, princess.”

“Someone’s a romantic.” Adora hums out with a smile so bright it makes Catra lose her words for a moment, “So… romantic comedy then?”

“Sure.”

“Okay.” Adora nods, taking Catra’s outstretched hand as they walk to purchase tickets, the blonde adds, “Get whatever snacks you want to. My treat.”

“Are you going to eat any of those snacks with me?” Catra tilts her head as she asks Adora, “Or am I going to be eating them all on my lonesome while you watch me with hungry eyes?”

“I’ll have some.” Adora replies cooly.

“What about dinner?”

“What *about* dinner?” The blonde tilts her head in question, knowing which territory this line of questioning is heading towards

and sighs, waiting for Catra to ask.

“Are you going to be able to eat dinner with me?” the magicat probes a little more, “Or are you going to be staring at me while I eat while you probably pick at your *salad* and look longingly at my food?”

“I’m not going to do that.” Adora rolls her eyes and huffs, but she’s grateful that Catra’s wording is much more tactful than she’d expected, “I can eat dinner. I just need to log it is all.”

“Okay. Cool. Good to know. I look forward to dinner later.” Catra says sincerely as Adora pays for the tickets and then drags the magicat to the concession stand, “Well, what do you feel like?”

“Popcorn, definitely.” Adora closes her eyes and takes a happy breath in, the smell of popcorn stronger from where they are currently standing since the machine is practically in front of them, “You can pick anything else that you want for the movie.”

“Drinks?” The magicat looks at the pricing, “Looks cheaper if we get the deal. But it just means we won’t be sharing.”

“I don’t think I can handle all of that by myself. We can get the jumbo combo instead.” Adora suggests with a grin, “Then you can pretend not to touch my hand when we go for the popcorn at the same time.”

Catra laughs out, “Like I would pretend.”

“No?”

“I like you, Adora.” The magicat admits freely, “I’m willing to take anything you’ll give me.”

“Oh.”

“But no pressure.” Catra adds, “We move as fast or slow as you want.”

“Okay.” Adora nods as she turns to the attendant and orders the jumbo popcorn and soft drink, leaning over and pressing a soft kiss on Catra’s lips, “Thank you.”

“Yeah, anytime.” Catra grins back adding, “I mean it though. I’m not going to rush you into anything.”

“Come on, the movie is starting soon.” Adora smiles softly back at the magicat before she hands over the popcorn to Catra, while she grabs the drink and then takes Catra’s hand once more, “We’re in cinema 3. We should get going, movie is starting in ten minutes.”

“Lead the way, princess.” Catra says taking a sip from the drink in Adora’s hand.

Adora squeezes Catra’s hand and smiles back at her, “This way.”

Cinema 3

The movie is… not as romantic or even funny as advertised.

Catra could see the way Adora cringed at one of the jokes that the magicat leant over and asked, “Wanna get out of here? Grab dinner instead?”

“Stars, yes.” Adora whispers back quickly as Catra gets up, pulling Adora up with her as they hightail it out of the awful movie.

“That. Was truly terrible.” Catra declares.

Nodding, Adora and groans out disappointingly, “I can’t believe I paid full price for that terrible movie.”

“No wonder the theatre was practically empty.” Catra points out, “I’m glad we ate most of the popcorn already though.”

“Yeah.” Adora sighs and then smiles over at Catra, “Oh well, means we can get an earlier dinner.”

“Great.” The magicat grins back, “Where are you taking me for dinner, princess?”

“Where do you want to go?” Adora asks back.

“Nope. You’re taking me out tonight. You pick.” The reply has Adora rolling her eyes as Catra adds, “I’m also not giving you any hints.”

“Catra!” Adora whines out dramatically as they step out of the venue and back outside into the cool afternoon air, the blonde tries again, “Okay, what don’t you want?”

Knowing this was coming, Catra tugs Adora along, “And here I thought you had this date all planned out.”

“I do!” Adora quickly retorts before slumping forward dejectedly, “But I might have forgotten to book anything… as I forgot to ask if there was anything you couldn’t eat…”

Chuckling, Catra squeezes Adora’s hand, “It’s fine, Adora. My shirt is still messed up so anything fancy would have gotten me refused entry.”

“What time is it?” Adora asks and Catra looks at the time on her phone, showing the blonde, “Oh, it’s still really early.”

“Yeah.”

“Why is that bar open so early?” Adora thinks out loud to herself.

“It’s more like a bar bistro kind of set up.” Catra replies, “They’ve got a killer seniors menu starting at three in the afternoon for the oldies. And then they stay open later for the dinner rush.”

“What time do they usually open until?” Adora asks as Catra leads the way.

“Ten most nights and later Friday and Saturdays. They’ve usually got a band or DJ on Friday and Saturday nights. There’s stuff on pretty much every night.” The magicat answers, “And they are closed on Mondays.”

Adora nods and then bites her bottom lip thinking back to earlier that afternoon.

Catra notices and squeezes Adora’s hand again, “Something on your mind?”

“Kind of.” Adora continues to bite her bottom lip, “Just about before. At the bar.”

“I’m sorry that creep harassed you, Adora.” Catra quickly says, “I should have caught it earlier…”

“It’s not your fault, Catra.” Adora pulls the magicat to a stop so she can wrap her arms around Catra’s shoulders, “Besides, I thought it was pretty badass what you did. Flip the script on him. He looked so scared.”

They both chuckle at the memory as Catra says, “It looked like he was going to piss his pants when Huntara grabbed him.”

Adora hums back and nods, “She is quite… scary.”

“Who? Hunt?” Catra grins as Adora nods again, “Yeah, she is. Definitely is, if you get on her bad side.”

Adora laughs, “Well, I’ll be sure not to get on her bad side.”

“She’s also a really big flirt when it comes to pretty girls.” Catra points out, “I’m surprised she didn’t put the moves on you.”

“She might have…” Adora admits quietly and then whips her head around when she hears Catra growl, smirking over at the magicat, “Did you just… did you just growl?”

“No. Shut up.” Catra looks away sheepishly at letting that sound out, she clenches her jaw and under her breath, the magicat grumbles, “Unbelievable…”

This time Adora giggles at hearing that, “I told her I was with you. And she was very polite and backed off.”

“Good.” Catra breathes out before she realises what Adora just said, “Wait, you told her, you were with me?”

“Yeah…?” Adora replies with a shy smile, “Like… your girlfriend.”

“Hold up.” Catra says as she collects her thoughts, “Did you tell her you were my girlfriend, so she’d back off or…?”

Adora just smiles back the magicat before she answers, “Uh, yes and no…”

Catra raises her eyebrows at the blonde.

“I did and I didn’t.” Adora says making it no more obvious, “I did want it to be true too.”

“At the same time as making a statement to tell Huntara to back off.” Catra surmises, she can’t stop the trill that escapes from her chest and she doesn’t bother tampering it down, even with the cooing look that Adora is giving her, chuckling, the magicat says, “Wow, one date and I’ve already snagged myself a girlfriend. How lucky am I?”

“Very lucky.” Adora preens with a smirk and then declares, “It’s a privilege.”

Catra shakes her head, drawing a confused look from the blonde, “Not a privilege.”

“No?”

“No.” Catra repeats before pulling Adora into her, eyes fixed on one another’s and leaning close enough for their lips to touch as

she whispers out, “It’s an absolute honour.”

Without closing the gap, Adora’s eyes soften, “I think I’m really the lucky one here.”

“Why’s that?”

“Because I’ve found you.” Adora says, “Or was saved by a hot tray of curry.”

Catra looks down at her still stained orange shirt and grins back, “Totally worth it. And I’d do it again.”

“I know.” Adora nods before leaning in and kissing Catra chastely on the lips, “Mm… I’ve never had a girlfriend before…”

“Really?”

“Yes, really.” The blonde shyly answers, “Apart from my friends, I haven’t had a good run with… potential partners.”

“That sucks, princess.” Catra admits.

“Yeah, it did.” Adora agrees with a sigh, “But then I met you…”

The magicat ears perk up and Adora’s eyes flick up to see them swivel around her head as Catra straightens up, she places both hands on Adora’s hips and declares, “From this day forward, I will try to make your romantic experiences far better than any you’ve ever had.”

“That sounds terrible.” Adora laughs at the wording, “Also that’s a really low bar.”

“We move at your pace.” Catra brushes past Adora’s comment, “I only want you to be happy. And if you ever find yourself unhappy, then let me know.”

“You’re an idiot.” Adora simply says as she pulls Catra in for a kiss.

Catra purrs out, “Probably. But you’re an idiot too.”

“I’m your idiot.” Adora replies back with a chuckle, “I’m hungry.”

“I know the perfect place.” Catra says, “Come on, it’s just this way.”

Dinner

The tables are covered in red and white checkered tablecloths, surrounded by sturdy wooden chairs and soft music playing overhead as Catra stands at the sigh that says, *Please wait to be seated.*

The restaurant is busy but there’s still a few tables empty, though those tables haven’t been cleared of plates or cups as of yet as Adora looks around and sees that most of the people have plates of pasta in front of them accompanied by glasses of red wine.

“Catra.” Adora looks around nervsoulsy, “I can’t eat most what’s in here…”

“Because it’s a pasta place?” Catra asks and Adora nods, the magicat chuckles, “They also have other stuff too. *I’m* here for the pasta. You can grab something else on the menu, it’s a pretty extensive menu, two pages worth.”

“Catra.” A woman with blue hair, dark skin and dressed in a teal singlet and matching pants drawls, “Your shirt’s gross.”

“The curry won’t come out, Mermista.” Catra pulls at her shirt and picks at the orange stain with her claws, “I’ve tried everything.”

“Give it to me. I’ll get it out.” Mermista holds her hand out before she takes notice of Adora, “Also, who’s the beautiful woman standing next to you?”

“I’m not taking off my shirt in public again.” Catra says with a roll of her eyes, “Also, don’t. This beautiful woman standing next to me is Catra-sexual now.”

Adora giggles, “I’m Adora. And it’s true.”

The blonde holds out her hand and Mermista just stares at it with a raised eyebrow, “Yeah, gross no.”

“Cut it out, Mermy.” Catra grunts out, “Be nice to my girlfriend.”

“Girlfriend?” Mermista’s eyes widen before a smirk sits firmly on her lips and her eyes turn back to Adora and shakes her hand, “My bad, blondie. Also, you’re not gross, obviously.”

“Well, you did call me beautiful before.” Adora points out with a blush.

“She’s a worse flirt than Huntara.” Catra mumbles out before she goes back to Mermista, “Can we get service or are you going to pay me to work for my food?”

“Hm…” Mermista decides to draw this out and hum to herself in thought, “Depends, Wildcat.”

“On?”

“Are you paying or singing for your food tonight?” Mermista smirks once more as she waits for Catra to answer, “Seahawk has been going off his nut about doing another sea shanties greatest hits duet with you.”

“I’m paying.” Adora pipes up, even putting her hand up to stress the point, “Yeah, I’m paying. It’s my treat today.”

Mermista tilts her head at the blonde and then grins, “Finally. Wildcat’s got a sugar momma!”

“What?!” Adora says in shock.

“What? No!” Catra almost shouts at the same time.

Mermista bursts out laughing at the pair, “Stars. You two are way too easy to rile up.”

Catra growls at the blue haired woman.

“Oh, fuck off, Wildcat.” Mermista rolls her eyes, “Follow.”

Adora looks to Catra, the magicat shrugs but follows Mermista further in until they get to their table, situated right next to the window overlooking the ocean. The tables around them empty.

Catra quickly moves to pull out Adora’s chair, the blonde nods back in thanks as she takes a seat while the magicat shrugs off her jacket and places it on the back of her chair before holding out a menu to Adora.

Mermista watches the whole thing, leaning in towards the magicat, “Whipped much?”

Catra just grins back, “Speaking from experience, Merms?”

“Touche.” Mermista concedes before straightening back up, “I’ll be back with bibs and water for the table.”

They watch as Mermista walks away, Adora looks to Catra, “Bibs?”

“I get a little messy eating pasta.” Catra admits sheepishly, “Kind of gets everywhere.”

The answer makes Adora giggle, she leans in, “I can’t wait to see that.”

The magicat groans but there’s a smile on her lips, “You better watch out too. It. Gets. Everywhere.”

Adora just grins back as she opens the menu.

“Here you go.” Mermista returns with their orders, “Your pasta, Wildcat. Extra saucy.”

The magicat licks her lips hungrily and grabs her fork in readiness as Mermista sets down the plate in front of her.

“And your steak, medium-rare with steamed vegetables, no sauce.” Mermista says placing it down in front of Adora, “Oh, and before I forget.” She reaches into her back pocket, “Bibs.”

“YES!” Catra practically snatches one out of Mermista’s hand and throws it on before picking back up her fork and grinning widely.

“Cute.” Mermista simply says as Adora takes the bib offered to her and places it in her lap, the blue haired woman looks over at her, “I’d put that on. Wildcat is a *very, very, very* messy eater when it comes to pasta.”

“It’s true.” Catra says waiting diligently for Adora put the bib on before she proceeds to demolish her meal.

“I’m going to get Seahawk to get the mop and bucket ready for when you guys are done.” Mermista says as she walks away to serve other patrons, “The man sure loves to mop.”

“Makes him feel like he’s a deckhand on his own ship.” Catra calls out after her, the other woman doesn’t bother replying or reacting. The magicat chuckles as she turns to Adora, “Seriously, princess. I don’t want to get you dirty with how messy I’m going to be.”

“Surely, it can’t be that bad…” Adora says as she puts the bib and then looks down at herself, “I feel ridiculous.”

“You shouldn’t.” Catra smiles, “Look around you.”

Adora does.

“See how there’s no one on any of the tables around us?” Adora nods, “That’s the *splash radius* according to Merms.”

“So, what you’re telling me, is that I’m in the firing line.” Adora surmises and Catra nods, “Okay, well, then after dinner you’re coming back to my place so we can get cleaned up.”

Catra mrrps, “Uh…”

“Plus, I maybe want to do some other… second date things too.” Adora shyly says, a blush coming over her cheeks.

Catra smiles back as she says leaning forward, “At your pace, princess.”

Chapter End Notes

2nd part of the date will be next.
I'm thinking... dropping it around valentines day?
We'll see.

thanks for reading, commenting, kudos, bookmarking and subscribing.

Chapter 5: Date part 2

Chapter Summary

Date part 2.

Chapter Notes

I made it! 20mins to spare on V day!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra eating pasta is… chaotic.

Sauce goes everywhere.

EVERYWHERE.

Lucky for Adora, the magicat manages not to splash her too much, apart from a few spots on the white bib covering Adora's hoodie.

The magicat looks up with a mischievous grin, "Probably shouldn't have worn white, huh?"

"Are you talking about me or you?" Adora laughs as she looks at her bib, "Thank the stars for this bib, huh?"

"Well, my shirt is already fucked." Catra replies looking down at her sauced up bib and then under at the orange stain still there from the curry, she shrugs, "Pretty sure Hunt said she'd get me a new shirt."

"A muscle shirt. To show off your furry arms, if I recall." Adora giggles and then looks at the magicat's covered arms, her long sleeved white shirt not giving anything away as she puts her utensils down and then leans her chin on her hand, staring at Catra's arm, "I wouldn't mind seeing what's underneath those sleeves…"

Catra looks up, sauce now covering the fine fur on her face and somehow also on her ears, she grins teeth and all, "Just under my sleeves, princess?"

Adora blushes but nods, shifting a little and picking up her knife and fork once more to continue eating, and right before she puts a piece of potato into her mouth she says, "Maybe more…"

"I'm happy to show you everything, Adora." Catra says as she loads up her fork with more pasta, "Just whenever you're ready."

Nodding, Adora pops the potato into her mouth and chews, she clears her throat, "Hey, can I ask you something?"

"Sure." Catra replies with a mouthful of pasta, grabbing a napkin and wiping her face, "What's on your mind?"

The blonde puts down her fork and knife again, "Before, at the bar…"

"Hm." Catra hums back as she takes a sip of her water and sits back now done with her pasta, plate clean of everything as she sighs out happily sated.

"You said…" Adora looks away as she pauses and bites her bottom lip.

"I said?"

"You said to that guy, well more like threatened him…" Adora says furrowing her brows, trying to think how to ask the question that's on her mind, "Um… is it, like, true?"

"Which part?"

"You know…" Adora looks at Catra like the magicat should understand her question.

"I really don't." Catra sits back and grins.

“Ugh! Catra!” Adora groans out, “You know what I’m asking.”

“I do?” the magicat pretends not to know, “What are you trying to ask me, Adora?”

Adora glares at the magicat playfully, her eyes trailing down Catra’s body until she can’t see past the table, “I’ll…I’ll ask you later.”

“Okay.” Catra continues to grins, “I’m going to go and wash my face. Be right back.”

“Okay.” Adora replies as she goes back to her dinner when someone slides into Catra’s seat, “Uh, hi…?”

“Hey.” Mermista drawls boredly as she pushes Catra’s empty plate forward and then wipes the table down enough for her to put her elbows down without getting sauce on them, “So, I know you.”

“You… do?” Adora asks as she continues to eat, chewing away as Mermista just stares at her. The blonde swallows down her last bite, “Is… is there something on my face?”

Mermista raises an eyebrow before her eyes glint in realisation, “Oh, that’s where you’re from.”

“O-kay.” Adora pushes her plate forward and takes her glass of water and then takes off the bib.

“Why are you with Wildcat?” Mermista just asks, there’s no accusation in her tone just, bored, she sits back and wait for an answer, pretending she doesn’t care.

The question stumps Adora, who slowly places the dirtied bib on top of her now finished plate.

The silence stretches between the pair.

Mermista not giving anything away.

Eventually, Adora folds.

“I like her.” Adora replies with a blush, “She’s… I don’t know how to describe it. But… she makes me, happy. Safe. Like I’ve known her in another life and we were close.”

“That’s a lot of feelings, blondie.” Mermista replies looking at her nails, but there’s a small smile on her lips, almost like she approves, the blue haired woman turns to Adora, both hands on the table, “She likes you.”

“I know.” Adora says in almost a whisper, “And it’s scary.”

“Don’t be.” Mermista leans forward, “She’s safe. Protective. Loyal.”

Adora looks up at Mermista to see if she’s telling the truth, the blue haired woman stares right back, the seriousness in her eyes has Adora nodding, “I know. She was all that before I even knew her name.”

“The shirt.”

Adora nods.

“I’ll get her a new one.” Mermista says before lowering her voice, “Don’t tell her.”

“Why?”

Mermista sits back and looks around, “I have a reputation to protect.”

Adora just looks at Mermista confused.

The blue haired woman stands up, her whole demeanour changes, “Are you done?”

“What?”

“Your plates.” Mermista says while picking them up anyways, “I’ll bring you some menus for dessert.”

“Uh…” And before Adora can decline, Mermista’s already wiped down their table, taken all the empty plates, dirty napkins and bibs away.

“Hey, that was quick.” Catra returns to her seat to find the table clean and cleared, “She sure is efficient.”

“Yeah.” Adora nods, “She’s bringing menus back for dessert.”

“Oh, sweet!” Catra grins widely and Adora can’t help but mirror it, “They’ve got some really good stuff here. What do you feel like?”

Adora bites her bottom lip, “I’m not sure I’m allowed to have any.”

“Right. Because of your contract.” Catra’s ears fold down against her head, “It’s cool, Adora. We don’t have to have dessert.”

“No, don’t deprive yourself because of me. Please.” Adora insists, “Just because I can’t have it, doesn’t mean you shouldn’t get to.”

“It’s no fun eating sweets by myself.” Catra grumbles out and then sighs, “What about fruit? Can you have fruit?”

“Not this late.” Adora sheepishly says, “I’m not supposed to have sugar this late.”

“Oh.” Catra replies as Mermista returns with two menus, the magicat reaches out to the blue haired woman arm, “I think we might give dessert a miss tonight, Mermy. My stomach is doing the funny thing again…”

“Get out.” Mermista orders, “I don’t need you puking in here again, Wildcat.”

Catra throws Adora a quick wink and then scampers out of the restaurant, leaving Adora there with Mermista and the menus on the table, “I uh, better go after her…” Adora says standing up, reaching for her wallet, “How much was dinner?”

Mermista rolls her eyes, signalling for Adora to follow her to the till, handing her the bill, “Here you go.”

“That’s it?” Adora looks over the bill with a frown, “You’ve discounted this massively.”

Mermista shrugs as Adora pulls out cash from her wallet and places it on the counter and the blue haired woman grins.

“That should cover it.” Adora nods with a smile before heading for the door.

As she’s about to exit, Mermista drawls out, “Don’t be a stranger, *car-girl.”*

Adora laughs, “I won’t.” she waves to Mermista as she leaves, the door shutting behind her as she goes to find Catra.

“Hey. Are you alright?” Adora asks as she finds Catra waiting for her by a wooden bench, “How are you feeling?”

“Great.” Catra replies with a grin, “I faked the stomach thing.”

“Why?” Adora furrows her brows as she steps closer to the magicat.

“Because.” Catra puts her hands on Adora’s waist, “Mermista would not let you leave without dessert and I didn’t want her to guilt trip you into something you didn’t want to do.”

“Oh.”

“Yeah, I can get something later if I still feel like it.” The magicat shrugs before taking one of Adora’s hands and looking the blonde up and down, “The bib really worked it’s magic.”

“Or you have very accurate sauce splashing.” Adora laughs to herself, “Not a drop of sauce on my hoodie.”

“I’m glad.” Nodding, Catra looks forward, “Can I walk you home?”

“Yes.” Adora turns around and presses her lips on Catra’s in a soft kiss, “Walk me home.”

A dopey grin appears on Catra’s face at the sudden kiss, she shakes herself out of her stupor, “Uh, yeah. Let’s go.”

“Are you okay?” Adora quirks an eyebrow up at the magicat, the dopey smile reappearing on her face and she can’t help but smile back.

“I’m just… happy.” Catra admits, “And I don’t think I’m ever going to get used to you kissing me.”

“I like kissing you.” The admission has her trilling out, Adora’s hand squeezing Catra’s lightly, reassuringly, “I wasn’t looking for anything. Actually, I’d been put off finding someone for so long because it all seemed like such hard work. But with you…”

Catra glances over to Adora to see the slight blush on her face as she lets the blonde continue.

“But with you it just seems so much easier.” Adora finishes, “Like I don’t need to someone else.”

“You don’t need to be someone else, Adora.” The magicat says softly, “You’re perfect just the way you are. And no one can change that.”

“See?” Adora finds herself pressing her lips against Catra’s again, “You make it so easy for me to just be me. No expectations. No judgements.”

“That’s not entirely true.” Catra rubs the back of her neck.

“What do you mean?”

“I do judge.” The magicat replies looking down, “I don’t like your contract conditions.”

“Is this about the food stuff?” Catra nods and Adora sighs, “It’s not forever.”

“Doesn’t take forever to screw up your body, princess.” Catra counters a little more harshly than she meant to, “Sorry. It’s just…”

Adora swallows down the nervous feeling in her throat, “Just what?”

“I just don’t agree with it.” Catra finally says.

“I’m not starving myself, Catra.” Adora reassures, “I’m just eating healthier, didn’t my dinner prove that?”

Conceding, Catra nods, “Yeah, I guess you’re right.”

“Take a look at the contract if you want. Would that help you feel better?” Adora offers.

“You’d let me go through your contract?” Adora nods, “Just like that?”

“Yes.” Adora smiles back as she tugs the magicat forward once more, “If it’d make you feel better that I’m not actively starving myself. Which I’m not.”

“I mean, if it’s cool with you…” Catra says, “I’ve got a knack for contracts and legal jargon and all that.”

“Do you now?” Adora grins over at the magicat, “Are you actually a lawyer that’s just lost too many cases?”

“I wish.” Catra laughs, “No. No one would hire a magicat to be their lawyer.”

“Why not?”

“I’d be an utter sideshow.” The magicat replies self depreciatingly, “And I’m not good with my emotions as you probably already

know.”

“You’re passionate.” Adora corrects, “And you care about the people you love.”

Catra looks away, “And it’s gotten me into more trouble more times than I can count.”

“And has any of those things stuck?” Adora asks, “Or was it like when security cleared you when I met you?”

“Are you sure this is something you want to be a part of? I’m a short fuse.” Catra warns, “Bad things seem to follow me.”

“You don’t scare me.” Adora declares, “You’ve already proven who you are to me the first time I met you. That’s all I need to know about you.”

“Really?”

“Yes, really.”

Catra smiles widely, “Most people see me and think the worst of me just because of what I am.”

“That’s unfair.” Adora breathes out, “You’ve got a big heart, Catra. I’ve seen it.”

“So do you.” Catra replies back, “You’ve let me in. And not many people do.”

“That’s not true.” Adora squeezes Catra’s hand, “It seems like many people do. I’ve already met so many of them today and they all have nothing but good things to say about you. But me? I’ve got my two best friends and that’s it.”

“Well, you’ve got me and my friends now too.” Catra says, “If you’re happy with the bunch of people I call my friends, I guess.”

Adora giggles, “Come on, you really need to get cleaned up. You’ve got pasta sauce everywhere.”

“I know. I even tried to clean myself up in the bathroom back at the restaurant.” Catra groans out dramatically, “But I can’t help it. It’s too good.”

“You’re really cute.” Adora nudges Catra playfully with her shoulder.

“I’m not cute…” Catra grumbles under her breath, “You’re the model here.”

“Doesn’t mean I’m wrong.” The blonde laughs out, “And you’re even cuter when you deny it.”

“What can I do to shut you up?” Catra rolls her eyes in jest.

“You can kiss me.” Adora smiles back.

“Then, that’s exactly what I’ll do.” Catra grabs Adora by the hips and brings her down enough so the magicat can kiss her properly, the blonde melting into it, humming even as Catra grins into the kiss before pulling back, “Hold on, princess.”

A little dazed, Adora’s eyes flutter open, “Hm?”

“You can come out now.” Catra says loudly and Adora just looks at her confused until…

Meow

“Melog!” Adora crouches down and holds her hand out for Melog to come over for pets, “Hi!”

Meow

"Awe! So cute!" Adora coos when Melog sniffs her hand and then starts to rub against it before winding around her legs, "Hi Melog! I missed you!"

Catra just watches with a smile on her face as Melog accepts the chin scritches before he eventually walks over to the magicat, looking up at her like he's already planning something. Catra crouches down slightly, "Up you get, bud."

Melog leaps up and onto her shoulder, settling himself, perched perfectly balanced on Catra's shoulder.

"Has he been hiding this whole time?" Adora asks as they start walking back to her place again.

"No idea." Catra turns to Melog, "What do you do when you're out and about bud?"

Meow

"What did he say?" Adora asks.

"No idea." Catra shrugs, "He just mumbled a whole bunch of nonsense."

Laughing, Adora slaps Catra playfully on her other shoulder before she thinks about whether or not she's allowed to have animals in her apartment, "Do you think Melog would want to come up?"

"To your place?"

Adora nods, "Yeah."

Catra looks to Melog and then back to Adora, “Nah, I wouldn’t bring him up to your place. He’s got a tendency to not leave once he finds somewhere better. And I’m betting that your place is going to be a lot better than my place.”

“Your place can’t be *that* bad.” Adora says unsurely, “Right?”

“Uh, it’s home.” Catra says not giving anything away, “Maybe further down the track I’ll show you it. But for now, I’d rather not have you see where or how I live. If that’s okay?”

“I get it.” Adora nods, “But I also want you to know that I’m not going to judge you for the way you live, Catra.”

“I know, but it’s still…” The magicat sighs, “I’m not ready for you to see that part of me just yet.”

“Okay.” Adora grabs Catra’s hand and squeezes it, “When you’re ready. Or never. It’s okay with me. I just don’t want you to feel like I’m pressuring you or anything.”

“Thank you.” Catra squeezes Adora’s hand back.

Meow

They both look over at Melog and laugh.

“He’ll be fine. He comes and goes from my place anyways.” Catra says as she rubs her cheek against his fur, “And he knows his way home. Otherwise, he’ll just wait outside your building. Unless Frankie lets him in. Then he’ll probably never leave.”

Adora giggles at that, “I don’t know. Frankie’s got a big heart.”

“Then you’re doomed.” Catra replies flatly, “Melog will become your building’s cat now and no longer my shoulder cat.”

That makes Adora laugh out louder, “Well, I for one will be happy to have Melog as a new resident of the building.”

“Hear that bud? You’re moving up in life if you get along with the doorman, Frankie.” Catra says to Melog like the cat understands, “And I guess you’ll leave me all by my lonesome after that.”

Meow

Catra smiles, “I know, bud.”

“What’d he say?” Adora asks staring at the pair.

“I think he said…” Catra looks over at Adora, “That he’d be living part time between both of our places.”

“Is that right?” Adora asks reaching over to pet along Melog’s furry back.

“Shared custody. I think that’s what he said.” Catra adds.

Meow

Catra laughs, “I know, bud. But I’m telling you, once you’ve seen Adora’s building, you’re not going to want to come back home with me.”

Melog rubs himself against Catra’s cheek, purring away happily as he settles.

“So…” Adora gets back into step with Catra.

“Hm?”

“About the bar…” Adora starts up, poignantly looking away, instead staring ahead as she loosens her grip on Catra’s hand.

“About the bar?”

“You said something… interesting.” Adora bites her bottom lip.

“I said a lot of things.” Catra replies, “Actually I said a lot of very threatening things.”

“Yeah, I know. I was there.” Adora tries to lighten the mood, “It was more like the uh, first thing you said to that guy.”

“About him being pretty?” The magicat tilts her head at Adora, “Because I didn’t really mean that. He’s definitely not my type. I just wanted to make him feel as uncomfortable as the way he was making you feel. Not to mention anyone else he’s hit on in the past.”

“No, I meant after that. I know he’s not your type.” Adora waves her hand in the air a little, “I meant the stuff you were threatening to do to him.”

“You mean the part where I peg him?” Adora nods and Catra grins, “I wasn’t really going to peg him. It was just an empty threat. Huntara on the other hand…”

Adora quirks an eyebrow up at Catra somewhat surprised.

“Hunt is… scary.” Catra breathes out, “I have no idea how much of what she said was as threats that she would actually go through with. Pegging some dude to prove a point… well, I wouldn’t put it past her.”

“That’s… wrong.” Adora frowns.

“I’m sure she probably wouldn’t do it.” Catra quickly defends, “But she’d do that other thing she threatened. Make them hurt without bleeding out or whatever.”

“Oh.” Adora makes a surprised noise and then clears her throat, “So… you don’t have a…” she looks down Catra’s body and then back up to the magicat’s smirking face, “Stars…”

“You want to know if I’ve got a dick?” Catra asks amused that this question is even coming up, “Just because I said that I’d fuck that guy up and make him suck my dick?”

Adora nods shyly, her face heating up at the conversation.

The magicat squeezes Adora’s hand before throwing her head back and laughing, “Stars, princess. What do you think?”

“I-I… Catra!” Adora groans out.

“No, Adora. I don’t have a dick.” Catra tries to say without laughing, watching as Adora’s face gets redder, “Unless that’s something you’re into. I’d have to save a little to acquire one.”

“Stars…” Adora groans out, hiding her face in her hands, “I’m not really sure… what I like.”

“That’s cool.” Catra pulls the blonde’s hands away from her face, “Like I said, we take it at your pace. No pressure. No guilt. No rushing.”

Adora’s eyes catch the magicat’s, a soft smile on her lips, “Are you sure? You could be with someone that wants all that right away.”

“No thanks.” Catra smiles back, “I think I’d prefer to share all of me with you.”

Adora leans in and presses her lips against Catra’s, sighing as they part, “Well, you might have to wait a while then.”

“I’m in no hurry.” Catra shrugs back reassuringly, “You take all the time that you need. Besides, this our second date. I’m not expecting anything more than making out and maybe some light petting.”

The mischievous grin on Catra's face as Adora giggling, "If you mean petting Melog, I'd be more than happy to oblige."

"Sure. That's exactly what I meant." Catra says with a roll of her eyes as they continue to walk.

"I'll just go talk to Frankie first." Adora tells Catra as they stand in front of the building, "Make sure he's okay with Melog hanging around in the lobby."

"Oh! Maybe ask if Melog is allowed inside." Catra grins as she holds up a hand to Frankie who nods back in acknowledgement, "Otherwise I'll set this guy down and he can go gallivanting solo for the night."

Adora nods, "Be right back."

Catra watches as Adora heads inside to talk to the doorman.

The exchange between the pair seems light and friendly.

Sort of like a parent and child kind of relationship.

Adora waves for Catra to come forward with a wide grin.

The magicat takes a deep breath, "Ready bud?"

Meow

"Alright, let's go." Catra declares to Melog and heads towards the building's door, "Behave. For the love of the Stars, please don't go ape-shit and destroy the building."

Meow

"That's not reassuring." Catra mutters as Frankie opens the door.

"As long as Melog isn't too loud, he'll be allowed to stay!" Adora announces happily.

"That's… great." Catra nods, genuinely surprised as Adora grabs her hand and gives it a squeeze.

"Kid." Frankie greets Catra with another nod, "And Kid's cat."

"Frankie." Catra replies and moves so Melog is closer to him, "Meet Melog. Melog, this is Frankie. The doorman."

Meow

Frankie chuckles, chuffed that the cat actually acknowledged him at all and then yelps out in surprise when Melog leaps off Catra's shoulder and into the doorman's arms, purring up a storm.

"Uh, Melog?" Catra warns.

"It's okay, kid." Frankie pets Melog in his arms, "It'd be nice to have some company on the night shift."

Melog seems determined to stay with Frankie, going so far to close his eyes whilst still purring in Frankie's arms.

Catra sighs, grumbling out quietly, "Traitor." She turns to Frankie, "If Melog becomes trouble… just let him back out to get it out of his system."

"I've got Miss Adora's contact if I require assistance, kid." Frankie replies, "Besides, this little guy looks like he's planning to sleep

the rest of the shift.”

“What time does your shift end?” Catra asks.

“6am.”

“You’ll probably need to let Melog out before then. Business and all.” Catra says, “And he probably will end up not coming back after.”

“Oh. That’s not a problem.” Frankie gently pets Melog along his back, “A little bit of company is better than none at all. Now, you two run along. It’s getting late.”

“Goodnight Frankie.” Adora bids him goodnight as she tugs Catra towards the lifts.

“Night, Frankie.” Catra manages to say as she’s pulled away, “I might see you when I leave later.”

“I think you should stay the night with Miss Adora.” Frankie calls back, “It’s going to be too late whenever you plan to leave.”

“Uh…”

“Don’t worry, Frankie.” Adora calls back to him, “She’s staying the night.”

Catra turns to Adora, “I am?”

“Yes.” Adora says before she drops her bravado, “I mean, if that’s okay…”

Catra grins, “Okay.”

“Okay?”

“Yeah, I’ll stay the night.” Catra replies, “How’s your bathroom facilities?”

“Uh, good…?”

“I’m going to need to take a shower after all that pasta.” Catra rubs the back of her neck, “Can I borrow some clothes?”

“Sure.” Adora smiles back, “They might be a little big on you though.”

“Better bigger than smaller.” Catra says as the lift arrives and they get in.

They stand a next to each other in the lift as they watch the numbers advance until they reach the top floor and Catra whistles out impressed and steps out, “Penthouse, baby.”

Adora’s place takes up the entire first floor with a few guest rooms, a huge lounge room, kitchen, gym and Catra thinks she even sees a pool outside. It looks like it’s out of a magazine and most of the space looks untouched.

Adora giggles, “Yeah. My first paycheck was… insane.”

“So, do you like rent or own this place?” Catra asks as they step out of the lift and straight into Adora’s apartment, “Also, isn’t this like a security risk opening up straight into your place?”

“I guess it is when you say it like that.” Adora furrows her brows, “But you need to have a swipe card to get up here. And it is my place.”

“I have a friend that could probably hack into that system and your swipe card would be…” Catra sees the nervous look on Adora’s face and decides to go down a different path, “I’ll contact my friend to see if she can beef up security on your place.”

“You can do that? I mean, she can do that?” Adora’s eyes widen and a look of relief on her face.

“Sure. She’s a technological genius.” Catra says, “And an ethical hacker… of sorts.”

“Okay. First, you need to get cleaned up.” Adora declares as she pulls Catra towards her bathroom, “I’ll grab you some towels and some clothes.”

“I won’t need underwear.” Catra quickly says.

“Uh, okay…”

“Not unless you want me to put a hole through it for my tail.” The magicat elaborates, “I don’t really wear underwear anyways. Too restrictive.”

“That’s… a lot of information.” Adora slowly says, “Anyway, I’m going to get you a fresh towel and something to change into.”

“Okay.” Catra nods, “Thanks.”

“Wait!” Adora almost shouts out as Catra is about to enter the bathroom.

“What’s up?”

“Your ears.”

“What about my ears?” Catra’s ears flick about involuntarily.

“Let me clean them first and then you can go shower.” Adora says as she rushes off to grab a few items, directing the magicat to sit down on the couch, “Sit.”

“Sure? I don’t want to mess up your furniture.” Catra looks around as makes a face.

“It’s fine. It’s just a chair.” Adora simply says.

Shaking her head, Catra decides to plop herself on the floor in front of the couch, “Nah, I think I’ll just sit on the floor.”

“Shove forward so I can sit behind you.” Adora instructs.

“Okay.” Catra moves forward slightly so Adora’ can get in behind her and starts to clean her ears. The magicat relaxes, a purr stirring up in her chest as she sighs, “No one usually touches my ears.”

“Oh. Do you want me to stop?” Adora asks taken aback.

“No. It’s fine. You feel safe. I feel safe around you.” Catra admits softly, “Keep going. It’s nice.”

“Okay.” Adora nods and continues to clean the magicat’s ears.

It’s not long until Adora’s done and ushers Catra into the bathroom, a fresh towel in her hand as well as a hoodie and a pair of red shorts, she knocks on the door.

“Catra? I’ve got that towel for you and a change of clothes.” Adora says after knocking on the door.

“Thanks.” Catra replies while in the shower.

Adora shifts from foot to foot, not sure if she should go in or not since the magicat hasn’t opened the door for her.

“You can leave it on the rack, princess.” Catra calls out when she doesn’t hear Adora go inside the bathroom.

“Oh, okay.” Adora takes a deep breath and opens the door, keeping her eyes down, she quickly puts the towel and clothes on the rack before going back out, breathing out in relief once she’s back outside again.

Catra comes out, the towel wrapped around her lower half, her hair still wet as she wanders out in search of another towel or Adora.

She finally spots the blonde in the kitchen, making up two cups of something hot and steaming when Catra walks in and watches her. She's changed into her pyjamas, a rainbow unicorn set that even sports a hood with the horn on top.

"Hey, Adora." Catra rasps out trying to stifle the laughter that wants to burst out at the sight of the blonde in her pyjamas.

Adora shrieks a little at being surprised, a hand to chest as she turns around to see Catra standing in her kitchen with the towel wrapped only around her lower half.

Her eyes widen and then she quickly looks away, "Catra! You're… naked!"

"I've got a towel on." Catra gestures to the towel around her lower half, "What are you doing?"

"Making tea." Adora covers her eyes with her hand, her face turning bright red at seeing the magicat topless, "Why aren't you wearing a shirt?!"

"You didn't give me one." Catra simply replies, "Plus my hair is wet which means my shirt would get wet too. Help me dry my hair?"

"Stars…" Adora whines out.

"You can look, you know?" Catra says amused, "I don't mind."

"I mind." Adora quickly says, "Let me go grab you another towel then."

"Okay."

"And the hairdryer." Adora adds as she stumbles out of the kitchen to fetch a second towel, "Sit on couch or something and I'll bring them over."

"Sure." Catra grins as she watches Adora avert her eyes from her while searching for the items and then a sense of dread hits her

upon knowing what will happen when her hair dries and she groans out.

Chapter End Notes

That thought is when her hair dries it's going to go really fluffy!

Thanks for reading, kudos, comments, subscribing and bookmarking!

Chapter 6: Soft

Chapter Summary

Catra stays the night.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Stars…" Adora looks away as she blow dries Catra's hair, "I have clothes for you…"

"After, princess." Catra replies closing her eyes and enjoying the feeling of the heat on her fur and in her hair, "Not right now. Fur's still wet. Your nice dry clothes won't make it. Not on my wet fur."

The blonde sighs, "Just… keep your towel on."

"Oh, you mean my bottom half?" Catra asks looking into her lap, "Yeah, don't worry. As soon as I'm dry, I'll get dressed."

Adora nods, humming out as she runs her fingers through Catra's hair, inadvertently petting the magicat and eliciting a loud purr. The blonde giggles, "That is so cute."

"Just means that it feels good." Catra reasons with a shrug as Adora finishes up, "Thank you."

The blonde snorts out a laugh at how Catra's fur has dried, "You're very welcome."

Catra's fur now blown dry is completely fluffed up.

Fluffy.

Really fluffy.

"Not a word, princess." Catra warns as she gets up from the floor and stretches out her back facing away from Adora, the blonde

snickers behind her back as she stands up as well so she can put away the hairdryer.

The magicat walks over and grabs the shirt that Adora's lending to her for the night and throws it on, pulling the fabric to her nose and breathing it in as Adora just watches. Catra looks away sheepishly at being caught literally sniffing Adora's clothes, "It's a scent thing."

Adora just hums back in reply as she goes to put the appliance away and then returns to sit on the couch.

"Join me?" The words soft from Adora's lips, almost hopeful.

"Let me put some pants on first?" Catra gestures down at the towel still wrapped around her hips and Adora nods, a slight blush on her face as she quickly looks away from the towel, "I'll be right back."

"Okay." Adora replies with a smile as she watches the magicat walk away to put on the pants she's left out on her bed.

The blonde busies herself with finding something for them to watch on the tv as Catra comes back out, the pants that Adora left out rolled up so she can walk freely, she can't help but smile at the magicat.

Catra flops down on the couch next to Adora and groans out contently, "Stars, your couch is so soft."

"I mean, it is pretty old." Adora replies as she runs her fingers over the well worn fabric of the old couch, "It's from my old place that I shared with my best friends."

Catra nods, "I can tell it's well loved, princess."

Adora hums back as she goes back to searching for something to watch on the tv, "Is there anything you want to watch?"

“Nah. I’m not really into tv.” Catra replies with a yawn, “Stars, I didn’t realise I was so tired. Must be this really soft and comfortable couch…”

The makes the blonde giggle, “You want to sleep?”

Shaking her head, Catra finds herself leaning her head on Adora’s shoulder, “I’m fine. I can stay awake forever.”

“Uh huh. Adora says less convinced, “Can you now?”

“Sure can.” Catra smiles lazily, “Why did you move out?”

“I wanted my own place.” Adora replies as she gives up on searching for something to watch and just turns the set off.

“It’s a really nice place, Adora.” Catra says.

“Thank you.” Adora replies feeling pride in her place as she adds, “Also, my best friends started dating and I didn’t want to be the third wheel or whatever.”

“They kicked you out?” Catra wakes up a little more, frowning, “That’s not cool. I can claw their eyes out if you want.”

The giggle that the statement pulls from Adora’s lips has Catra’s frown turn into a confused look, “They didn’t kick me out. I chose to go. Be independent for once in my life.”

“Oh. Ignore the whole… clawing out their eyes thing then…” Catra breathes out relieved at not having to do that in the first place.

“Yeah.” Adora nudges Catra with her shoulder, “It’s the first time living by myself.”

“Yep, you’re definitely a grown up now. Adulting for real.” Catra replies with a grin, “Inviting random magicats into your place to shower and everything.”

“Hey!” Adora shoves Catra playfully, the pair breaking out in laughter as she glares lightly at the magicat, “For your information, apart from my best friends, you’re the only other person that’s been here.”

“Yeah?” Catra grins, the fact that Adora trusts her enough makes her feel pride, “Thank you for letting me into your space, princess.”

“Well…” Adora turns to Catra with a mischievously grin on her lips, “There is a price for coming up here…”

“One that I’m sure I am more than happy to pay.” Catra says leaning in towards Adora until their foreheads meet, “So, what is this price?”

The blonde hums and pretends to think, her eyes glance up for a moment before focussing back on Catra’s as she says, “A kiss.”

“Oh, a kiss?”

Adora nods, a dopey smile on her face as she waits for the price to be paid.

“A kiss.” Catra whispers, her breath light on Adora’s waiting lips, “Then a kiss you shall receive.”

Adora giggles until her lips meet Catra’s and she lets out a satisfied hum instead.

The kiss is soft and chaste, ending faster than the blonde would like.

And just as the magicat pulls away, she chuckles when Adora grabs her by the cheeks and brings her back in for more kisses.

“Stop laughing!” Adora whines out playfully, “I can’t kiss you if you keep laughing!”

Catra stifles her laughter and lets herself get pulled back into some serious kisses with Adora, letting the blonde take the lead as she purrs happily.

Their kissing eventually peters out when their cheeks start to strain and they lean their foreheads against one another, panting and catching their breaths, Adora looks into Catra's eyes, "Bed?"

"Sure." Catra nods, "Lead the way, princess."

Adora gets up, holding her hand out to Catra.

Then enter Adora's bedroom.

The blonde flips the light switch and illuminates her room, Catra steps forwards, looking at the unmade bed and smiles.

"Shut up. I usually make my bed." Adora grumbles knowingly, "Besides I was running late this morning."

"I'm not judging." Catra replies genuinely as she adds, "I don't make my bed up either."

"You don't?"

"Nope. Don't see the point." Catra replies, "I'm going to sleep in it anyways and the way I leave it is basically the way it was comfortable before I had to get up."

"Well, I do usually make my bed." Adora admits, "It's just a routine. But this morning I was running late."

"Mm…" Catra eyes her bed warily, "So, want to toss me a pillow and a blanket and I'll head back to the couch to sleep."

"You don't want to sleep here? With me?" The last part makes Catra tilt her head at the blonde guiltily, "I mean, yeah, it's fine if you don't want to…"

“I want to.” Catra blurts out.

“Then… why don’t you just stay? Here.” Adora gestures to her bed.

“I just… I don’t want to rush you into anything.” Catra rubs her arm sheepishly, “I like you.”

“I like you too.” Adora smiles back.

The puppy dog eyes Adora is giving her makes her relent, “Okay. But I’m taking the left side.”

“It’s all yours.” Adora gestures to said side, “I’m just going to brush my teeth and get ready for bed.”

“Okay.” Catra nods before reaching out for the blonde, “Do you have a spare toothbrush?”

“Yes.” Adora smiles before it drops slightly, “But it’s not exactly for magicats though.”

“I’ll manage.” Catra shrugs, “You go first. I’m going to make my side comfortable.”

“Comfortable?” Adora raises an eyebrow at the magicat, confusion on her face.

“Yeah. Comfortable.” Catra grins back, “It’s a… thing.”

“A magicat thing?”

“Yeah. A magicat thing.” Catra confirms.

“Can I watch?” Adora asks with genuine interest.

“You want to watch me get my side of the bed comfortable?” Catra asks amused.

“I mean, if that’s okay…” Adora bites her bottom lip in anticipation.

The magicat chuckles, “Yeah, okay. It’s really not all that interesting though.”

“I’ll be the judge of that.” Adora crosses her arms over her chest with a grin.

With that, Catra walks over to Adora’s bed and inspects the left side.

Her hand touches the bedsheets, letting her fingers run along the fabric, humming in satisfaction.

Adora giggles.

Catra looks up with a lopsided grin, “It’s been a while since I’ve slept in a proper bed.”

The statement changes the smile on Adora’s face to one of confusion.

The magicat doesn’t address it, instead grabbing the pillow and fluffing it a few times before climbing onto the bed, rolling side to side a few times before star fishing on it, closing her eyes and letting out a content sigh.

Adora can’t hep herself and gets into bed next to the magicat, rolling on her side to look at Catra, “You’re cute.”

“You’re cute.” Catra retorts quickly whilst cracking an eye open, “And beautiful. And hot. And nice. And… mmphf!”

Adora practically climbs on top of Catra, kissing the magicat deeply before smiling into it, “You’re too much.”

“I’m just enough.”

“You’re ridiculous.”

“I’m in love.”

Adora’s eyes widen at the statement.

Catra's eyes widen at the confession blurted out.

"You… you love me?" Adora voice soft, unsure and then she furrows her brows, "You're not just saying that to get me into bed, are you?"

"Princess." Catra rolls her eyes up at Adora, "I'd lie for you. Not to you."

"It's just… so soon." Adora says, the frown still on her face, "Do you mean it?"

Catra looks away bashfully, "I'm sorry. I shouldn't have blurted that out loud."

Adora gently turns Catra's face back to hers as she repeats, "Did you mean it?"

The magicat's ears flatten against her head at being cornered by the blonde, her eyes shut as she grits out, "Yes. I meant it."

When Catra opens her eyes, she expects Adora's face to be angry or at least confused.

What she doesn't expect is the soft and shy eyes Adora looks at her with.

"I can go." Catra says, "I've just fucked this up. I'll just grab Melog and get out of your hair."

"Catra."

"I'm such an idiot." Catra grumbles out to herself as she tries to get out of bed.

"Catra." Adora repeats not getting off the magicat to let her flee.

"Just, uh, let me up and I'll head home." Catra looks away as she says it.

"Catra!"

“What?” The quiet reply has Adora leaning down and pressing her lips on to the magicat’s once more.

“Stay.”

“Yeah?”

“Yes. Please.” Adora breathes out as she lets her weight rest on top of the magicat, “Stay.”

Sighing out, Catra nods before looking up at the blonde, “Okay.”

“Yeah?” the grin on Adora’s face widening.

“Well, I couldn’t leave even if I wanted to.” Catra looks between them, “Literally. You’ve got me pinned down.”

“Good.” Adora chuckles softly and then bites her bottom lip unsurely, “Are you going to stay when I get off you to get ready for bed?”

“You’re such an idiot.” Catra laughs out, wrapping her arms around Adora’s lower back, “Of course I’m staying. I said I would, didn’t I?”

Nodding, Adora smiles, “Good. I’ll be right back.”

“Okay.” The magicat sighs out contently, “Go. Get ready for bed before I fall asleep without brushing my teeth.”

Giggling, Adora lifts herself off Catra, getting off the bed, she points a finger at the magicat and quirks an eyebrow up, “Stay.”

“I’m not a dog, princess.” Catra rolls her eyes light heartedly,

“Didn’t say you were.” Adora leans over and kisses Catra once more making the magicat melt onto the bed, before she goes to get ready for bed, “I’ll be right back.”

“Uh huh.” Catra smiles dopily back at Adora’s disappearing form into the bathroom, “I’ll be… right here.”

“Your bed is like sleeping on a cloud.” Catra says as she melts into the mattress, “Now I definitely don’t want to ever go home.”

Adora smiles, turning off the light and then getting into bed with Catra.

“Can I ask you something?” The blonde softly asks as she turns over to face the magicat.

“You can ask me anything, Adora.” Catra replies turning over, mirroring the blonde as her eyes glow in the dark.

Adora gasps, “Your eyes glow.”

“Reflect light.”

“That’s so cool.” Adora practically squeals.

“Also, that wasn’t a question.” The magicat laughs as she stares at Adora in the relative darkness of the blonde’s room.

“No. It wasn’t.” Adora nods.

“What did you want to ask?” Catra yawns, her eyes disappearing as she shuts them briefly.

“Back at the bar.” Catra’s eyes stare back at Adora, waiting patiently for the question, “You said something…”

“Hm?”

“Do you have… uh…” Catra notices Adora’s eyes drift down to the blanket over them.

“Do I have…?” Catra asks back, too tired to recall what she’d said back at the bar.

“Do you have a…” Adora’s whole body feels like its on fire as she tries to ask her question.

It’s at that moment, the magicat saves Adora from the embarrassment of asking, “A dick?”

“Stars…” Adora groans out, hiding her face in her hands.

Catra just smiles back tiredly, yawning out as she replies, “Pretty sure I don’t.”

“Oh.”

And just as Catra’s about to fall asleep she repeats, “Pretty sure I don’t…”

Adora leans over and presses her lips on Catra’s for a chaste kiss, “Sleep, Catra.”

“Mm… not tired…” Catra murmurs as she body feels heavier.

Giggling, Adora turns over to get a little more comfortable, her breath hitches when she feels Catra’s arm get slung over her stomach, pulling her back into the front of the magicat, the hold around her is just tight enough to feel safe yet not too tight to restrict.

“Mm… you smell good.” Catra mumbles as her breathing starts to slow and her arm feels a little heavier around Adora’s middle.

Adora smiles, the warmth and the feeling of being held enough for her to fall into a restful slumber. Thoughts and perceived conceptions of what could have happened tonight fall away as they both fall asleep.

Catra wakes up first.

The room is still dark as she gets her bearings.

The room isn’t familiar.

It’s very obvious this is not her place.

Not at all.

But when she breathes in, the scents and smells around the room instantly make her feel calmer.

Happier.

There's a warmth radiating with a slight weight on her chest and she inhales.

"Adora." Catra breathes out, the blonde's scent filling up her nose and lungs as she presses her lips into Adora's hair, a content purr and smile on her lips.

The magicat's ears pick up the soft hum below her as she feels Adora rouse from sleep too, Catra holds her breath trying not to break the calm of the morning.

Adora's eyes open.

Her body now turned over and curled into Catra's chest as she chances a look up only to find heterochromatic eyes starting back at her. It takes a moment before she realises that she's literally woken up in Catra's arms as a hint of shyness hits her and she covers her face with her hands.

"Stars…" Adora breathes out.

"Good morning to you too." Catra rasps out, her morning voice hoarse and low, amusement under toning her words, "I have to get going soon. Melog's probably tearing it up down in the lobby."

Adora pouts visibly, "It's too early."

"I don't want Frankie to hate Melog." Catra replies as she tries to sit up but is pulled back down, she chuckles at how clingy Adora is being and then suggests, "Come down to the lobby with me then."

"That means getting up and no more cuddling." Adora replies with a whine.

"How about…" Catra thinks for moment and looking looks up at her, the blonde's fingers stroking the fur around Catra's stomach, a purr rumbles out from the magicat's chest, "We go down to the lobby. I do a quick check on Melog and let them out and then…"

"And then?" Adora repeats interested.

"And then we come back up here and I raid your fridge and make you breakfast." Catra finishes.

A smile appears on Catra's face when she watches Adora's eyes widen in surprise, she looks up into Catra's eyes and cringes a little, "I don't actually have much at my place…"

"Oh. Maybe I go check out your fridge and we do a quick grocery run." Catra suggests instead, rubbing her cheek playfully against Adora's, "Or… we can go out for breakfast…"

"Kiss?" Adora asks instead, a smile on her lips as she does so.

"Of course." Catra whispers and leans in, pressing her lips onto Adora's in a light kiss, "Enough?"

'Stars no." Adora complains, pulling Catra back down for a proper kiss.

After a lot more kisses…

"I'm blaming you if Melog's trashed your lobby." Catra jests as they take the lift down the lobby after finally getting out of bed and dressed before she readies herself for what she's expecting to see.

"Whatever. It wasn't my fault *you* took so long to get ready." Adora throws back, sticking her tongue out childishly and then grinning, "You could have just worn my clothes."

“I am wearing your clothes.” Catra deadpans back.

“Those are still your pants.” Adora points at the magicat’s pants.

“Okay, I’m wearing your hoodie.” The magicat flips the hood up over her ears, said ears wiggle under the hood, Catra turns to Adora and smirks, “See.”

“Stars…” Adora coos as she wraps her arms around Catra’s shoulders and brings her in for a kiss, “You’re so cute…”

“Once we get out of this lift, no more calling me cute, princess.” Catra grumbles lightly, “I have a reputation to uphold.”

“Uh huh.” The blonde hums back, “Can I hold your hand and kiss you still once we step out of here?”

“I’d be quite annoyed if you didn’t.” Catra replies leaning her forehead against Adora’s and closing her eyes as the elevator stops at the lobby and the doors open, “I think this is our stop.”

Giggling, Adora pulls Catra outside and they both stop in front of Frankie, eyes wide as they see Melog in the lobby.

Adora nudges Catra as they take in Melog.

Melog, who’s lounging about the lobby.

Lounging about the lobby on the shoulder of Frankie.

Melog is now Frankie’s shoulder cat.

“Traitor.” Catra grumbles under her breath as Adora snickers out a laugh, the magicat rolls her eyes at her, “This is betrayal in its highest form.”

“He’s so cute!” Adora whispers out the coo.

It’s at that point, Frankie turns around to see the pair standing in his lobby, a smile on his face as we walks over to the pair, “Ah!

Adora! And Catra. Good morning. What's brings you two down here so early?"

"Good morning, Frankie." Adora greets back, "We actually just came down to check on Melog. Make sure he didn't 'trash' the place."

Catra glares at her cat.

Perhaps it's *former* cat now.

Meow

Melog leaps from Frankie's shoulder and onto Catra's, purring as he rubs his face against her cheek.

Frankie pouts, sad to lose his nighttime companion, "Melog. I thought we were friends."

"You are." Catra replies for Melog, "Friends. I mean, Frankie."

Meow

Adora giggles at the interaction between Frankie and Catra.

"Melog and I are family." Catra grunts a little when Melog headbutts her, "My shoulder cat."

Frankie walks over and reaches out, Melog rubs his head against his hand before leaping down to the ground and sitting in front of the doors.

“Better let Melog out, Frankie.” Catra says, “Melog has some… business to attend to.”

“Of course.” Frankie opens the door for the cat, Melog runs out, disappearing without looking back, he calls out to cat that’s wandered off, “Come back anytime, Melog. You’re always welcome here.”

“Now he’ll never come home with me.” Catra groans out.

“I don’t work on weekends. So, he’ll be all yours then.” Frankie grins back playfully before laughing, “Melog was very quiet. Slept the entire time. Nothing but a very quiet companion that didn’t mind pets every now and then.”

Another doorman enters the lobby, dressed exactly the same way as Frankie, just a decade younger, “Morning, Frankie.” He greets, tipping his hat to the night shifter, “How goes it?”

“Fine. Fine.” Frankie reaches out and shakes the other man’s hand, “Good morning to you too, Dan.”

Doorman Dan turns to Adora, “Morning, miss Adora.”

“Good morning, Dan.” Adora greets back with a nod, reaching out for Catra’s hand and pulling the magicat forward, “This is Catra.”

“It’s nice to meet you, Catra.” Dan nods in greeting, “Are you and Adora friends?”

“Something like that.” Catra replies.

Dan looks over at Frankie who raises an eyebrow at him and somehow they are able to communicate exactly, the morning doorman grins back at the pair before putting on his serious face, “You better not hurt our, Adora. *Kid.”*

Catra looks between Dan and Frankie a little confused and maybe somewhat fearful, forcing herself to remain confident she replies, “I have no intention of hurting, Adora.”

“She doesn’t.” Adora nods in confirmation, “She’s been nothing but respectful. Even threatened a few… unsavoury people around me.”

“Oh.” Dan says happily surprised, “That’s good.”

“It is?” Catra turns to Adora to ask.

“Yes.” Adora replies squeezing Catra’s hand, “It’s good. You’re kind of like my own personal bodyguard at this point.”

Dan nods approvingly, “I’m still going to keep my eye on you, kid.”

“Me too.” Frankie chimes in as she goes to grab his things to clock off, “Okay. My wife is going to kill me if I don’t get home soon.” he turns to the pair, “Keep her safe.”

“Of course, Frankie.” Catra nods as she squeezes Adora’s hand back, “We’re heading out to get groceries or breakfast. Maybe even both.”

“You cook, kid?” Frankie asks surprised but also impressed.

“A little.” Catra replies with a small shrug.

“Okay.” Adora interjects, “We’re going to head out. Have a good day, Frankie. And we’ll see you later, Dan.”

“Have a good day too, Adora.” Frankie waves to them as Dan opens the door, “And you as well, kid.”

“Thanks, Frankie.” Catra nods back at him whilst being dragged out by Adora, “Was nice to meet you, Dan!”

“Likewise!” Dan waves them off before shutting the door.

“So…” Adora turns to Catra as they walk down the street, hand in hand and with wide grins on their faces, “Breakfast?”

“Sure, princess.” Catra replies and before she can say anything else, the blonde pulls her in for a chaste kiss leaving the magicat a little dazed, “What was that for?”

“I know a really great place that does breakfast.” Adora replies in lieu of explaining a reason for the kiss, “Oh, and it’s my treat.”

Chapter End Notes

there's most likely going to be more chapters...
I have plans and I don't think one more chapter is going to cover it.

Thanks for reading, kudos, comments, bookmarking and subscribing!

Chapter 7: Photoshoots and Managers

Chapter Summary

We meet Adora's manager.

Chapter Notes

I've been meaning to get back to this fic...
and I finally did!
Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“Hey.” Adora says just as Catra starts to dig into her breakfast of assorted meats, the magicat looks up with a mouthful and a questioning look, the blonde chuckles at the sight before she continues, “I’ve got a photoshoot later today.”

“Oh, yeah. That’s cool.” Catra replies after swallowing her mouthful of food, “I can meet up with you after, if you want.”

“Well, I was wondering if you wanted to come along?” Adora asks shyly, “If you’re not busy today.”

“Sure, princess. I’ve got the day off.” Catra replies with a smile, “What time and where?”

“It’s in the city at 2pm.” Adora replies, “I’ll have to double check the address.”

“I’ll walk you home first and then if you send me the location of your photoshoot, I can meet you there.” Catra plans out loud, “I need to do a quick stop at home and get changed. Maybe check on the fur baby…”

With faux offense, Adora brings a hand to her chest in mock hurt, “Are you saying my clothes are not good enough for you?”

Catra laughs, shaking her head, "You're not getting this hoodie back, just so you know. It's mine now. I'm kidnapping it. I like it too much to just wear out on nonspecial occasions."

That makes Adora grin widely, "Keep it. It's yours." The blonde then looks at the time on her phone and sighs, "I've got to hit the gym after breakfast. Work off some of this before my shoot."

"I shall keep this as clean as I can." Catra replies solemnly, "Though, I will apologise in advanced for claw marks…"

Adora giggles, "It's fine, Cat." she looks at the magicat's still relatively full plate, "Eat up. My treat."

"You eat up too." Catra gestures to Adora's own plate, "You're going to need the energy if you're hitting the gym after."

"I'll be fine." Adora brushes off Catra's concern, a small smile on her face trying to reassure the magicat, she starts on her own breakfast of fruit, yoghurt and museli.

"Okay." Catra nods and lets it go, going back to her breakfast.

After breakfast

Catra sips on her black coffee as their plates are cleared from their table, Adora pulling out her phone and tapping on it a few times before placing it on the table, screen down.

"Hey, Adora?"

"Hm?"

"Can you send me your contract to look over?" Catra asks as she lowers her cup back onto the table, "I've got some downtime and if you want, I can look over it for you."

“Sure. Hang on, let me find it first.” Adora grabs her phone again and taps on it a few times before finally finding what she’s looking for, her phone makes a noise to indicate that it’s been sent sounds as she puts her phone back down on the table once more and says to Catra, “Sent. Enjoy the lengthy reading.”

“Thanks. I’ll take a look at it and make some notes.” Catra replies as she feels her phone vibrate in her pocket, “Is there anything in particular you want me to look into though?”

Adora shrugs, “Not really.”

“Okay.” Catra nods, “I’ll do some reading and research and see what’s normal and what’s bogus.”

The blonde smiles back gratefully, “You really don’t have to do that…”

“Call it, personal interest.” Catra shrugs, “I’d like to know why I can’t take my girlfriend on dinner dates to buffets.”

Adora snorts out a laugh, “Really? A buffet?”

“Yeah. It’d be a good insight into what foods you really like and what foods you don’t.” Catra replies, “Plus I heard there’s a thing called fondue… which sounds very interesting.”

“You don’t know what a fondue is?” Catra shakes her head, “It’s like melted cheese in a pot that you dip stuff into. Can you even have dairy?”

“I can… in moderation.” The magicat replies as she picks up her cup again, “I don’t mind cheese. Just too much makes me… not so fun to be around…”

“Have you ever seen a chocolate fountain?” Adora asks amused, “Wait, what about chocolate? Can you eat that?”

“Yeah, I can.” The magicat grins, “I’m not a dog, Adora. It’s not poison to me. Just as long as I don’t consume too much and get

sick, I can have chocolate, it's just not my favourite thing tin the world. It's just a little too sweet for my tastebuds."

"What is your favourite thing in the world?" Adora asks as she taps her fingers against her empty water glass.

"You."

"That wasn't what I meant…" The answer makes Adora blush, she reaches out and grabs Catra's hand and softly says, "You're my favourite thing in my world too."

"Thing?" Catra raises an eyebrow up at Adora, a grin on her face, "Am I a thing?"

"No. Of course you aren't." Adora shakes her head with a low chuckle, "You're my favourite person in the world." Catra grins as Adora quickly adds, "Definitely top three because Glimmer and Bow are my favourite people too. But in a friend way."

"Uh huh."

"You're more of a… girlfriend kind of way." Adora explains.

"Well, you're my favourite person in a kind of… *lover* kind of way." Catra squeezes Adora's hand as she picks up her cup and downs the rest of the drink, "Okay, ready to go?"

"Yes." Adora smiles, pulling out her wallet as they go to the cash register to pay.

Catra's home

Catra's laying on her back on top of her bedsheets, still in Adora's borrowed hoodie as she scrolls through the contract her girlfriend

sent her this morning, she rubs her eyes and sighs, “Geez, princess… this contract reads like a horror script…”

The magicat blinks her eyes a few times and continues to read through the very long and confusing contract.

Adora’s photoshoot

Catra looks at the warehouse building in front of her.

It doesn’t look like somewhere a photoshoot would happen, but what would Catra know.

She’s not a photographer.

Or a model.

She just waits tables, brings food around and picks up empty glasses most days.

Looking down at her phone, she checks the address one more time before smoothing down her black button up shirt, tucking it back into her black chinos and smooths her hair down before taking a deep breath and walking forward.

She’s met with security at the door, both guys dressed in black suits as they wait for her to get to them.

One of the large security guards puts his hand up to the approaching magicat, “Can I help you?”

“Uh, yeah. I guess you could.” Catra says as she stops in front of the guard, “I’m here for Adora. She’s doing a photoshoot here. I’m Catra.”

“Is she expecting you?” He asks unmoving from his spot.

“Yeah. She is actually.” Catra replies with a grin.

“One moment, please.” The guard says as he steps back and gets onto his radio to confirm, Catra waiting patiently on the spot until he returns after a few moments, “This way please.”

He gestures for Catra to follow him, leaving the second security guard to cover him while he goes inside.

The corridor is dimly lit until he pushes through another door and Catra has to cover her eyes briefly when the brightness of the room nearly blinds her.

“Wait here. Someone will be along shortly to escort you in further.” The security guard says, once Catra nods he takes that as his cue and heads back to his post.

Once Catra’s eyes adjust to the lighting in the room, she sees the warehouse is essentially a staged floor, everything from stage flats to video screens lining the walls of the room waiting to be utilised. A few partitions and bollards with tape mark out certain areas while coloured tape on the floors for is used for direction.

“Excuse me.” Someone clears their throat breaking Catra’s focus around the room, it must be an assistant or a runner, they’re dressed in a navy blue pantsuit, the young woman has a headset on over her green hair, clipboard in hand as she asks, “Are you here for Miss Adora?”

“Yes.” Catra nods with a polite smile.

“Is she expecting you?” The woman asks looking at the list on her clipboard.

“Yes.”

“Name?”

“Catra.” The magicat replies somewhat amused, “Does she have a few people on her ‘list’ usually?”

“No.” the assistant replies frowning at her paperwork, “I’m sorry, but I don’t have you on here.”

“Well, she asked me to come.” Catra counters, “I’d assume she’d let you know.”

“Miss Adora doesn’t generally have any guests whilst on set.” The assistant continues to look through her list, flipping over the pages and huffing whilst tapping her pen on the board, “I’m sorry, but you’re not on here.”

“Oh.” Catra says surprised, “Is she around? You can ask her directly. Or call her?”

The assistant furrows her brows at Catra, “She is. But you’re not on the list. Which means you are now technically trespassing. So, you’ll need to leave.”

“Woah, hold up.” Catra puts her hands up, “Trespassing? She asked me to come today. Can’t you just ask her?”

“No.”

“Seriously? It’d take like ten seconds.” Catra tries, doing her best to stay calm as another woman steps in. She’s tall, jet black hair, thin, her red and black dress looking like they float on the air despite being grounded. She’s also menacing with the red mask with black around her eyes, the magicat looks up confused.

“Is there a problem, Ivy?” The tall, dark and menacing woman asks in a gruff voice, almost like she’s already irritated that this hasn’t been resolved already.

“No, Ms Weaver.” The assistant, Ivy replies, fear evident in her voice as she turns back to Catra, “You’re not on the list. Please leave.”

"Look, *Ivy and tall, dark and scary lady."* Catra starts as the latter glares back at her clearly unimpressed, "Adora asked me to be here. I'm not leaving until she tells me differently."

"This is most inconvenient." Ms Weaver says, it sounds more like a threat than just a statement as she puts her hands behind her back and towers intimidatingly over the magicat, "You'll need to leave. Adora does not need *distractions."*

"I'm not a distraction." Catra replies through gritted teeth, her hands balling into fists as she tries to stay calm, "You are being very rude."

A smirk comes across the taller woman's features, Catra can tell despite the mask that she's managed to rile the magicat up, "Leave now or security will throw you out."

"This is ridiculous." Catra scoffs out, "Adora asked me to come today. Just ask her yourself."

"Enough." Ms Weaver puts her hand up to stop Catra from speaking, "Ivy, please get security to escort this…" she narrows her eyes at Catra before continuing, "*Thing…* out of the lot. I don't want it anywhere near the building."

"Yes, Ms Weaver." Ivy nods and gets onto her headset, "Security onto the main set. Security to the main set. We need you to escort a… someone out."

"This is bullshit." Catra grumbles.

"That language is not welcome here. Just like you." Ms Weaver sneers, letting her stance relax a little bit as she spots security coming.

"Catra?" Adora's voice calls out from somewhere behind the pair in front of the magicat.

Catra leans sideways to see around the assistant and Ms Weaver, spotting the familiar blonde hair of Adora, a grin adorns the

magicat's face, "Hey Adora."

The blonde rushes towards her girlfriend, a wide grin on her face and dressed in a white dressing gown, her hair loose and down, as she goes to grab the magicat's hand, only to be stopped when the security guard from before places both hands on Catra's shoulders. Adora furrows her brows, confused, "What's going on?"

"I'm being thrown out." Catra replies.

"Wait, why?" Adora asks as she reaches out and grabs Catra's hand.

"Ms Adora." The security guard greets the blonde, "Is this person with you?"

"Yes."

"Right." The security guard releases his hold on Catra, "Apologies, it seems there may have been a miscommunication."

Catra nods to the security guard, there's no anger towards him as she understands he's just doing his job with dodgy information, she watches as he quickly turns to leave, not bothering to address the assistant or Ms Weaver, much to the latter's ire.

"Ivy. Ms Weaver. Catra is with me. I asked her to come today." Adora explains calmly.

Ivy quickly nods and writes something on her list before smiling, "Okay. I've added her to your list, Miss Adora."

"Thank you." Adora replies confused as to why she wasn't already added in the first place, she shakes her head, squeezes Catra's hand, "Come on, I'll show you around."

Catra lets Adora pull her forward, the magicat sticking her tongue out at Ivy and Ms Weaver as she's dragged away.

“Adora.” Ms Weaver says making Adora stop in her tracks, her tone similar to before, sounding like a warning, “You cannot have ‘visitors’ while on set.”

“Oh.” Adora stops in her tracks, she looks back sheepishly, “I thought I was allowed to have my friends come on set as long as they didn’t interrupt the shoot.”

The tall, dark and scary woman shakes her head, “No. As per the contract…”

“It states that Adora *can* have people on the set. Just limited to three at a time.” Catra interjects, “Nowhere in it does it say she cannot have friends or visitors on set.”

Ms Weaver pauses, shocked, she turns back to Adora, “You let that thing see your contract?”

Adora frowns, “Catra is not a thing. And see! I’m allowed to have people I trust look over the contract I’ve already signed.”

“Speaking of Adora’s contract…” Catra starts to say before Ms Weaver huffs out.

“Wardrobe is ready.” Ms Weaver declares cutting the magicat’s sentence off, “But get to hair and makeup first. Go.”

“Yes. Okay.” Adora nods, ignoring the taller woman’s eyes as she tugs Catra forward towards hair and makeup. She plops down on the chair as directed by the hair stylist, Catra is offered the chair next to her as they continue to hold hands, “I’m so sorry about that, Catra. Shadow Weaver can be a little… protective.”

“Hm.” Catra replies flatly.

“Though she was out of line calling you a ‘thing’.” Adora adds, she tries to keep the frown off her face but fails, “That was uncalled for.”

“She also called me a distraction if you want to add it to your list.” Catra jest teasingly.

“Did she?” Adora asks seriously and Catra sighs and then nods, “I’m going to have a talk with her.”

“Who is she?” Catra asks.

“She’s sort of my manager.” Adora admits, “Said I needed one to look after things like scheduling and stuff like that.”

“How much do you pay her?” The magicat stares at Adora through the mirror on the wall in front of them.

“She gets 25%.”

“Seriously?”

Adora nods, “She said it was pretty standard.”

“And… how long have you had her as your manager?” The magicat squeezes Adora’s hand.

“Not all that long actually.” Adora says after thinking it over for a moment, “She came on board to negotiate my current contract.”

“And is it better than before?”

“I get paid more.” Adora replies with a small smile.

“Do you? Even with the whole 25% to the manager thing?” Catra asks.

“It’s still a lot of money…” Adora bites her bottom lip as she answers, “And I’m pretty comfortable as it is.”

Catra nods, “So, money-wise, it’s still good.”

“Yes.” Adora confirms.

“What about the rest of it?” Catra turns her body so she can look at Adora’s profile from the side, “I’m talking the living part of the contract.”

“Well, you already know about my dietary requirements…” Adora replies softly.

“Did you add that in or did *she* add that in?” the question makes Adora squirm a little in her seat.

“That wasn’t me.” The words are said softly, sheepishly, “I didn’t even know she had added extra bits into it until after I already signed it.”

Catra nods, giving Adora her most reassuring smile she can muster as her brain goes through all the information she’s read in the contract.

After hair and make up and onto wardrobe

“I’ll be right back. I’ve got to change.” Adora smiles at Catra, letting go of the magicat’s hand as she ducks into a dressing room and shuts the door.

Catra leans against the wall opposite the door and waits patiently.

The door swings open suddenly.

Adora is still in the white bathrobe.

Her face flushed as she looks around and then to Catra.

“Everything alright there, princess?” Catra asks.

Adora shakes her head, her eyebrows furrow as she stares down at the floor.

“What wrong?” Catra pushes off the wall and stands in front of Adora, her hands rubbing soothingly over the blonde’s arms.

“Wardrobe.” Adora simple grumbles.

Catra looks around Adora to see what her girlfriend is talking about, and her eyes go wide when she sees it.

“They want you to wear that?” Catra asks bemused, “To show off a car?”

Adora nods with a scoff.

“Why?”

“I don’t know.” Adora replies with a groan.

“You’re not comfortable wearing it.” Catra says, not a question, a statement that Adora nods to, “You don’t have to wear it, princess.”

“I do.” Adora groans again, leaning into Catra and wrapping her arms around the magicat’s shoulders, “It’s for the shoot.”

“You don’t.” Catra repeats, “You have the right to refuse.”

“Ah, Adora!” The photographer appears as soon as he spots the blonde, a confused look on his face, “Why aren’t you dressed?”

Adora’s jaw clenches, “I’m not wearing that, Lashor.”

Lashor, the pink and muscly lizard hybrid smirks, “Yes, you are. We need to highlight your tits, love.”

“This isn’t what I signed up for…” Adora grumbles into Catra’s ear.

“Why does she need to be in a skimpy bikini to sell a sports car?” Catra asks, putting herself between the creepy photographer and Adora, “She’s never worn anything like that in all her other shoots…”

“Well, this one is different.” Lashor’s smirk still firmly on his face, “It’s… *racier.* Get it?”

“Adora.” Shadow Weaver comes up behind the photographer, a confused look on her face from behind the mask, “Why aren’t you dressed?”

“She’s not wearing that.” Catra replies for her, the magicat can feel Adora’s hands fisting into her shirt, clearly unhappy with the situation.

“Come on, love.” Lashor tries again, “We’ll sell more cars if you show a little more skin.”

“Is there a problem with the outfit?” Shadow Weaver asks, her tone making it sound like Adora’s in the wrong for refusing to wear it, “Don’t forget that this shoot can open up many more doors…”

Catra laughs sardonically, “You put her in that and you’re basically telling everybody she’s going to be in adult magazines soon.” The magicat looks over the skimpy bits of fabric, “It barely covers anything.”

“That’s the point.” Lashor says whilst licking his lips, “Now, get dressed so we can start shooting. Time is money!”

“Adora. Get changed and get out there.” Shadow Weaver orders.

Catra can still feel how tense Adora is.

The magicat shakes her head, “No. She’s not doing it.”

“She’ll do it or she’ll be breaking her contract conditions.” Shadow Weaver hisses, “Or have you forgotten about that? The brand will drop you instantly. And you’ll have nothing. Is that what you want?”

“No.” Adora whispers out the word, just loud enough for Catra to hear.

“Well, hurry up then.” Shadow Weaver crosses her arms over her chest and huffs, “You’re wasting everybody’s time here otherwise.”

“I’ve got this, princess.” Catra whispers into Adora’s ear.

The blonde looks into the magicat’s eyes, “I should…”

Shaking her head, Catra says, “No. They’re wrong.”

Lashor leers over Adora once more before rolling his eyes, “We’ll be waiting on set for you. Now go get changed and get those tits out.”

He leaves before Catra growls at him.

“Adora.” Shadow Weaver’s tone now stern, “Go get changed. You’re wasting time. And money.”

“Hey, Adora?” Catra whispers.

“Yeah?”

“Is this for the brand? The one that you’re signed up for?” Catra asks.

“No. It’s a spread for a magazine or something. Ms Weaver set it up.” Adora answers, her eyes still looking into Catra’s, “Why?”

“Then you don’t need to do this.” Catra smiles.

“Yes, she does.” Shadow Weaver hisses, “She’s been contracted to do this shoot.”

“You’re wrong.” Catra releases her hold on Adora, but the blonde doesn’t let go of her, the magicat turns to Shadow Weaver, “Adora is only contracted to the brand. Not magazines. Not newspapers. Not tv stations. Only the brand. As per her contract. Anything else needs to be agreed and signed off by both the brand and Adora.” She turns to Adora, “Did you sign anything to do this shoot?”

“No. I just got the details from Ms Weaver to attend today.” Adora replies, “I thought it was for the brand.”

The magicat goes back to Shadow Weaver, “What shoot is this even for?”

“You’re not her manager. I am.” Shadow Weaver scoffs, “And Adora will do what I say.”

“No.” Adora finally looks at Shadow Weaver.

“What?” Shadow Weaver looks genuinely shocked.

“You are no longer my manager.” Adora says, “You’re fired.”

“Adora, please.” Shadow Weaver says flatly, “You have no grounds to fire me. It is simply unfair dismissal and one that I will take you to court over.”

“Go ahead.” Catra goads, “Also, read the contract.”

“I know the contract. I wrote it.” Shadow Weaver’s voice raises in irritation, “I do not need to be told by a nothing what I already know.”

Catra shrugs, “Whatever.” She turns back to Adora, “Can we get out of here?”

“Yes.” Adora grins widely in relief, “I just need to get changed back into my clothes.”

Adora quickly disappears back into the dressing room, shutting the door with a soft click as Catra turns to face Shadow Weaver only for the woman to rush her, grabbing her by the front of the shirt and slamming her into the wall next to the door.

“You insolent, little runt!” Shadow Weaver seethes, “You think you can ruin me?! Think again.”

Catra shoves her off, she drops back down to her feet and hisses at Shadow Weaver, "You're ruining Adora. I can't let you do that. I'm not going to let you do that."

"Without me, she's nothing." Shadow Weaver says as a threat.

"She doesn't need you or your dodgy contract." Catra throws back, keeping herself calm enough not to attack her, "She was doing fine before you came along."

"She makes more under my guidance than she ever had before." The statement makes Catra laugh as Shadow Weaver continues, "She's nothing without me."

"You keep saying that." Catra shakes her head, "But she doesn't need you. But it sure does sound like you need her more than she needs you…"

Scoffing, Shadow Weaver glares down at the magicat, "And you think she needs you? You? An inconvenience. A distraction. Not even human."

"Stop it!" Adora swings the door open, no longer in the bathrobe and back in the jeans and red hoodie, anger on her face, "Don't take to her like that. She's none of those things!"

"Adora." Shadow Weaver's voice softens once more, "Please. Think about this. I've set up all your bookings and shoots, have I not?"

"You have."

"I have nothing but your best interests at heart." Shadow Weaver continues, "Perhaps this shoot wasn't quite on point this time. We can try something different for the next one."

Catra scoffs, earning her another glare from the tall, dark and scary woman.

Adora shakes her head, still unhappy with her former manager, "I'm leaving. Thank you for your services, but I think it best we part ways from here on end."

A shocked sound escapes Shadow Weaver's throat, "Adora. No. Think about this. Please!"

"I have." Adora grabs Catra's hand and starts to march them out towards the exit.

"You're making a big mistake!" Shadow Weaver shouts out the threat, "You'll never work in this town again!"

Adora stops in her footsteps at that.

"She's bluffing." Catra whispers to Adora, "The brand wants you. Not… whatever this is."

Adora swallows down the rebuttal she had for Shadow Weaver, breathing out in a controlled manner as she turns back one last time and says to her former manager, "You ruin people."

And with that, Adora squeezes Catra's hand in hers and they both exit the building.

Outside

"Can you believe the nerve of her?!" Adora starts to pace back and forth next to her car, the keys in her hand as she vents, Catra leans against the driver's door patiently, "I told her I didn't want to work with Lashor ever again. And what does she do?! She has him as the main photographer!"

Catra nods, her eyes glancing over the dark blue sports car as she focuses back on Adora.

She reaches out and pulls Adora into her, arms wrapped safely around the blonde's waist as Adora leans her head into Catra's neck, "Can you drive me home?"

"Sure, princess." Catra replies.

Adora hands over the keys to Catra and then pauses, "You have a licence, right?"

"I do."

"Okay." Adora breathes out in relief, "Just… be careful. She's got more power than she looks."

"I'm sure we'll be fine, princess." Catra leans in and presses a kiss on Adora's lips, "Get in. I'll take you home."

Nodding, Adora breathes out, "Okay."

Towards Adora's place

"Where do you want me to park up?" Catra asks as they get closer to Adora's place, "Is there a garage or something?"

"Yeah. Just go past the building and turn left." Adora replies as she points out with her finger, "All the car spots are allocated by room numbers."

"Cool." Catra nods, "How many spaces do you get for your place?"

"Two."

"But you've only got the one car?" Catra asks.

"Yeah. I don't need more than one car." Adora replies amused, "And I can barely drive this one as it is."

“Why? It’s a pretty smooth drive. Plus, it’s automatic.” Catra replies with a grin as she indicates into the garage as Adora quickly pulls out her keys and presses a button on her fob, the gates open up and Catra drives down the ramp, “Hang on… if you can barely drive… how’d you get this baby to the lot?”

“Bow drove me.” Adora smiles proudly, “We worked out together and he said he’d drive us to the gym so he could borrow her for a few errands and then drop it off at the lot after. Guess he was done quicker than usual…”

“So… he’s got the spare key?” Adora nods, “He doesn’t have a car?”

“He does.” Adora says as Catra finds the allocated car spot and reverse parks the car into it before shutting off the engine and getting out, the magicat asks over the top of the car, “Then why did he need to borrow your car?”

“Ugh.” Adora groans out as they meet up by the basement parking lift, “He knows I’m not confident driving so he offered to drive me to the lot. I’m usually okay driving home since there’s no time pressures… and mostly no traffic.”

“Oh, okay.” Catra nods as the lift doors open and they get in, “Want me to ride with you when you drive? Get your confidence up?”

“Would you?”

“Of course.” Catra smiles sincerely.

“Honestly, I’ve barely driven since I got my licence a long time ago.” Adora admits as they ride the lift up to Adora’s floor, “And because I kind of stopped driving for a long time when I moved to the city and didn’t have or need a car. It’s scary to get back into after so long...”

Nodding once more, Catra asks, “So, what exactly did you do to get this modelling gig for the brand?”

“Pretend to drive it.” Adora admits shyly, her cheeks turning a faint pink, “Once they’ve got their new car model ready, I’ll be there to help launch it.”

“That’s pretty cool.” Catra admits.

“It’s basically me being recorded trying to drive it and the car being intuitive enough that I don’t kill anyone by accident.” Adora says with a sheepish grin before straightening up, “But one day I want to show them up. Like really show them up.”

“Oh yeah?”

“Yeah!” Adora nods enthusiastically as they get to Adora’s floor and the doors open up, “I want to really knock their socks off with some cool drifts or wheelies…”

“Or being able to parallel park.” Catra cuts in with a smirk.

The joke goes over Adora’s head as the blonde nods, pointing to Catra whilst doing so in agreement, “Yes! Exactly!”

The magicat laughs, “Well, it seems like your schedule’s opened up a bit…”

“Mm…” Adora hums in confirmation.

“Tomorrow. After I finish work?” Catra offers.

“Are you sure? I don’t want to inconvenience you, Cat…” Adora starts to say.

“I’m sure.” Catra nods before adding, “Just as long as Melog gets to come along too.”

A huge grin appears on Adora’s face, she leans in and presses her lips onto Catra in a soft kiss, “I would love nothing more than your shoulder cat, Melog to come with us.”

“Great.” Catra claps her hands together, a dopey grin on her face, “I’ll ask him later when we grab something for dinner.”

Catra follows Adora inside her place, the blonde shutting the door behind them and pulls the her girlfriend into her for a warm embrace, “Thank you.”

“You’re very welcome, princess.” Catra whispers back, “No one should be taking advantage of you. Especially *her.”*

Sighing, Adora groans out softly, “Ugh… now I have to find another manager…”

The magicat nods, “Do you really need one?”

“I don’t know… yes?” Adora answers unsurely.

“Why?”

“Because other people have them?” Adora replies, “You know… to manage things…?”

“Well, then…” Catra pulls back and smiles at Adora, “We’ll look for another one. A better one.”

Adora smiles back, leaning in and kissing Catra once more, “Okay. But you’re helping me.”

“Anything you want, princess.” Catra replies, sealing the deal with another kiss.

Chapter End Notes

I've upped the chapter count!
Because, I have more planned!

thanks for reading, comments, kudos, bookmarking and subscribing!

Chapter 8: Test Drives

Chapter Summary

They go see the new car that Adora's going to be promoting.

Chapter Notes

thanks for waiting!
Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Melog. Are you planning on ditching me again for Frankie?" Catra eyes the cat that has taken up their spot on the soft cushioned bench meant for visitors, "Come on, dude. You're not even visiting. You're practically a squatter by now."

Meow

"I've been passed over for a couch." Catra grumbles, making Adora giggle at the sight of Melog now getting into peak comfort, stretching out and staring back at them lazily, "Whatever, dude. Just… don't make a mess."

"Melog will be fine." Frankie laughs, going over and giving the freeloading cat pets, "He's good company on these slow nights."

"Are you sure, Frankie?" Catra asks for the third time, "I don't want to inconvenience you."

"I'm sure." Frankie nods and then looks at Adora, "Miss Adora. How did your photoshoot go?"

"It didn't." Adora replies with a shrug of her shoulders as Frankie gives her a confused look, "It was not what I thought it was going

to be."

"Adora walked off after firing her manager." Catra supplies with a proud look on her face, "It was epic."

Frankie smiles, "I didn't like her, Miss Adora."

"You got that too?" Catra asks genuinely surprised, "She tried to get me kicked out."

"I remember when she came here that one time and from that moment, I knew." Frankie says and then looks at Adora, "But I thought that perhaps it was different when it came to you, Miss Adora."

"She's two faced." Catra states, "Anyway, Adora got rid of her even with Ms Weaver trying to pull a fast one of her."

"Oh?"

"She tried to threaten me with a lawsuit if I terminated her contract." Adora explains, "But I'm lucky that Catra jumped in there and told her what for."

Frankie looks at Catra, a proud look on his face, a simple nod to the magicat and then he turns back to Adora, "Good riddance to your former manager. I have to say that since she took over, your content has been more… adult. Not very you."

"If you mean that she wanted to turn Adora's brand into adult entertainment, you wouldn't be too off the mark, Frankie." Catra replies, "That photographer she hired was an absolute jerk. And the language he used made me want to claw his eyes out."

"But you didn't." Adora quickly grabs Catra's hand and squeezes it, "And I'm glad you didn't. Because Weaver would have used that against you and me."

"Violence doesn't solve everything, kid." Frankie agrees, "Although sometimes it's the only way, especially when you're being

attacked.”

“True.” Catra nods and then looks over at Melog stretching out and then gets more comfortable, “Alright bud, I guess you’re going to be Frankie’s problem tonight.”

Meow

Melog starts to purr as he gets to peak comfortable on the plush bench, shutting his eyes and pretending to sleep.

Frankie coos at the cat, “He is so cute.”

“And… he is your problem.” Catra grins, patting Frankie on the shoulder in consolation, “Kick him out if he starts scratching up the place.”

“Oh, he would never.” Frankie puts his hands on his hips in defence, “My Melog is very well behaved.”

“Your Melog?” Catra raises an eyebrow up at the doorman and then glances over at Melog and swears she can see him smirk, “Traitor.”

Adora laughs, “Oh, poor baby.” She wraps her arms around Catra in a hug, “Come upstairs with me and I’ll make you feel better.”

Catra mrrps, she sighs, “Cuddles?”

“Whatever you want, Cat.” Adora whispers.

The magicat’s ears perk up and she grins, “Cuddles it is.”

That makes Adora laugh, “Then I will cuddle you for as long and as much as you want.”

Catra looks at Melog, sticks her tongue out at her *former* shoulder cat, “You can keep Frankie. I’ve got Adora.”

Meow

Melog stands up, shaking out his fur and then leaping off the bench and curls around Catra’s ankles and then jumps up onto her shoulder, purring and rubbing against her cheek.

“We’re good, dude.” Catra reaches up and scratches behind his ear, “Keep Frankie safe, okay?”

Meow

Melog stretches out and headbutts against Adora’s cheek.

The blonde chuckles, reaching out and running her hand through the fur of his back, “Hey, Melog.”

He purrs louder in Catra’s ear as Adora coos at him.

“Okay. We’re going to go up.” Catra softly says to Melog, “Go bug Frankie.”

Meow

Catra winces a little as she feels his claws dig into her shoulder as he jumps off and heads back to the bench that he has now claimed as his own. The magicat sighs and then turns to Frankie,

“I’ll bring one of those sticky roller thingies to get all his fur off the bench, Frankie.”

“No need.” Frankie puts his hand up and then produces one from inside his blazer pocket as Adora and Catra pull back from their hug but keep their fingers intertwined, he grins at the pair, “I am always prepared for anything.”

Adora smiles.

“Do you always carry that around?” Catra looks at the sticky roller in his hand.

“Lots of lint around, kid.” Frankie simply says, “Plus, it comes in handy with many a tenant. Especially those that have job interviews and jobs or dates to get to.”

Catra laughs and nods, “Okay, that I get.”

He nods back, “Good.”

“Okay, Frankie. We’re going to head up now.” Adora tugs Catra towards the elevators, “Have a good night! Bye, Melog!”

Meow

Adora giggles at Melog’s response, “So cute.”

“Be good, dude.” Catra calls out and then grins at Frankie as the lift doors open, “And you too Frankie.”

Frankie waves to the pair as they disappear into the elevator.

Adora’a bed

“I thought I was supposed to get cuddles, princess.” Catra complains lightly with a chuckle as she stares at Adora’s back, “I feel like I’m doing all the work.”

Adora turns around from being the little spoon and glares lightly at her magicat, “Are you saying loving me is work?”

Catra’s face softens, “Loving you is easy.”

“Then?”

“Turn back over, princess and let me do my job.” Catra waggles her finger around in the air.

Rolling her eyes, Adora gasps when Catra leans in and presses their lips together in a soft kiss, the blonde melting into the kiss, “Mm…”

“I love you.” Catra whispers, “So much…”

Adora smiles back dopily, “I love you too.”

“Good. Now, turn back over.” Catra tries to say without laughing and failing.

Adora pulls her back in for another kiss, pushing the magicat onto her back and climbing on top and kissing her deeper and when she pulls back, she smiles down and whispers, “Hey.”

“Hey, Adora.” Catra whispers back, cupping Adora’s cheek with one hand, “You’re so beautiful. How did I get so lucky?”

Adora giggles, “I think I’m the lucky one.”

“Not really, considering all the times you’ve had assholes hit on you and not taken the hint that it was unwarranted and unwanted.” Catra brings up making Adora groan out, flopping her full weight on top of the magicat who shakes with laughter, “But

I'd step in and take those assholes down a peg every time for you."

"I know you would." Adora mumbles into Catra's neck, pressing a soft kiss against it, "Hopefully once I show you off more often, those assholes will stay home and leave me alone."

Catra grins, "How are you planning on showing me off, princess?"

"Everywhere." Adora replies, her warm breath on Catra's neck.

"Everywhere, huh?"

Adora nods.

"Are you sure?" Catra's body tenses a little without her meaning to, "I'm not exactly… date material."

The blonde pushes herself up and stares down at Catra confused, "Catra."

"What? It's true." The magicat shrugs, "I know when I'm batting out of my league. And in all circumstances, you are in the professional leagues and I'm hitting it out with the little kids."

"You think I'm out of your league?" Adora's face softens but there's a hint of amusement in her eyes.

"You totally are." Catra says with seriousness, "You're not just out of my league. You're out of my universe. And I have no idea why you're even with me."

"You really have no idea?" Adora asks staring down at the magicat with a raised eyebrow.

Catra shakes her head, "You could do so much better, princess. Like, *so* much better."

"I don't want better." Adora replies, leaning down and pressing a kiss to Catra's lips, "I want you. I love you."

“I love you too.” Catra leans up and chases Adora’s lips, the blonde pulls back and just out of reach, “Adora.”

“And you’re wrong.”

“About?”

“Being out of my league.” Adora rubs her thumb against Catra’s cheek, a soft smile on her lips.

“How so?” Catra leans into Adora’s touch and purrs quietly.

“Because.”

“Because what…” Catra rasps out, “Princess?”

“Because…” Adora leans in and presses a kiss on Catra’s lips, “No one else stepped in when ever those assholes were harassing me. Just you.”

“People are assholes.” The magicat simply says.

“Not you.” The blonde kisses Catra again, this time a little deeper, “You just stepped in and put those assholes back into their place before I could punch them out myself.”

“I wouldn’t want you to get into trouble, princess.” Catra justifies, “You’re too important to be arrested. And too pretty.”

Adora giggles, “Well, I don’t want you arrested either.”

“Can’t get me arrested.” Catra smiles back, “Not if I haven’t done anything wrong.”

“Mm…” Adora leans down and kisses Catra again, “Be my plus one?”

“Hm?”

“I have a… thing to go to next Friday night.” Adora says laying back down fully on top of Catra, “Be my plus one?”

“What is this… thing?” Catra asks.

“Just a little… promo thing.” Adora says muffled once more in Catra’s neck.

“A promo, huh?” The magicat’s hands move down Adora’s body and land on her waist, giving it a gently squeeze, “For what?”

“The new car they are planning to unveil…” Adora replies, “It’s the CX series.”

“CX?”

“It’s supposed to be like one hundred and ten in roman numerals.” Adora says, “Like it’s better than one hundred.”

“Because it’s one hundred and ten?” Catra grins back with her eyes shut as Adora presses their lips together.

“Exactly.” Adora huffs out a laugh, “So?”

“Hm?”

“Be my plus one?” Adora asks again.

“Where’s it at and what time?” Catra asks back.

“Starts at seven at the Brightmoon Event and Exhibition Centre.” The blonde replies, “But the promotional bit with the press and photographers starts at five…”

“Do you want to do all the promotional stuff?” The question from the magicat takes Adora by surprise, “Your contract doesn’t stipulate that you have to do any of that. You know that, right?”

“Really?”

The surprise in Adora’s voice tells Catra everything she needs to know, the magicat wraps her arms around her blonde and sighs, “I think we need to go through your contract together. Your old manager really did a number on you.”

Adora breathes out, “Yeah, she really did.”

“We can go through it in the morning.” Catra says as she tips them over and rolls Adora onto her side so she can spoon her, “But first, let me get back to work.”

Giggling, Adora pushes her butt back into Catra’s front, the magicat purring up a storm as she wraps her up tightly in her arms and gives the blonde the cuddling of her life.

Wednesday

“Okay, why are we here?” Catra asks as she parks up Adora’s car in front of the Swift W car showroom, a vale comes over and opens the doors for them, she turns to Adora, “What’s going on?”

“They’ll park her for us.” Adora simply says as she gets out of the car before sticking her head back inside, “Come on, Cat. You’re going to make me late.”

Catra unbuckles her seatbelt, the car still running as she looks to Adora, “Do I like, leave the car running or turn it off?”

“Leave it running.” Adora makes her way to the driver’s door with a smile, “The valet will take care of her.”

“Okay.” Catra says as she checks the park brake is on before stepping out, “She’s all yours, dude.”

The valet nods, giving Catra a token before getting in and driving off with Adora’s car.

Adora grabs Catra’s hand and starts tugging her forward, the magicat chuckles at the blonde’s enthusiasm, “What’s the rush, princess?”

“You’ll see!” Adora giggles as she continues to pull Catra forward and inside the massive showroom.

In the middle of the showroom, is a car covered in a silver cloth, lit up like it’s on display.

They stop in front of it and Catra just looks at Adora, “I’m going to guess there’s a car underneath that cloth.”

“Well, duh.” Adora replies still smiling widely as a tall woman with straight black hair and a long dark purple dress, topped off with a gold tiara approaches, “Oh, Catra. There’s someone I’d like you to meet!”

The magicat straightens up, “Hello.”

“Oh, you must be Catra. Adora has told me so much about you!” The woman greets with a genuine smile, “I’m Castaspella. But everyone just calls me Casta.”

“It’s nice to meet you, Castaspella. Uh, I mean Casta.” Catra nods to her, not sure if she should hold her hand out for a handshake or kiss the back of this tall woman’s hand, the magicat looks around unsurely, “Adora hasn’t really told me what we’re doing here.”

“Oh, she hasn’t?” Castaspella looks over at Adora, the blonde smiling widely as she squeezes Catra’s hand in hers, a smile tugs wider on the taller woman’s lips, “Well, I think you will like this.”

“Okay…” Catra says confused as they follow Castaspella towards the covered car as she mumbles, “For the love of the stars, please do not give me a car…”

Castaspella raises an eyebrow up at the magicat, her eyes flit over to Adora who continues to beam happily.

“Do you not want a car, Catra?” Casta tilts her head and asks bemused.

Shaking her head, Catra grimaces slightly, “Cars are an expense I can’t afford, Casta.”

“Oh.”

“I don’t think I could afford the insurance, roadside, maintenance, fuel and registration costs.” Catra lists off looking away, “Plus I’d have nowhere safe to park it at night.”

Castaspella takes a moment to think, humming out in thought before she clicks her fingers together and grins at the magicat, “How about this? If you ever need a car, you just text me and I’ll have one ready for you to use.”

“You don’t need to do that.” Catra says looking away awkwardly, that is until she feels Adora squeeze her hand, the magicat’s eye catches Adora’s soft look and she sighs, “It’s very thoughtful, Casta, I’ll have to think about it but thank you for the offer.”

Castaspella seems to be satisfied with that answer, reaching into the secret pocket of her dress and pulls out a business card, “Here. Anytime.”

Catra takes the card and reads it, she looks up, “Thank you.”

“I expect you to text me about utilising a car to take Adora out on dates with.” Castaspella says like a warning, “Because if I don’t hear from you, Adora will be hearing from me.”

Adora laughs, “Don’t worry, Casta. I’ll make sure Catra texts you.”

“Good.” Castaspella nods approvingly, “Okay, so, are you ready for the big unveil?”

Catra and Adora stay standing side by side waiting for Castraspella to do the big unveiling, but she doesn’t. She just stares at the pair with a smile on her face.

“Uh, Casta? Are you going to… you know?” Adora gestures to the vehicle behind her.

“No.” Castraspella smiles and then takes a step back, “Go on, Adora.”

“Me?”

“Of course, you. Who else?” Castraspella rolls her eyes before reaching out and grabbing both of them and pulls them forward, “Come on, come on! Pull off the cloth already!”

Catra laughs, “Go ahead, princess.”

“Don’t you want to do it?” Adora asks.

“This is your world, princess.” Catra says, “Besides, I want to see how the pros do this.”

Rolling her eyes, Adora laughs, “You’re such an idiot. I’m literally pulling off a cloth.”

“I want to watch. I’ve never seen an unveiling of a car before.” Catra grins, taking a step back, “I feel like I should be filming this.”

“You can if you want.” Adora says a little bashfully, not really wanting to be filmed at this moment but if Catra wants to, then she’d be okay doing it.

“Nah, I think I want to experience this without a camera.” Catra declares noticing the slight shift in Adora’s demeanour, “Okay, come on, princess. Let’s see what’s underneath.”

“Okay.” Adora looks over at Castaspella, the older woman smiles back with a nod, “Right. Here we go.”

Adora takes the edge of the cloth and tugs it off in one smooth motion, Catra quickly gathers up the cloth in her arms and holds on to it as they finally see what’s underneath.

“Casta…” Adora says softly, her eyes staring at the white vehicle with rainbow stripes down the sides of the sports car, “What…?”

“This is the new Swift CX.” Castaspella gestures to the car like she’s presenting it to them, “It’s a prototype. We designed this to match our model.”

“It’s nifty.” Catra nods approvingly.

“It’s beautiful.” Adora whispers, carefully reaching out and tentatively touching the bonnet.

“You want to take it for a test drive?” Casta asks playfully.

“Um, it’s too beautiful for me to take out and wreck it with my terrible driving.” Adora replies sheepishly, “I don’t really want a repeat of the B series…”

“Oh, don’t be silly.” Castaspella laughs, “This model is practically indestructible.”

That makes Catra chuckle under her breath, “What’s it made of?”

“No idea.” Castaspella answers with another laugh, “But I’ve driven this and I still didn’t crash it.”

Catra nudges Adora and whispers, “Is that a good thing?”

Adora nods back subtly before feeling herself relax a little, “Well, I guess we can take it for a test drive.”

“Fantastic.” Castrspella claps her hands together before looking around the showroom, “Let me just find someone to move it outside…”

Catra does a walkaround of the new sports car, keeping her hands behind her back to stop herself from reaching out and touching it, she peeks inside, “Automatic transmission.”

“Yes, it is. Most people nowadays only drive auto. Manual is starting to go out of style.” Castaspella confirms, “I find manual transmission difficult sometimes too. Especially on hills.”

Catra nods.

“We have the original manual model out in the lot.” Castaspella mentions just as one of the workers arrives, “Ah, Mel! Can you please have Adora’s new car brought outside and to the testing track? Also, we’re going to go out to the testing lot and take the CX manual model out for a drive too.”

“Of course, Miss Casta.” Mel nods and heads towards the office to retrieve the keys, “Be right back.”

The testing track

Adora’s sits in her new car, adjusting the seats and mirror and winding down her drivers window, smiling widely at Catra in the black manual CX model parked next to hers.

“This feels like we’re going to be drag racing or something.” Adora jokes waving to her magicat, “I’m I’d so win.”

Catra smiles back, “Get your pretty ass in here, princess.”

“No. You get your cute self in here.” Adora retorts with a grin, her eyes widen when Catra shrugs and gets out of the other car, casually walks over and gets into the passenger seat of Adora’s new CX, “That was… unexpected.”

“You asked me, so I did.” Catra simply says as she buckles up, “Let’s see what this car can do.”

Adora laughs nervously, “Let me just…” the blonde takes a deep breath in, “Get my bearings first…”

“It’s not a race, princess. Just a test drive.” Catra reminds her girlfriend, “You’re just testing out the car before you promote it. Cool?”

That seems to settle Adora’s nerves, she just looks over at the magicat and smiles lopsidedly, “Thank you. Usually, I have one of the mechanics or engineering people sitting in the car with me, asking a bunch of questions while I try not to crash.”

“Well, princess.” Catra stretches out in the passenger’s seat and lets a purr out, “There shall be no such inquisitions from me. The most I’m going to ask is how easy is this to handle.”

Adora’s smile widens, “I think you should have a turn after me.”

Catra looks over amused.

“You know? Just to confirm what I say about this car.” Adora replies with a nod, “See if we’re on the same page or not.”

“Are you going to try out that one too?” Catra gestures towards the black model that she was just in before, “It’d be a good practise in a controlled environment.”

“No, I’m not licenced for manual transmission.” Adora replies.

Catra nods, “No worries then.”

“Just like that? You’re not going to push?” Adora asks a little surprised of the lack of challenge from the magicat.

“No. Why?” Catra asks back.

Adora shrugs, scrunching up her face a little in thought, her brows furrows slightly before turning back to Catra, “It’s just usually people push. Try to make me do things I don’t want to do.” She chuckles lowly, awkwardly, “But sometimes I guess it’s a good thing. I mean I have tried things I never thought I would have if it wasn’t for a little push.”

“There’s a difference between a little push and coercion.” Catra points out, “I do not want to make you do anything you are uncomfortable with, Adora. Ever.”

Adora reaches over and grabs Catra by the collar of her jacket and pulls her in for a kiss, her hand rests on her magicat’s chest even after they part, the blonde sighs happily, “I love you.”

“I know.” Catra smiles back, “I love you too.”

Nodding, “Okay, we should uh…”

“Get driving?” Catra chuckles into another soft kiss.

“Yes, that.” Adora giggles back, leaning in for one more kiss before pulling back and setting her hands on the steering wheel, “Ready?”

“Start her up, princess.” The magicat sits back and relaxes.

Back inside the showroom

“So? What did you think?” Castaspella asks when the pair walk back into the showroom, her gaze drops down to their joined hands and then another thought comes into her mind, “You two didn’t…” she makes some rather interesting and a little lewd hand gestures and then looks back at them, “…do anything in those cars, did you?”

“What are you insinuating, Casta?” Catra asks amusedly, watching the older woman look flustered at even the thought of the pair like that, “If you are asking if we had sex in the cars, the answer is no.”

“Catra!” Adora whispers harshly, her face turning red at the fact that Castaspella had even thought that would happen.

The older woman seems genuinely relieved upon hearing that they did not in fact do anything untoward in those cars, she turns her attention to Catra, “So, what did you think? It’s like driving a race car, right?”

“It was fine.” Catra shrugs, “I’m not really a car person.”

“Oh.” Castaspella says a little surprised, “From the way I watched you drive, you seem like you knew what you were doing. I’ve never seen someone drift with such ease around the corners of the testing track, well, apart from the professional drivers we get to come into test drives before we take it to location for filming.”

“Uh, thanks?” Catra replies bashfully.

“Say, how would you like to do a little bit of show driving for us?” Castaspella asks staring at the magicat, “We’d pay you for your services, of course.”

“Can I think about it?” Catra asks instead, “I’m not exactly a professional at this whole driving bizz.”

“Of course.” The older woman replies with a smile, “You’ve got my business card. So, just reach out when you’re ready.”

“Thank you.” Catra nods back.

“What about you, Adora?” Castaspella turns her attention to the blonde, “Was I right? Practically indestructible.”

Adora chuckles nervously, “You were right.”

The older woman laughs quietly, leaning in and nudging Adora playfully, “This is why we have the test track. We wouldn’t make you drive anything you weren’t familiar with.”

“Thank you.” Adora nods back graciously.

“Now. Where is your… manager?” Castaspella looks around warily, obviously looking for Shadow Weaver.

“Adora fired her.” Catra supplies with a smirk.

“You did?” Castaspella turns to Adora, who looks a little sheepish, before she claps her hands together and laughs, “Thank the stars! What brought that about?”

Catra wraps her arm around Adora’s waist, “It was just time for them to part ways.”

Adora looks over at Catra with an appreciative smile on her lips, bumping the magicat lightly and whispering, “Thank you.”

“Well, in any case. I, for one, am very glad that she is no longer your manager, Adora.” Castaspella says approvingly, “If I had to deal with that woman one more time…”

Catra chuckles, “I dealt with her once and I had enough of her.”

“Oh?”

“She tried to have me booted from Adora’s photoshoot for simply being there to support her.” Catra replies.

“I asked Catra to be there.” Adora adds, “She completely disregarded anything I asked or said. I don’t know why I kept her for so long. The jobs that she kept getting kept getting worse.”

“I’m glad you got rid of her.” Castaspella reiterates, “In the meantime, will you be handling all the paperwork and contracts?”

Adora grimaces, truth be told, paperwork wasn’t her strongest suit, not since she started making serious money.

“I’ll help you out until you find yourself a new manager, Adora.” Catra steps in, “I might not have much, but I’ve made do with what I do have. And I can look over any paperwork or contracts that come your way.”

“You would?” Adora says surprised at the offer.

“Yeah. I have nothing else to do apart from my few shifts with Perfuma and Scorpia.” Catra replies, “And I haven’t heard back from any other event gigs since I sort of caused a scene at the last one I was at.”

“You mean the one where you ruined your shirt to help me out?” Adora recalls the memory.

“That’s the one.” Catra nods in confirmation, “Turns out that was the last straw after I pulled a similar stunt at a different event, not quite the same circumstances but pretty close.”

“Another pretty girl?” Adora raises an eyebrow at the magicat.

“Actually, no.” Catra rubs the back of her neck, “It was Kyle. One of the kitchenhands who was getting berated for something that wasn’t even his fault by a jerk of a patron. Long story short, I tipped their soup in their lap, by accident of course.”

“You tipped their soup in their lap?” Adora repeats slowly.

“It was the cold kind of soup. The tomato one or whatever.” Catra waves her hand in the air, “Which now to think about it was the reason why this jerk was complaining. Turns out they didn’t even know what they were ordering was supposed to be cold. And unfortunately for poor Kyle who was just making his way to the kitchen to deliver tomatoes, he got caught in the crossfire.”

“That’s terrible.” Castaspella says, her brows furrowing in reaction.

“Well, yeah. But I was just a casual with that company, so no big deal, I guess.” The magicat shrugs nonchalantly, “It’s fine. I always land on my feet. I’ve got a few permanent shifts with Perfuma at the bar, that’ll keep me tied over until I get a little more work.”

“Or… you could be Adora’s new manager.” Castaspella suggests easily.

“I don’t really like mixing business and pleasure.” Catra looks over at Adora as she replies, “It just gets… messy in the long run. And I don’t want to have that hanging over our heads if things go sour.”

Castaspella nudges Adora, “I like this one. Keeper.”

Adora’s face flushes but she nods, “I love this one and I plan on keeping her.”

“I can hear you, you know?” Catra quirks an eyebrow up at the pair before sighing, “I’ll help you out until we find you a suitable manager to take over. I’ll even help you look.”

Adora leans in and presses their lips together, “Thank you.” She turns back to the other woman, “Casta, you can send my all the paperwork and contracts directly to me. I’ll have Catra look over them in the meantime until we find someone else to help me manage all this.”

“You got it.” Castaspella nods back to her, “Okay, I’ve got to get going. I’ve got a meeting with the promotions team to see what they are planning for this new car.” She points to Catra, “Text me. Seriously. I want to know where you’re at with my proposal of having you as part of the driving team.”

“Uh… I don’t know if I’d feel right about stepping into the driving team.” Catra says, “I’m not even qualified or…”

“Hush.” Castaspella shuts Catra down swiftly, “No one gets to where they are without getting given a shot in the first place. Remember that. And if anyone tries to make you feel less than, ask them where they started from. Because I can guarantee you, no one gets to where they are without a little luck or a helping hand. Hard work can only get you so far, same thing with talent.”

“Yeah but…” Catra tries to protest.

“Nope.” Castaspella holds her hand up to stop the magicat from speaking, “If anyone in this company tries any of that, they are

not welcome here. That attitude is not what we want or need. And it will be dealt with swiftly. My company is built from one of respect and transparency. Two very simple things."

The magicat nods, clearing her throat, "I'll take that onboard. Thank you, Casta."

"Great. Fantastic. I really have to go." Castaspella says already starting to rush off, "Take a car home if you'd like."

Adora laughs, "No need, Casta. I've got my car."

Castaspella waves to them before leaving.

"She's… interesting." Catra chuckles as she grabs Adora's hand, "I've got a shift tonight at the bar to get ready for."

Adora nods, "Come on, let's get my car and you can drive us home."

"Home?" Catra raises an eyebrow.

"Yes. Home." Adora repeats with a smile, "Let's go home."

"Cool. Very cool." Catra nods as she pulls out the valet token and grins, "Home."

Adora smiles back and then says, "Do you think Melog would like to call it home too?"

"Princess." Catra says with a raised eyebrow, "Melog has already become a squatter at your place. And Frankie is practically his legal guardian."

Adora laughs and nods, "Okay. Take us home, Catra."

Chapter End Notes

So... does that mean Catra's moving in?
Maybe? I don't know...

thanks for reading, comments, kudos, subscribing and bookmarking!
I hope y'all are still enjoying this :)

Chapter 9: Almost Anything

Chapter Summary

Adora asks if Catra wants to come back with her to see Castaspella.

Chapter Notes

CW: Violence and Fluff.

Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“Hey, so Casta asked about you today.” Adora brings up as she leans into Catra’s side as they lounge about on Adora’s couch.

“Yeah?” Catra turns her head, her cheek rubbing against Adora’s, “Why?”

“I don’t know if you’ve heard…” Adora turns and lays down across the couch, her head in Catra’s lap looking up at her magicat, “Casta has been asking about you a lot. She was really impressed with your driving the other day.”

Catra smiles down, her fingers softly caressing Adora’s cheek as the blonde closes her eyes, “Yeah?”

“Yes.” Adora replies with a hum, “Do you want to come with me to see her again?”

Catra tilts her head, her fingers continue to gently rub against her cheek, “You’re going back there again?”

“Mmhm.” The blonde nods, “She called me and asked if you could join me.”

“Feels like a trap, princess.” Catra chuckles, her fingers thread through Adora’s loose blonde locks, “Is she angry that I didn’t call

her? It has been two weeks…”

Adora rolls her eyes up at the magicat, “It’s not a trap and she’s not angry.”

“When are you going back to see her?” Catra asks looking down, “I’ve got a shift tonight at the bar.”

“I know.” Adora sighs, “What time do you finish?”

“Just after the dinner rush. I’m not hanging around for the drinking crowd after.” Catra answers, “So, probably around nine.”

“That’s a pretty short shift.” Adora says as she pushes herself up so she can sit up, moving herself so she’s now sitting in Catra’s lap, “Maybe I can get some dinner there too, wait for you to finish.”

“I’m going to be busy, princess.” Catra replies, moving so her arm to keep Adora stable, “I might not have time to stop.”

“It’s fine, Catra.” Adora smiles, leaning in and pressing her lips against Catra’s cheek, “In my opinion, I get the best of both worlds in this situation.”

“How so?” The magicat’s ears perk up as she grins staring at Adora’s lips, licking her own.

“Because.” Adora leans in and presses their lips together, “I get to eat dinner *and* watch you work.”

Catra finds herself laughing into the kiss, “You want to watch me work?”

Adora nods while laughing softly too.

“You know…” Catra pecks Adora’s lips, “You’re just going to be watching me pick up empty plates and glasses, right? Not exactly the sexiest thing to be watching.”

“Doesn’t have to be sexy.” Adora whispers, “I just like seeing you. Doing whatever.”

“Doing whatever?” Catra repeats, “Or I could be doing… whoever…”

“Whoever huh?” Adora raises an eyebrow up teasingly, “Do I know this… *whoever?”*

“Oh, I think you know this *whoever,* very well.” Catra drawls playfully.

“Hm…” Adora pretends to think, she knocks her forehead against Catra’s lightly, “Do I? Describe this… *whoever.”*

Catra laughs under her breath, “You do.” She leans back and rubs her cheek against Adora’s, “Well, this… *whoever,* is very beautiful. Extremely kind. Gives the best scritches and my cat seems to have taken a very big liking to her, her doorman and her building.”

Adora pulls back and laughs, “Melog belongs to Frankie and this building now.”

“Yeah, he does.” Catra smiles back, “I should go down and congratulate Frankie for adopting a son.”

“He is very well behaved.” Adora says proudly, before she furrows her brows, “What about me? Don’t I get to adopt Melog too?”

“Princess. You’ve already been adopted by him.” Catra says grinning, “You can’t abandon your child now.”

“My child?” Adora giggles, “Stars, what have I gotten myself into?”

“Well, I’m pretty sure you’ve gotten yourself into a little thing called… love.” Catra says smoothly before she breaks out in a laugh, adding, “And I’m submerged fully in it with you.”

“Stars…” Adora breathes out with a wide grin, “Yeah, I’m completely in there with you.”

“I know.” Catra mirrors Adora’s grin, as she looks around, “What time is it?”

“Just after one, I think.” Adora says and then wraps her arms around Catra’s neck, “Still got a few hours before you have to get ready, right?”

“Yeah. Whatever shall we do?” The magicat asks light heartedly, pressing her lips against Adora’s cheek and jaw, “Or is it… a whoever shall I do, question?”

Giggling, Adora shoves Catra, “I love you.”

“Want me to show you how much I love you too?” Catra starts to press kisses along Adora’s neck, making the blonde giggle, “But… then again, I think I’d prefer to take my time showing you.”

“Mm…” Adora hums out with her eyes closed, “So, do you want to come with me to see Casta at the showroom again?”

“When?” Catra asks, “I’ll have to see what my schedule is like.”

“I’m meeting her at 9am on Thursday.” Adora nuzzles into Catra’s neck, “Mm… soft.”

“Thursday, huh.” Catra mulls it over in her brain, trying to bring up her schedule before replying, “I should be free. Or well, I can make myself free to go with you.”

“You’d make yourself free for me?” Adora teases.

“I’d do anything for you, princess.” Catra declares and when Adora looks into her eyes, she knows it true, “Just, please don’t ask me to kill anyone for you…”

Adora snorts out a laugh, “Stars, no! I wouldn’t do that. Although…”

Catra tilts her head to the blonde and makes an interested sound.

“Although…” Adora continues, “I do expect you to help me hide the body.”

“Stars…” Catra breathes out a laugh, “That, I can do.”

“Really?” The word is drawn out as Adora laughs softly, “You’d help me hide a body.”

Catra grins, chuckling under her breath and then nods, “I mean… if you asked me real nice… I’ll be the reason there will be a body to hide.”

Adora’s eyes widen, she leans in and kisses Catra’s cheek, “Well, let’s hope that scenario never has to come about, like at all.”

“I don’t know, princess…” Catra teases before a low growl escapes her lips, “There’s already been a few that have made me want to claw them to pieces.”

“I’m glad that you didn’t.” Adora soothes her magicat with a few more kisses until the low growl turns into a purr, “Oh, speaking of things that did happen. I’ve got something for you.”

“You do?” Catra asks surprised.

“Yes.” Adora quickly pecks Catra on the lips, “Wait here. I’ll be right back.”

Nodding, Catra reluctantly releases her hold on Adora so she can get up and retrieve whatever she’s got for her, sitting back on the couch and closes her eyes. Her ears pick up Adora’s movements around the apartment, the sound of footsteps and rustling about as her ears moving about on the top of her head.

She smiles, her eyes still closed as she hears Adora come back, the sound of a something rustling in her hands as she feels Adora’s weight sit back down on her lap, she can’t help but chuckle, wrapping her arms around the blonde from behind.

“I love when you sit on my lap, princess.” Catra says opening her eyes and resting her chin on Adora’s shoulder, she sees a something wrapped up in white paper with colourful stars all over it, like a present in the blonde’s hand, “Whatcha got there?”

Adora turns around, a slight blush on her face as she holds the present out to Catra, “Here. For you.”

“For me?” Catra gingerly takes the present from Adora, the blonde practically shoves it the rest of the way into the magicat’s hands, “Why?”

“Because I wanted to.” Adora replies turning around so she can see Catra open it, “Well, go on. Open it.”

“Why?” Catra repeats again, looking at the present in her hands.

“Catra.” Adora puts her hands over her magicat’s, “I don’t need a reason to give you things other than how much I love you. So, please, open it.”

Catra’s nods, turning the present over in her hands once Adora removes hers, “Okay.”

A sharp claw cuts neatly through the wrapping paper carefully, her hands pull it open to reveal something black inside. Adora pulls the wrapper out of Catra’s hand and scrunches it up in a ball as she watches Catra out a black faux leather jacket out and look it over.

“Well, do you like it?” Adora asks a little nervously, she bites her bottom lip while she waits for an answer.

The silence from the magicat has Adora questioning her choice.

“You hate it.” Adora surmises before Catra even answers, “I can take it back and change it to something else that you like. We can go together if you want. I think I still have the receipt somewher-mmmpf!”

Catra crashes their lips together, the blonde's eyes widen before melting into the kiss.

Still unsure, Adora leans her forehead against Catra's, "Do you hate it?"

"No." Catra looks up into Adora's eyes, "I love it. Thank you, Adora."

Adora breathes out in relief, before shoving Catra back, "You could have just said something before! I thought you hated it."

"Why would I hate it?" Catra asks looking at Adora fondly, "I could never hate anything from you."

"Are you just saying that to make me feel better?" Adora narrows her eyes at the magicat, "Because you can tell me if you don't like it. We can take it back and exchange it for something else."

Catra leans in and presses her lips against Adora's, a grin on her face as she slides the blonde off her lap so she can stand up, taking the jacket and sliding it on over her tshirt, popping the collar before turning to Adora while sticking her hands into the pockets of it, "Well, what do you think? Does it make me look silly?"

Adora huffs, "You don't look silly, Catra."

The magicat pats her new jacket down and smiles, "I've never had something like this before."

"You've had jacket before." Adora laughs.

"Nothing this nice." Catra rubs her face against the collar, "Soft."

Adora smiles back, "You really like it, right?"

Rolling her eyes, Catra pulls Adora up to her feet, "I love it."

“Good.” Adora nods happily before pointing her finger at the magicat, “Also, don’t you go buying things for me just because I got you this jacket.”

“Why not?” The question asked by a little confused by Catra, “You’re allowed to get me stuff, but I’m not allowed to get you anything?”

“I don’t need stuff, Catra. I just need you.” Adora replies much to Catra chagrin.

“Well…” Catra starts to say, not wanting to be outdone, “I don’t need stuff either.”

“Your jacket got ruined to help me out. It’s the least I can do.” Adora says.

“I’d do it again.” The declaration and the smirk on Catra’s face has Adora pulling the magicat in for another kiss. When they part, the magicat whispers, “What can I do to get more of that?”

Adora laughs, “You don’t have to do anything but be yourself, Catra. And I’ll kiss you as much as you want.”

“Good to know.”

Perfuma’s Bar & Bistro

“Adora! It’s so good to see you again!” Perfuma greets loudly as Adora walks in hanging onto Catra’s arm, the magicat whispering something into Adora’s ear before heading behind the bar and towards the kitchen while Adora walks over Perfuma. She’s quickly pulled into a hug despite only meeting once, “Can I get you a drink?”

“Water, please.” Adora replies when Perfuma releases her and guides her to the bar.

“Are you here for dinner?” Perfuma asks as she ducks behind the bar and grabs a clean glass, “Ice?”

“Sure. And yeah, I am planning to stay for dinner.” Adora replies.

A few cubes of ice clink as Perfuma drops them into the glass before she fills it up with water, “Here you go.”

“Thank you.” Adora smiles, quickly taking a sip and then reaching for her wallet, “How much?”

“Water is free, Adora.” Perfuma says with a smile, “Dinner service starts at 6pm. But I can get you a menu to look over until then.”

Adora nods, “Thank you.”

Perfuma reaches under the bar and pulls out a stack of menus, dropping them on the top of the bench and then passes one to Adora, “Just go over to the other counter over there to order when you’re ready. Unfortunately, we won’t be able to make it for you until Huntara arrives for her shift.”

“That’s fine.” Adora looks to the other counter that Perfuma gestured to, “I’m in no rush.”

“Catra should be done by 9pm. 930pm at the latest.” Perfuma says looking towards the main dining area where Catra is doing a quick check over the tables to make sure they’re clean and all the chairs pushed in, “It shouldn’t be too busy tonight being Monday.”

“Yeah?” Adora asks smiling fondly at her magicat moving around the space with care and attention.

“Yes. Monday nights are usually our slowest nights. But we stay open for our regulars.” Perfuma replies looking to where Adora’s is staring, “I’m glad we have regulars because without them out business wouldn’t be thriving.”

Adora nods, “Am I alright to just hang out here until dinner service and maybe until Catra finishes her shift?”

“Of course.” Perfuma smiles, “But if you get bored, there’s a few arcade games in the back otherwise that Scorpia and Huntara insisted on buying.”

“Oh, that’s cool.” Adora looks over a little excitedly, “I might have a look after dinner.”’

“Hey, Adora.” Catra taps the blonde on the shoulder from behind, “I’ve got something for you.”

Turning around on the barstool, Adora grins at the magicat standing in front of her with her hands behind her back, “Are you done doing whatever already?”

Catra chuckles, “Not by a long shot.”

“Then what’s up?” Adora tilts her head.

“Here.” Catra holds out a well worn and loved book out to Adora, “Something to read while you’re waiting around and bored out of your brains.”

Adora reaches out and takes the paperback, reading the title out loud, “Journey to the centre of the Earth.” The blonde looks up at Catra and narrows her eyes, “I didn’t take you for a *Verneian.”*

“A what?” Catra furrows her brows confused.

“A Verneian.” Adora repeats looking down at the book and then flipping through the pages quickly, grinning when she sees it, “You’ve made notes.”

“I liked the book.” Catra shrugs this time, rubbing the back of her neck and looking away, she clears her throat, “It’s a good book.”

“I know.” Adora agrees getting off the stool and standing back to face Catra properly, “I love this story.”

“Wait, really? You do?” Catra asks, her ears perk up as Adora nods with the widest grin on her face, “That’s…”

The magicat leans in and crashes their lips together, careful not to crush her book as Adora laughs into the kiss, the blonde pulls back first, “Thank you for the book, I’ll keep it safe.”

Catra nods before her she’s startled by the sound of Huntara calling out for her as she arrives for her shift, she groans out softly, “I gotta get back to work.”

“Quit kissing women and get back to work!” Huntara shouts out teasingly, “You’re not paid by the kiss!”

Adora laughs as Catra breathes out a growl, “Go. I’ll be fine.” The blonde goes back to her barstool and sits down again, “Maybe if it’s not too busy, you can join me for dinner on your break?”

“Yeah, count on it.” Catra grins as she winks at the blonde and then quickly heads towards the kitchen to help with the preparation for the dinner rush.

Closer to 6pm

“Here’s your table number.” Perfuma passes over a table number to Adora, “Where do you plan to sit tonight?”

“I think I’ll sit in the dining area, if that’s alright.” Adora says taking the number and then heads towards the dining area of the venue.

“I’ll bring your drink to you.” Perfuma calls out as she goes to serve the next customer, while Adora nods back in recognition.

The blonde puts the table number down on the table and then pulls out a chair that directly faces the kitchen. She places Catra’s

book on the table in front of her and gets settled.

Perfuma comes by after a few minutes and places Adora's lemonade on the table with a smile before returning to bar.

Adora takes a sip of her drink and then looks around for her magicat, she spots Catra running around as Huntara barks orders and Scorpia moves around her in a sort of chaotic order. A small smile graces Adora's lips at the sight before she puts her drink back down again and then picks up the book Catra gave her.

She brings it up and traces the words on the cover with her fingers, twirling the paperback in her hand to look at the back cover before finally opening the book and flipping through the first few pages and then starts to read.

The chair across from her is pulled out and someone sits down.

Adora smiles, her nose still in the book and not looking over as she says, "I'm going to need to borrow this for a few days if I'm going to finish it."

In a voice, not Catra's, a gruff woman's voice replies, "I didn't take you for a bookworm."

Adora furrows her brows and lowers her book slowly, the irritation on her face obvious, "Do I know you?"

The woman sitting across from her is about the same height and build as Huntara, well, it seems to be about the same from the way this woman is sitting down opposite Adora. She's looks like she's come from work, still in work clothes, probably a labourer, a white muscle tank, clearly to show off her muscles and a pair of well worn and muddy jeans.

A smirk comes across this woman's face, thinking that it'll make Adora swoon, "Not yet, but I'd love to get to know you." She sticks her hand out, it's large and dirty and Adora scrunches up her nose at it as the woman introduces herself, "Ronnie."

Adora stares at the hand for a moment longer, she decidedly goes back to her book, ignoring the outstretched hand and says, “No thanks.”

“Excuse me?” Ronnie asks offended at Adora’s response, she brings her hand back and smooths over her blue hair.

“I said, no thanks.” Adora repeats calmly, “I didn’t ask for your company.”

A scoff leaves the imposing woman sitting across Adora, she takes a moment and recalibrates, going for a different approach, “What’s your name, pretty lady?”

“Stars…” Adora groans under her breath, her fingers grip unconsciously over Catra’s book, “Look, I’m really not looking for company tonight. I just want to have my dinner and read my book.”

“What did you order for dinner?” Ronnie asks.

“What?” The question surprises Adora.

“Dinner. What did you order?” Ronnie repeats, a sly grin on her lips as she relaxes into the chair she’s slowly making herself welcome in, “I usually get the steak.”

Adora just stares at the other woman, she shakes her head and frowns back, “No.”

“They also do a mean pizza here as well.” Ronnie continues to talk, “Super supreme or one of their signature ones, actually, all the food here is really good.”

Realising that the other woman isn’t going to take no for an answer, Adora raises the book back up in hopes Ronnie will get the message that she isn’t interested.

“Hey.” Ronnie says, before repeating the word with a lot more force, “Hey! I’m talking to you!”

Adora ignores her.

She hears the chair pushed back and then her book is snatched out of her hands.

“Hey! Give that back!” Adora shouts out, the few other patrons around turn to look at the commotion and the blonde shrinks down a little at raising her voice and drawing attention to herself. All the while Ronnie stands with her arms crossed over her chest and Catra’s book slightly crushed in her hands as she smirks at the blonde.

“I’ll give this back to you if you sit back down and have dinner with me.” Ronnie says as Adora reaches for the book, only for the other woman to turn and block her attempt, “Uh uh!”

“Give. It. Back.” Adora repeats angrier.

“Tell me your name.” Ronnie counters, the smirk still on her face as she easily pushes Adora back a few steps, “And I’ll think about giving this back to you.”

Adora clenches her jaw, contemplating what to do next.

Though she doesn’t need to contemplate much longer when Ronnie grunts out unhappily.

“Hey!” Ronnie growls out as the book is ripped out of her hand.

“Hey, yourself.” Catra growls back as she checks over her book and then glares at the other woman, “What the fuck do you think you’re doing?”

“What’s it to you small-fry?” Ronnie scoffs, she keeps her arms crossed over her chest as Scorpia, Perfuma and Huntara all come up behind Catra, her eyes widen, “What is this?”

“Are you alright, princess?” Catra asks, her eyes doing a once over Adora who nods to her before the blonde’s eyes glare at Ronnie. The magicat’s eyes follow Adora’s and she feels Huntara’s large

hands on her shoulders, standing behind her and squeezing said shoulders once, “Are you harassing her?”

“What? Me?” Ronnie pretends to be innocent, “I wasn’t doing anything. Just came in to grab some dinner and a drink.”

Huntara crosses her massive arms over her chest, squeezing the muscles in her arms as she towers over Ronnie with a glare, “Doesn’t look like that’s all you were doing.”

“I’m just shooting my shot.” Ronnie reasons innocently.

“You were shot down.” Huntara says, “Multiple times.”

“If she really shot you down, you’d look like Swisse cheese.” Catra adds making Adora giggle a little behind her hand, the magicat walks over to Adora and wraps and arm around her waist, “And if you weren’t already dead, I’d make you into string cheese. Got me?”

Ronnie sizes up the magicat and before she decides to do something stupid, Scorpia puts her pincer on the woman’s shoulder, “Listen, *friend.* You are welcome to order dinner and a drink, but you need to behave yourself. No more shooting your shot when you’ve already been shot down.”

“Don’t fucking touch me, freak.” Ronnie shoves Scorpia’s pincer off her shoulder and then yelps when Huntara grabs her the arm and twists it behind her back, slamming her face onto the table and spilling Adora’s lemonade over.

“Sorry about that. I’ll get you another one.” Huntara says to Adora.

“ARGH! Let go!” Ronnie screams out in pain as Huntara twists her arm just a little more.

“I think it’s time for you to go.” Huntara leans down and growls out into Ronnie’s ear, “I’m not fond of filling out paperwork for workplace incidents…”

"And I'm not fond of filing that paperwork and following it up." Perfuma adds with a huff.

"I can either haul you up and toss you on your ass or you can walk out of here with what's left of your dignity." Huntara snarls out the options before adding with a smirk, "Please pick the first one. It's been a long while since I've had the pleasure of throwing someone out of here. I want to see if I can beat my mark from last time I tossed an asshole out of here."

Catra makes a face of confusion, "That first option means you have to fill out paperwork, idiot."

Huntara snarls at the magicat, Catra just rolls her eyes back.

"So? What's it going to be?" Huntara asks gruffly and pushes Ronnie down a little more against the table.

"I'll walk! Fuck! Let go and I'll go!" Ronnie grits out, scrunching her face up in pain with her arm twisted behind her back.

"Good choice." Huntara whispers before shoving the other woman into the table before letting go.

WHACK!

Huntara stands there stunned.

As does everyone else in the bar.

Silence rings around the room.

Ronnie clutches her fist with a wince.

The one she used to punch Huntara in the left cheek.

“Sweetie?” Perfuma breaks the silence, “Can you please open the front doors? I don’t want to have to replace them again.”

Scorpia nods, speed walking to the entrance, pushing and locking them open before stepping back and to the side, out of the way.

“Hunt.” Perfuma speaks again seeing the rage in her eyes starting to flare up, “Please don’t break anything if you can.”

“No blood either.” Catra adds as she guides Adora further away from Ronnie, “I don’t want to be scrubbing up blood tonight!”

“Blood?” Ronnie repeats with a frown as she looks at Catra before she’s lifted off the ground with an indignant yelp as Huntara throws her a few feet forward making Ronnie drop to the ground with a groan, “Hey!”

Huntara doesn’t speak, she just picks Ronnie up again and does it again and again until she’s practically at the entrance, the night air drifting through as a few customers keep clear of the door, the regulars with them ensure they do.

Groaning out, Ronnie tries to get to her feet, only for her feet to be swiped out from under her, “ARGH, FUCK!”

“CLEAR!” Scorpia shouts out in warning to the people standing outside the entry doors before Huntara picks Ronnie up and throws her as far as she can.

Which turns out to be a good few meters.

“Oof!” Ronnie lands with a thud onto the grassy verge, face planting into the dirt, practically eating the stuff as she rolls over and spits it out of her mouth, growling at Huntara standing in the doorway, “I’m calling the cops!”

“Go ahead.” Huntara replies not rising to the threat, “Call them.”

Hissing out, Ronnie reaches into her pant pocket and pulls out her phone, “You’re going to pay for this.”

Catra shoves Huntara out the way, stomping her way out and going face to face with Ronnie, needing to crouch down to be level, “The only one who’s going to pay is you.”

Ronnie glares at the magicat ready to say something before being quickly interrupted.

“You swung first.” Catra simply says, “Everything after that is justified.”

Ronnie narrows her eyes at Catra, “Bullshit.”

“Oh, trust me, it isn’t.” Catra growls out with a smirk, “So, go ahead, call the police. But the only person who’s getting arrested tonight, is you.”

“You’re lying.” Ronnie grits out.

“I’m really not.” Catra replies sharply and then stands up, “But I’m not the boss of you. Do whatever you want. I don’t fucking care.”

Ronnie scoffs, her eyes glaring at Catra who’s now just standing towering over her, “Fuck you.”

“No, fuck you.” Catra retorts before she flicks her claws out, letting them gleam in the moonlight and tilts her head, “Oh, and if you try that shit again…”

“Try what?” Ronnie gets to her feet with a grunted effort, “Talk to people?”

Catra throws her head back and laughs cynically, “You must be very dense if you think you got your ass handed to you just for *talking to people.”*

“I was just talking to people. You idiots took it too far.” Ronnie scoffs dusting the dirt off the front of her clothes, though you

wouldn’t be able to tell since her clothes were dirty to start with.

The magicat steps forward, “Don’t bother coming back here again.”

Ronnie scoffs again, shaking her head but doesn’t say anything.

Catra smirks, she turns around and heads back inside, her tail whipping behind her as she does.

Her ears pick it up before she sees it.

“No.” Catra breathes out as she ducks and then throws a right hook against Ronnie’s left cheek, knocking the other woman to the ground.

“Wildcat!” Scorpia shouts out as she goes out to help Catra, Huntara still standing at the door looking proud as punch, “Are you alright? Do you need to be wrapped up and nursed back to health?”

Catra quickly bats Scorpia’s attempts to help her off, “Scorp! I’m fine. I just need some ice for my hand.”

“Oh.” Scorpia rubs the back of her neck sheepishly, turning her and sees Ronnie shaking her head and clutching her face, she looks at Catra, “I better help her.”

“Yeah. Get her out of here before she embarrasses herself further.” Catra replies, “Maybe call the cops to give her a ride home.”

Scorpia laughs at that suggestion, “Don’t worry about it. I got this. You can go back inside. The dinner rush is in full swing and Perfuma is starting to get… well, you know…”

“Oh, right.” Catra’s eyes widen, “I better get back in there!” she looks at Ronnie and then back at Scorpia, “You got this, yeah?”

“I got this.” Scorpia grins as Catra quickly retreats back inside, the scorpini towers over Ronnie and grins, “So, taxi, rideshare or police car?”

“Catra!” Perfuma calls out, the magicat puts her hand up.

“Give me one second.” Catra says as she moves towards Adora, “Hey, Adora.”

“Are you alright?” Adora asks like she doesn’t already know that Catra’s hand needs ice, she holds up the jug half filled with ice.

“I don’t have time.” Catra smiles softly, “It’s not that bad.”

“Catra.” Adora breathes out.

“I will. Just not right now.” Catra reassures reaching out taking Adora’s hand, she presses her lips on the back of it, “Perfuma’s going to lose her shit if I don’t get to work.”

Adora looks over at Perfuma who looks like she’s a moment away from cracking, she leans in and presses a kiss to Catra’s cheek, “You better come back and ice that hand when it quietens down.”

“I promise.” Catra smiles before she leans in and pecks Adora’s lips, “I’ll be back with your dinner soon.”

Nodding, Adora goes back to her table that’s been wiped down and a fresh glass of lemonade on a coaster awaiting her, her book resting on the tabletop as she sits back down and watches as everything starts moving again.

Perfuma finally looks at ease when things start getting back into rhythm and Adora can hear the woman laughing and talking animatedly with the customers.

Adora takes a sip of her lemonade and then opens the book once more. Finally letting herself immerse into the story of Catra’s

favourite book.

Half an hour later…

Adora's halfway through her meal, the book open next to her plate, when another plate is set opposite hers and someone sits down behind it.

"Enjoying my book?" Catra asks grinning, seeing how engrossed Adora is with it that she's barely touched her meal, "If you don't eat up, Huntara's going to crack the shits. Or get pouty." The magicat shrugs, "Either way, it'll be funny."

Adora glares playfully at the magicat, "Won't she toss you out like that ass from before?"

"Nah, she's gotta catch me first." Catra smirks digging into her food with vigour, after she swallows her mouthful, "Are you going to eat your bacon?"

"Yes." Adora looks for something to use as a bookmark before Catra hands her a clean napkin to use, "Thank you. And yes, I am."

The blonde slaps Catra's hand away before the magicat can grab the bacon off Adora's plate, grinning Catra goes back to her own plate, "It's good, right?"

"Yeah, it is." Adora closes the book and picks up her fork and starts to eat again, "How long before you have to get back to work?"

"Mm…" Catra thinks before answering, "Probably when I finish eating."

“That’s not a break, Catra…” Adora starts to say when Perfuma saunters over with a disapproving look on her face, “Hi, Perfuma.”

“Catra.” Perfuma says.

“I’m nearly done.” Catra shoves the rest of the food into her mouth and starts to get up, only for Perfuma to push her back down into her chair, “Mmrrp?”

“Sit. Digest.” Perfuma says squeezing the magicat’s shoulder, “You’ve got half an hour. So, take half an hour.”

“But…”

“No ‘buts’.” Perfuma says sternly, “I’ve told you many times that when you’re on break, you’re on break. We can handle half an hour without you.”

“But…”

“Catra, no.” Perfuma repeats, “The dinner rush is nearing it’s end so all that’s left is to collect the finished plates. And we can deal with that.”

“Are you sure?” Catra asks despite the reassurance.

“Yes.” Perfuma nods, “We got this.”

Conceding, Catra nods back, “Okay. But I don’t know what time my break started.”

Across the room, Huntara shouts out, “You’re break starts now, Cat!”

“But…”

“NO BUTS!” Huntara growls back as the other diners suddenly still for a moment before going back to their meals and conversations.

Perfuma giggles, “She’s so loud.”

Catra huffs out, “Yeah.”

“Half an hour.” Perfuma repeats before turning to Adora, “Do you want another refill?”

“Oh, no thanks.” Adora smiles back, “But if I could get some ice for Catra’s hand?”

“Be right back with that.” Perfuma nods starts to clear empty glasses and finished plates from a few tables, leaving the pair to their dinner as she goes to retrieve an icepack.

10pm…

“Sorry, princess. That went a little longer than expected.” Catra apologises as she steps out of the bar and bistro after they say goodbye to the crew inside, the magicat throws her new jacket over Adora’s already covered shoulders, the blonde giggles, “What’s so funny?”

“I already have a jacket.” Adora says but doesn’t take off the jacket, “And you’re giving me the jacket I gifted you?”

“Well, give it back then.” Catra says with a grin, reaching for it and not quite getting it, Adora laughs as she ducks away from the magicat’s grasp, “I thought you didn’t want it?”

“You gave it to me, so it’s mine now.” Adora wraps it around herself, “Plus it smells like you.”

“Well, it should.” Catra chuckles as she holds her hand out to Adora, who takes it immediately, “I’m about ready for bed, princess.”

“My place or yours?” Adora grins.

“Ladies choice.” Catra replies as she squeezes Adora’s hand, “Wherever you want to go, Adora.”

“My place. If that’s okay?” Adora glances over at the magicat, “I kind of want to be in my own bed tonight. And I want you in there with me.”

“Cuddles?”

With a nod and a wide grin, Adroa repeats, “Cuddles.”

Catra’s hand slips out of Adora’s suddenly, as the magicat is flung backwards, landing with a thud on her back.

“Catra!” Adora shouts, rushing towards her magicat before being pulled up by her borrowed jacket, she stumbles and falls back, wincing as she lands awkwardly, clutching her arm.

“Now, where were we?” A familiar annoying voice says.

“Ronnie?” Adora looks up and sees the woman from the bar before, her eyes glance over to Catra laying not too far away, unmoving. Her view is obscured when Ronnie stands over her and she frowns, “Leave us alone.”

“You got me kicked out of my favourite bar.” Ronnie says angrily, “So, you’re going to pay for that.”

“You got yourself kicked out” Adora spits back as she shuffles herself back so she can use the wall to get to her feet while still holding her arm protectively, “It was your own fault. Now leave me us alone.”

Ronnie steps forward, she’s practically snarling at the blonde as she reaches out to grab her, only be shoved back by Adora’s good arm.

“Get away from me!” Adora growls out watching Ronnie take a step back before moving forward again, “I’m warning you!”

"You're warning me?" Ronnie repeats the warning with a sarcastic laugh, "What are you going to do to me, *princess?"*

WHACK!

Ronnie stumbles backwards again, this time she's clutching her cheek, the same left cheek Catra had struck her earlier that night making her growl out.

Adora winces, her knuckles feeling it from the strike as she glares back.

Ronnie shakes her head, her hands closing into fists as her growls out and steps towards Adora, "I don't usually hit pretty girls, but for you, I think I'll make an exception if it means that you'll learn your place."

WHACK!

"Oof!" Ronnie stumbles back for a third time as Adora hands another punch on the same cheek, this time the larger woman growls out, "ARGH! FUCK! QUIT HITTING ME THERE!"

"Stay away from me!" Adora lifts her good arm up defensively, her hand throbbing from the two punches she's already thrown at the other woman, but she'll throw another if she has too, "Leave me alone!"

"After what you just did. Twice? Yeah, I don't think so." Ronnie scoffs while rubbing her cheek and wincing, "I'm going to make you pay. Twice. Make that three times, because I'm counting your girlfriend's punch too."

Adora swings again for another punch, this time Ronnie is ready for it, grabbing her hand before it can land and twisting it down and behind Adora's back, making her grunt out in pain, a whimper leaves her lips when she feels Ronnie twisting her arm just a little more.

Ronnie smirks, "Now, that's a sound I like to hear."

Adora struggles as Ronnie holds her in place, "You're hurting me!"

"I know." Ronnie leans forward to say next to Adora's ear, "This is only the start, *princess."*

THWACK!

Ronnie's hold on Adora loosens, the blonde managing to break free, taking a few steps away to see her attacker's eyes rolling back, a bead of blood running down her forehead over her face as she's jolted forward against the wall before slumping down onto the ground in a heap.

A low growl sounds from the shadows as Catra steps out, her hands still fisted as she glares at Ronnie, her eyes flick around and finds Adora's and softens immediately, she moves quickly and cups her blonde's face, "Are you okay?"

"My arm." Adora looks down, still clutching her injured arm and she sees Catra's eyes widen in concern, "I don't think it's broken, it's just sore."

"We should get you checked out at the doctors though." Catra says softly, careful not to knock against Adora's arm, "Come on."

"What about her?" Adora looks over at Ronnie, slumped unconscious against the wall, "We can't leave her like that."

Catra sighs, “Yeah, you’re right.” The magicat pulls out her phone and taps it a few times, she looks at Adora, “I’ll call her an ambulance.”

“We should probably get out of here before they get here.” Adora says.

Shaking her head, Catra smiles, “No. We stay until they get here. And after they deal with her, they can take a look over you.”

“Catra…”

“No.” The magicat shakes her head again, “We stay. She may be an asshole, but we aren’t.”

“Did you just call me an asshole?” Adora quirks and eyebrow at the magicat before narrowing her eyes.

“I said we aren’t.” Catra laughs as the call connects as quickly speaks to the emergency services, once she’s off the phone, the magicat turns to Adora, “They’ll be here in the next five to ten minutes.”

“Okay.” Adora nods as she stands next to Catra, not too far from where Ronnie is slumped over.

Catra wraps her arm around Adora’s waist, the blonde leaning into the magicat and rests her head on Catra’s shoulder with a sigh.

“What’s up, princess?” Catra asks after hearing the sigh.

“I just didn’t think we’d be pulling those favours to fast.” Adora says and Catra tilts her head a little confused as to what that means, the blonde nudges her playfully, “We’re not hiding bodies.”

Catra laughs, “Stars… you didn’t ask me nicely though.”

That makes Adora giggle, “I know. Because I’m not taking you up on that offer just yet.”

“Well,” Catra pulls Adora in just a little closer, “The offer is always there to help you hide the bodies in the future.”

“And if I ask nicely?” Adora grins at her own question.

“For you?” Catra smirks, “I’d do anything… almost.”

Chapter End Notes

Oof - one more chapter left...

Thanks for waiting, I know it's been a while between chapters...
but thank you for your patience.
I am slowly getting back into my SPOP fics.

Thanks for reading, comments, kudos, bookmarking and subscribing!

Chapter 10: View from the treetops

Chapter Summary

The pair go back to the showroom to meet Casta.

Chapter Notes

Final chapter!!!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Melog, no." Catra tries to stop her cat from coming inside the showroom where all the brand new cars are on display and happens to be where Castaspella is awaiting her and Adora.

Meow

"Dude, Melog. Not everywhere is cat friendly." Catra tries again to get Melog to move out the way so they can go in without him joining them. Melog tilts his head at her in disbelief, making Catra scoff, "I said cat friendly. I'm a magicat. Totally different species, dude."

Meow

"He's got a point, Cat." Adora teases, holding back a laugh at the situation unfolding front of her, "Besides, I think Casta will be fine with him being inside."

"Up until this guy is scratching up every single one of those vehicles." Catra replies while still staring Melog down, "Trust me.

He sees everything as a scratching post.”

Adora can’t hold back her laugh this time, wiping a tear from her eye, “That’s not true. He’s been so good with Frankie and the lobby. Haven’t you, Melog?”

Melog walks over to Adora and smugly rubs against her grey pant covered leg, purring up a storm as he sits in front of her and stares back at Catra in defiance of the magicat.

And before Catra can respond, the doors to the showroom swing open and Melog takes that as his opportunity to dart inside, straight through and under Castaspella’s legs.

The magicat groans, dropping to fours and running after her cat.

“Sorry, Casta!” Catra says as she darts under Castaspella’s legs too leaving the woman confused and a little unsteady.

“Catra!” Adora calls out after the magicat, shaking her head and chuckling before she looks up at Castaspella, she reaches out and steadies her, “Hi, Casta. Catra is just going to get Melog.”

Castaspella smiles softly back, “Melog?”

“Her cat.”

“Melog.” Castraspella repeats, “What’s a Melog?”

“Catra’s cat.” Adora clarifies, she rubs the back of her neck with a nervous laugh, “He ran in so she ran in after him, just in case he decides to scratch up all the cars.”

“Oh, is that all?” Casta smiles back undeterred, she turns back inside, “Come on in, Adora.”

“Thank you.” Adora nods, quickly following Castaspella inside and then hesitating at the doors, “Should I shut them or leave them open?”

“Go ahead and shut them, dear.” Castaspella replies without looking back, “Don’t want either cat getting out now, do we?”

Adora holds back a laugh, shutting the doors and then turning around to face the showroom, she shakes her head, “No, that’d be bad.”

“Dude, Melog! Get back here!” Catra shouts out, Melog evading her hands as they zip in around each of the showroom cars, “Seriously, come back here, dude!”

Meow

Adora watches Catra’s tail weave around in the air, changing directions rapidly as she chases her cat. The blonde doesn’t even realise when Castaspella stands next to her, nudging her playfully with her shoulder, making her turn her head to the taller woman.

A knowingly smile appears on Castaspella’s lips, “I can see why you love her.”

The words have Adora blushing, but she doesn’t deny it, instead, she embraces it, “Yeah. I do.”

“Gotcha!” Catra shouts out victoriously, holding Melog up in the air like a trophy, “I’m the superior cat here!”

Adora snorts out a laugh at the sight of Catra carrying Melog above her head while rounding around the showroom cars and back towards them, grinning widely at the pair. Castaspella nods to the magicat, “Well done.”

“Thank you.” Catra smiles back victoriously, “Can you get the door please?”

“You’re going to put him outside?” Castaspella asks looking at Melog giving her sad eyes, “We can’t leave him out there all alone. Can we?”

“Yeah, Cat.” Adora giggles in agreement, “You can’t just leave Melog outside all alone.”

The magicat furrows her brows slightly, “What do you suggest? This dude has claws and he isn’t afraid to use them.”

“He isn’t that bad, Catra.” Adora reaches out and touches Melog’s paw, “He seems perfectly well behaved with Frankie.”

“Yeah, but these are very expensive vehicles. You do not want this dude to get his claws into those nice cars.” Catra warns as Melog starts to struggle in her grip, “Quit wriggling around, Melog!”

Meow!

“OH!” Castaspella gasps as Melog gets loose and leaps into her arms, a purr rumbling out of his furry chest as he nuzzles into her arms and she melts, “He. Is. So. CUTE!”

Melog smirks back at Catra before shutting his eyes contently, smugly, purring even louder.

Adora giggles, pulling Catra into her arms, whispering to her magicat, “Leave him be. He’ll be fine.”

“I’m not worried about *him.”* Catra breathes out slightly annoyed at her cat’s ability to make people love him, adding, “I’m worried about the cars.”

“Oh, don’t worry about that.” Castaspella pets Melog with her left hand, cradling the large cat in her other arm as Melog practically hugs her back, “I can keep this guy busy for a bit.”

“What are we doing here, princess?” Catra asks leaning into Adora, letting herself be wrapped up in the blonde’s arms.

“Casta wants to see you drive again. Make sure it wasn’t a fluke.” Adora replies, “She’s got some new toys to try.”

Catra pulls back and smirks at Adora, “Toys?”

“Stars, Catra…” Adora laughs, shoving the magicat back, “Not those kinds of *toys.”*

The magicat chuckles, “Okay, so not those kinds of toys… then what toys are we talking about?”

“Cars, idiot.” Adora rolls her eyes, “Why do you think we’re here?”

“I need to make sure you’re not a one time thing.” Castraspella says and then tilts her head, “That didn’t sound right.”

Catra stares at her bemused, watching the taller woman shake her head and laugh to herself, she nudges Adora, “Is she always like this?”

Adora nods with a grin, “Yeah, she is.”

“What I meant to say is,” Castaspella tries again, readjusting Melog in her arms slightly, “I need to make sure you can replicate the way you drove the last time you were here.”

“Oh.” Catra replies taken aback, “You want me to drive again?”

“Yes. Exactly.” Castaspella replies with a smile, “So, what do you say?”

“Yes!” Adora answers for Catra.

The magicat makes a surprised sound as she turns her head to look at the blonde, “Yes?”

“Great. Fantastic!” Castaspella claps her hands together, “Let’s go then.”

“Wait, I didn’t…” Catra starts to say when Adora tugs on her hand to follow the taller woman.

“It’ll be fun. And then we can go get waffles after.” Adora giddily says, “You’re driving.”

“Well, duh.” The magicat can’t help the laugh that falls from her lips.

“Are you serious?” Catra stares at Castaspella like she’s grown a second head, “You want me to drive *that?”*

“What’s wrong with it?” Castaspella asks genuinely confused, “Do you not like it?”

“Are you kidding me?” Catra shakes her head in disbelief as she looks at the car in front of her and then back to the taller woman, “This is a 707HP Dodge Hellcat…”

“I am aware.” Castaspella replies, “Did you want to drive it?”

“I’m too scared to scratch it.” The magicat immediately replies as Adora looks over at Catra fondly, “There is no way I can afford to pay for repairs if I fu- crashed.”

“I highly doubt you’ll crash, Catra. You seem to be quite a competent driver.” Castaspella says matter of factly, “Besides, you won’t crash it.”

“You can’t be so sure…” The magicat shuffles from foot to foot, not sure if she should take up Castaspella’s invitation or not, “I mean, I wouldn’t trust me with it.”

“What if Adora sits in the car with you?” The suggestion has Catra whipping her head over to Adora and then back at Castaspella, “Surely, you value her safety first and as such wouldn’t be driving recklessly.”

“Do you want me to ride shot gun?” Adora asks with a soft smile at Catra, “I don’t have to if you rather I not.”

“Yes. Ride shot gun with me.” Catra immediately says and mirrors the smile, before turning back to Castaspella, “What exactly am I doing today?”

“Just driving.” Castaspella replies and then leans down to the magicat, “Get in, Catra. I want to see what you can do.”

Catra gulps down, she nods in return as reaches for the handle, “Adora?”

“I’m already in the car, Cat!” Adora calls out from the front seat, already buckled in and waiting for her magicat to get in.

Catra turns to Adora after parking up the car, a grin so wide that it makes her face hurt, “That was nuts. Coconuts. Freaking crazy.”

Adora giggles in reply, grabbing Catra by the collar of her shirt and pulling her in for a kiss.

“What was that for?” Catra asks breathlessly, eyes still closed as Adora pulls back but doesn’t release her.

“I’m just happy that you’re happy.” Adora whispers into Catra’s lips, leaning back in again for a chaste kiss.

“Mm…” Catra hums, a purr rumbling out of her chest loudly, proudly. “I’m glad you were here with me.”

“Me too.” Adora replies resting her forehead against the magicat’s.

Knock knock

“That’s Casta, isn’t it?” Catra asks without looking behind her to see who is knocking on the glass.

Adora nods, “Yeah, it is.”

“Should we give her a real show?” Catra grins mischievously, earning her a rightful shove from Adora, she cackles, “Can I get one more kiss in this fucking awesome car, princess?”

Rolling her eyes and double checking Castaspella is not looking, Adora pulls the magicat in for one more kiss, she can’t help smiling into it as Catra chases her lips when she pulls back after.

The sound of Adora’s seatbelt clicking open has Catra groaning, before doing the same with her own belt, “I guess the fun is over then, huh?”

“Doesn’t have to be over.” Adora says as she opens the door.

“Mmmrp?” Catra makes a sound of confusion before she opens her own door and steps out, holding the keys out to Castaspella, “Thanks Casta. She’s a dream to drive.”

Castaspella smiles widely, “I’m glad you think so.”

“Here. Take them before I refuse to give the keys back later.” Catra says, looking away from the keys and the car as she waits for the taller woman to take them.

“I have to say I am impressed with your driving, Catra.” The taller woman says as Melog leaps up into her arms and she immediately pets him, she smiles at him and says, “You are very cute.”

Meow!

“Yes, you are! You are very cute!” Castraspella coos at the cat in her arms, “And so soft!”

Melog purrs up a storm at the attention, smugly looking at Catra, the magicat glares at him, “You are not *that* cute, dude.”

“Yes, he is.” Adora chimes in, pressing a kiss onto Catra’s cheek and then whispers into her ear, “Just like you.”

Catra’s ear flicks Adora in the face making the blonde laugh, the magicat scrunches up her nose and says, “That’s what you get for a calling me cute.”

“Catra!” Adora shoves the magicat lightly and then rubbing her face and smiling.

“Casta. Keys.” Catra tries to hand the keys back to her again, “Melog has legs. You don’t have to carry him.”

“But he is so cute!” Castaspella repeats playfully, “I’ve never had a pet before.”

“Keep him. He’s yours.” Catra deadpans.

“No! What about Frankie?!” Adora brings up and then pouts at Catra, “I thought he was my building’s cat now.”

“You can share him.” Catra replies staring at Melog, “He seems to love the attention anyways.”

Meow!

“I don’t even know you anymore, dude.” Catra says to Melog.

Meow!

“It’s fine, Melog.” Catra sighs, “You deserve all the cuddles and pets you can get. Stars know that I’m not there enough to give you that.”

Meow.

Melog leaps out of Castaspellla’s arms and then leaps up onto the magicat’s shoulder, bumping her head affectionately. Catra reaches up and scratches under his chin, “We’re all good, dude.”

Castaspella nudges Adora, “That is the cutest thing I’ve ever seen.”

“I know.” Adora agrees grinning.

“How’s the hunt for a new manager going?” Castaspella asks watching Catra and Melog interact, “Any prospects?”

Adora shakes her head and blows out the hair that’s fallen on her ponytail and onto her face, “No. I haven’t really been looking.”

“How’s everything been?” Castaspella asks, “Have you been managing everything okay?”

“It’s been alright so far.” Adora nods, “Though this contract about my weight… Shadow Weaver really did a number on that one.”

“That woman…” Castaspella growls the words out before sighing, “I should have stepped in and helped you when I had the chance.”

“You didn’t know.” Adora replies, “Besides, Catra still going through my contracts to see if they are legitimate or not.”

Catra wraps her arm around Adora's waist, Melog back on the floor and weaving in and out of Adora's legs. Catra holds the keys out to Castaspella once again, and this time she finally takes them, "The contract about Adora's weight and calories is messed up."

"Who is that contract with?" The taller woman asks.

"I'm glad you asked." Catra grins and then raises an eyebrow at Castaspella, "It's actually with you."

"Wait, what?" Castaspella replies gobsmacked, "Me?"

"Well, not you, specifically." Catra chuckles, "Just the company. *Your* company."

"My company?" The taller woman tilts her head confused, "Huh. I'll have to have a word to my legal team."

"Well… I've got Adora's contract right here." Catra reaches into her pocket and pulls out the contract she printed out the day before, "I hi-lighted the sections that refer to the whole calorie counting and weight."

Castaspella takes the contract and flips through it to the hi-lighted sections and reads through it, mumbling the words as she does and furrowing her brows before looking up at Adora, "You signed this?"

Adora nods sheepishly, "I trusted her. She said it was normal for jobs like these."

"Oh, Adora." Castaspella sighs, looking back down at the papers in her hands and continuing to read and when she's done, lowers the papers.

"I know, I know. I should have read it properly first before I signed it." Adora chastises herself with a frown, "I'm an idiot. I know."

Catra's arm tightens around Adora's waist, "You trusted her. She screwed you over. Shit happens, princess. But we can fix it."

"We can?" Adora looks hopefully at her magicat.

Nodding, Catra shrugs and says, "Sure, why not?"

Breathing out heavily, Adora shakes her head, "How?"

"Well, I've already looked over your other contracts and there's clauses in each of them that have been violated from what I saw at that photoshoot that gets you out of them." Catra explains, "And the only contract left that has a calorie requirement is here."

"Oh." Adora mouths the word in surprise.

"So, since Castraspella and her company have been doing everything above board, you are still bound by this contract that you've signed." Catra adds, "But since the CEO of this company has the power to cancel, terminate or amend this contract…"

Castaspella points to herself, "Oh! That's me!"

The magicat chuckles, "Yes, Casta. You. The CEO."

"Let me speak to my legal team and get this contract adjusted or redone." Castaspella declares, "Calorie counting. Absurd."

Adora wraps her arms around Catra's neck, "Thank you!"

"It's not done yet, princess." Catra whispers with another chuckle, "Don't thank me yet."

"I still have to submit my calories?" Adora asks as she pulls back.

"Unfortunately, yes." The magicat replies with a sigh, "But just until we can get this contract altered or redone."

"Don't worry about this Adora." Castaspella says patting the blonde on the shoulder, "I'll get right onto this and have this sorted by the end of the day."

“That quick?” Adora asks surprised.

“Well, I am the CEO, am I not?” The taller woman straightens up proudly, she grins at them teasingly, before dropping back into her casual stance, “Like I said, I’ll get onto legal straight away and ask them how this contract even got approved with such… draconian requirements. Especially when our model is also supposed to be an athlete.”

“I’m not an athlete.” Adora quickly corrects.

Shaking her head, Castaspella puts her hand up to stop Adora from interrupting, “And you will never be one if you aren’t getting proper nutrition and the number of calories in this contract is laughable. I’m surprised that you haven’t fainted from lack of calories.”

“So… what does that mean?” Adora furrows her brows, “Am I still bound by this contract or not?”

“You are. For now.” Castaspella replies with a consolatory look on her face, “But don’t worry, let me get this sorted and I’ll let you know.”

“Great.” Catra says and then looks over at Melog, who’s now lounging in the sun on his side, “Come on, dude. We’re going.”

Melog looks up from where he’s lying for a few seconds before dropping back down and promptly ignoring Catra.

“Seriously, Melog?” Catra grumbles.

“It’s fine. He can stay here if he wants.” Castraspella says while smiling fondly at the cat, “If you’d like, I can have him driven back to your place after.”

“You’re going to get Melog chauffeured back?” Catra says dryly, “Back to the streets where he hangs out…?”

“The streets?” The taller woman repeats bemused, “Oh, that’s no good. A good boy like Melog should not be out on the streets.”

“He chooses to be.” Catra replies, “It’s a choice he makes.”

“Well, then, in that case, he can stay here for as long as he likes.” Castaspella declares, “We can set him up with food and water and oh! Toys!”

“Stars…” Catra sighs.

Adora giggles, “He usually sleeps in the lobby of my building with the night doorman, Frankie.”

“Oh, does he now?” Castaspella quirks and eyebrow up at the cat, “Melog, you have a home here too now.”

“Stars…” Catra repeats shaking her head, “Unbelievable, dude.”

“So, what now?” Adora asks leaning into Catra’s side.

“Don’t worry about this contract, Adora.” Castaspella replies, “We’ll get it sorted soon enough.”

“Thanks, Casta. But that’s not what I mean.” Adora chuckles, “I mean, what now with Catra?”

“What about me?” Catra asks.

Castaspella pauses to think for a moment before answering this time, she turns to Catra, “I assume you’re not keen on modelling?”

“No. That’s Adora’s domain.” Catra quickly quashes the idea, “Besides, this is her bread and butter. Not mine.”

“What is your *bread and butter?”* The taller woman asks, genuinely curious to know.

“I don’t really have…” Catra furrows her brows, feeling embarrassed at her place in life, “I’m a waiter. Gig worker really.”

“She’s got a knack for contracts and legal stuff.” Adora nudges Catra playfully, “And she’s always standing up for me, even if I can handle it.”

She straightens up, turning to Adora, “Sometimes it’s easier for those asshats to get the message when there’s muscle involved.” Catra turns to Castaspella, “Not my muscles obviously. I have friends with muscles that most people find intimidating.”

“She does.” Adora quickly confirms, “Huntara and Scorpia are the muscle.”

Castaspella nods her head, not really sure what to make of that, “So, what would you say to doing some driving for me?”

“Like rideshare?” Catra asks, earning an elbow to the ribs from Adora before they both laugh, “I’m kidding.”

Castaspella laughs too, “No, I already have a driver or two on my books. But I think it would be good to have you drive Adora around when we do the shoots.” And before Catra can say anything, she adds, “I’ll pay you handsomely.”

Catra turns her head, she whispers to Adora, “Did she just come onto me?”

“She said, handsomely. Not handsome.” Adora whispers back.

“You know, I can hear you.” Castaspella says with an eyeroll and a grin, “And I don’t mix business with pleasure.”

Catra chuckles awkwardly, “Uh, how about when you go through Adora’s contract, you can send something for me too to look through, perhaps?”

“Great. Fantastic!” The taller woman claps her hands together, “Okay, well, that’s settled. I’ll have something sent out to both of you as soon as I can.”

The pair both nod, Adora turns to Catra, “So… can we get waffles?”

Catra grins, “Sure, whatever you want, princess.”

“And then we can hit the gym afterwards. For a couple of hours.” Adora adds, “Got to work off all the food.”

“A couple of waffles isn’t going to warrant a full gym day.” Catra says still grinning, “What about if we did something else instead of the gym?”

“Like what?” Adora asks.

“I’m sure we can think of something active to do.” Catra thinks and then snaps her fingers when she gets an idea, “There’s this treetop adventure thing I’ve heard about. I have some money saved up so we can definitely go there afterwards.”

“You don’t have to pay, Cat.” Adora wraps her arms around her magicat, “I’m happy just going to the gym. Plus, my membership will get you in for free too.”

Shaking her head, Catra smiles at Adora, “No, I want to do this.”

“Yeah?”

“Yeah. It’s been a while since I’ve done anything for myself.” Catra admits sheepishly, “But if you really don’t want to, we can just, hit the gym after.”

“You’re such an idiot.” Adora whispers into Catra’s ear.

“That’s my line, princess.” Catra breathes out a laugh, “So, what do you say? Treetops or gym?”

“A treetop adventure does sound more exciting than regular gym session…” Adora concedes, she leans in and presses a kiss on the magicat’s cheek, “Can we have waffles first and then decide? How many calories can I burn with this treetop adventure?”

“No idea. But don’t you have one of those smart watches or apps that tell you?” Catra looks over at Adora’s wrist.

“Hello? I’m still here.” Castaspella interrupts the pair, Melog purring happily in her arms, “Okay, well, you two have a good rest of the day. I’m going to take this guy to meet the lawyers and go over this contract. And yours.”

“I don’t got one yet.” Catra replies with a lopsided smile.

“Take a car if you want one.” Castaspella throws the keys for the Hellcat back at Catra, “Just make sure you fill it with premium.”

“I’m not made of premium fuel money.” Catra places the keys on a table nearby, “We’re going to take Adora’s car. It’ll be less like to get stolen.”

“Huh, I didn’t even think of that.” The taller woman admits as she picks the keys up off the table and pockets them, “But then again, I have drivers that stay with my cars.”

“Right.” Catra nods, “Well, would you like to join us for waffles, Casta?”

“I would love to, but, unless you want Adora to continue counting calories, I better get going to legal.” Castaspella says, “We’ll be in touch.”

“Melog, behave yourself.” Catra warns her cat.

Meow.

Treetop adventures!

“See? You’re already sweating and we haven’t even got to the top platform yet.” Catra grins while holding her hand to Adora, and with her other she shifts the rope to the side so the blonde can climb the rope ladder easier on the rope grab, “I think you’ve worked off those waffles, princess.”

Grunting, Adora grabs Catra’s hand and lets her magicat pull her to the platform, her hands automatically reach for the tree and takes a deep breath in, “How much further before we get to the top?”

“Just look up, Adora.” Catra replies adjusting the rope grab and taking the slack out of it.

“Stars…” Adora groans as she shakes out her arms, “You know, when you said treetop adventures, I was thinking of rope bridges and zip lines. Not… this.”

Catra watches as Adora gestures to the trees and her gear, “There are rope bridges and zip lines. At the top of this climb”

The blonde glares at the magicat tiredly, “You never said this wasn’t made for non-magicats.”

“It’s not.” Laughing with a squeak, Catra tugs on Adora’s harness to double check it’s still good, “Well, did you not want the harness? I believe fingernails aren’t as effectively as these.”

Catra’s extends her claws, digging them into the tree next to the rope that’s there for Adora, “I feel like I should be trained to be doing this.”

“You are training. With me.” Catra replies, “And besides, I’ve got a backup rope and fall arrest. You’re totally safe. And, I’m climbing right here next to you. Otherwise, I wouldn’t be wearing all this gear too.”

“They made you wear it otherwise you wouldn’t be allowed to do this.” Adora deadpans, “Also take your claws out of the tree, they told you not to do that. You’re going to get us into trouble.”

Catra grins, pulling her claws out, “It’s only another level or two to the top.”

“Stars…” Adora groans out stepping forward towards the rope, the magicat switching the rope to her chest ascender and pulling the rope out of her descender, the rope grab pushed above Adora’s head, “Where’s the rope ladder?”

“Just ropes from here.” Catra replies with a smile, “It’s fun, right?”

“I think I prefer to spend an hour on the stepper.” Adora replies testing her chest ascender and leaning back into it, “Okay, how do I climb this rope to the top?”

“Well, you’re going to need these.” Catra says unclipping another a few more items from her harness and putting them on the rope, “The handle slides up the rope and locks in, put your foot in the loops and push yourself up.”

“You’re kidding.” Adora deadpans.

“Nope.” Catra smiles again, “If you need to rest, just sit back in your harness. Cool?”

Adora sighs.

Catra puts both hands on Adora’s shoulders, “You’ll be fine. I’ll be right next to you the whole time. You stop. I stop. And when we get to the top, I’ll help you up.”

Adora takes another deep breath in and then nods, “Okay.” She shakes her arms out and gets a determined look on her face, “Let’s do this!”

“Catra…” Adora exhales, they’re about 10m from the final platform, two magicat staff members wait at the top for them, “My arms are dead.”

“Reckon we’ve burnt off all your waffles and your breakfast and dinner from last night?” Catra jests, lightening up the mood, she grabs Adora’s rope and brings her a little closer, “Can you make it the rest of the way up or do you want them to pull you up?”

“Wait. They can do that?” Adora asks incredulously.

Chucking, Catra nods, “Of course. Not everyone can make it to the top on their own. You, princess, are like, top 2%.”

“I am?” Adora beams.

“Yep. Better than most magicats.” Catra puffs her chest out, “And hotter too.”

That makes the blonde giggles, “You’re such a charmer.”

Catra grins back lopsided, grabbing Adora’s hand and kissing the back of it, “So? Climb to the top with me?”

Adora breathes out dramatically, “Yeah, okay. I can do this.”

“Yeah. You can.” Catra says confidently, “You go first, I’ll follow.”

“Are you sure?” Adora asks looking up at the last platform and then back to Catra, “I’m going to be a while…”

“That’s fine. I’ll be with you the whole way.” Catra reassures.

“I thought you were going to pull me up at the top.” The blonde recalls.

“I can do that instead when we get closer to the top. Just want to make sure you’re close enough to the top that I can pull you up.” Catra explains as she puts her foot back into the loop to climb the rope, “Ready to go?”

“Yeah, okay.” Adora agrees and then slips her foot into her own loop to finish the climb.

“This view is amazing, Catra.” Adora’s eyes widen at the sight from the top of the treetop, “It’s so beautiful up here.”

“Yeah, it is.” Catra replies staring at Adora, all flushed from the climb with a sheen of sweat on her face, “Well, the best part is getting back down.”

“I don’t see any zip lines…” Adora looks around and then back to Catra, “Please don’t tell me we have to climb down the ropes. My arms and legs are already dead.”

The two magicat staff members at the top both chuckle as they wave the pair over to where they’re standing on another platform.

“Come on.” Catra holds her hand out, “Just a little bit further.”

“Can I take this off yet?” Adora gestures to the harness.

“Stars, no.” The magicat says quickly, “Leave it on until your feet touch the ground, princess. We don’t want any accidents.”

“Oh, right.” Adora laughs sheepishly, “Too bad we weren’t allowed to bring our phones up here.”

“I’ve got mine.” Catra whispers and then looks around conspiratorially before pulling her phone out of her pocket, “Come on, quick. Before they catch us.”

Adora grins and whispers back giddily, “You’re so sneaky!”

The magicat wraps an arm around Adora’s waist and holds up her phone, “Ready?”

The blonde smiles, genuinely happy to be up in the treetops with Catra as the magicat snaps a bunch of photos in quick succession before pocketing her phone once more and then gesturing for Adora to follow her to where the staff are.

After a few guided rope bridges across the treetops, they finally get to the ziplines.

Adora's eyes widen when she sees how far down the ziplines go, to the point she can't see the end of it.

Catra notices, "You good, princess?"

"Are you sure this is safe?" Adora asks, eyes still looking down and not seeing the ending.

"This is the fun part, Adora." Catra replies with a reassuring look and then turns to the two guides, "Right?"

They both nod. The older black and white magicat, Felix, does his safety checks over the system before giving his coworker a thumbs up, "We're all good, Wazzy."

Wazzy turns to the pair, his fur is a darker brown and a lot shaggier, he gives the ropes a tug and grins, "We changed out these ropes yesterday and re-rigged everything."

"New ropes. Nice." Catra nods in approval.

"Yep. Every inch of this zipline has been checked and double checked and then our head rigger triple checked it before signing this off." Felix says proudly, "Guess it helps that we can move around these treetops easily without all these ropes."

"Then, why have them?" Adora asks as Wazzy checks over her gear as she's hooked onto the zipline system.

"It's fun." Wazzy, Felix and Catra all reply at the same time before the trio laugh.

"Beats getting whacked in the face by branches climbing down." Catra says, "Plus like you said, this place told me to keep my claws out of the trees."

“It’s true. Boss hates it when we claw the trees.” Felix adds as Catra gets set up on the zipline too, “But yeah, best part of all of this is going down.”

Catra grins, earning a shove from Adora, the magicat clears her throat, “So, no brakes, right?”

“Nope. Won’t need them going down.” Felix smiles, he pulls at Catra’s rope, “There’s a brake at the bottom. Well, more of a stopper thing. But it’ll be fun.”

“Have you been on a zipline before?” Catra asks Adora while she leans back into her harness.

Adora nods, “Once before.”

“Did you like it?” Catra smiles at her.

“I feel like you should have asked me this before we got to this point.” The blonde giggles before exhaling shakily, “I remember it was fun. Scary. But fun.”

“I’m going to be right here with you.” Catra reassures, “Nothing bad is going to happen. I promise.”

“I know.” Adora smiles back, her fingers gripping the rope, “So, what do we do?”

“Literally just push off and down we go.” Her magicat replies looking down the rope, “Shouldn’t take too long compared to getting up here.”

“Ready?” Felix asks after the second round of checks are completed.

“Good to go.” Catra gives him a thumbs up, “Adora?”

The blonde nods, a determined look on her face as she says, “Let’s do this!”

“Stars! That was so much better than climbing up.” Adora grins widely, the adrenaline still running through her body as they take off their harnesses and hand them back to the little shop at the entrance, “Thank you.”

“You did the work, only makes sense coming down would be its own reward.” Catra replies straightening up her clothes, “Did you have fun?”

“I did.” Adora nods, reaching over and pressing a kiss onto Catra’s cheek, “You’re going to have to drive us back. My arms and legs are dead after all that.”

The magicat grins, “Of course.”

Ping!

“I got a message.” Adora says as she takes her phone out of her bag and checks it, “Several messages actually…”

“Oh, yeah?” Catra asks shrugging on her jacket.

“Mmhm.” Adora opens up her text messages, her brows furrow, “Ignoring this…”

“Ex manager?”

“Yeah.” Adora confirms as she ignores Shadow Weaver’s text messages, “She’s still trying to get me to rehire her, well threatening me.”

“Don’t delete any of those messages, just in case.” Catra advises, “You might need them as evidence if she tries anything.”

“Yeah, okay, I won’t.” Adora nods, “But I am going to block her.”

“Totally do that.” Catra agrees, “What about your other messages?”

“Oh, I’ve got something from Casta.” Adora says a little surprised, “She’s asked me to call her back.”

Catra watches Adora hesitate, biting her bottom lip nervously, “Are you okay?”

“What if it’s bad news?” Adora looks up at Catra.

“Then… at least you’ll know and then we can figure it out after that.” Catra replies calmly, “Besides, the worst that could happen is that you just keep chugging along as you are for a little longer.”

Nodding, Adora breathes out, “You’re right.”

They come to a stop next to Adora’s car in the parking lot, the blonde leans against the passenger door as Catra waits for her to pass over the keys. Sensing that Adora’s still in her head, Catra stands next to her and leans against the car too.

“Are you going to call her?” Catra asks.

Adora takes a deep breath in and nods, “Okay.” She looks over at Catra, “I’ll put her on speaker so you can also hear.”

“Cool.” Catra smiles as Adora holds the phone in her hand between them and finally pushes the call button.

“Hello, Adora!” Castraspella’s voice comes over the speaker excitedly, “I’m so glad you called me back so soon.”

“Uh, hi Casta. We just got out feet back onto the ground.” Adora replies, “Is, um, is everything okay?”

“Yes, of course.” The older woman instantly says, and Adora’s body relaxes at that, “I just wanted you to know that I’ve spoken to my legal department and we will be sending you through a new contract soon. Very soon!”

“Oh, that’s fantastic. Thank you so much!” Adora gushes as she turns to Catra with relief in her eyes and a wide grin.

“There’s just one more thing.” Castaspella says, her voice dropping slightly into something more serious.

“Um, yeah?” Adora swallows down hard.

“Oh, it’s nothing bad, Adora.” Castaspella tries to keep her voice steady, “I just thought of someone that could help you in the whole management side of things.”

“Oh?”

“Yes. You must know Angella.” Castaspella says.

“Glimmer’s mum?” Adora asks.

“The very one.” The older woman confirms, “I don’t know if you are aware, but she is my sister-in-law and Glimmer is my niece and Angella can help you out with getting a good representation if she doesn’t take this on herself.”

“Huh?” Adora’s mouth drops, “Glimmer is what?”

“My niece, keep up, Adora.” Castaspella confirms, “So, what do you say?”

“What do I say to what?” Adora furrows her brows and then looks at Catra.

“Perhaps you can reach out to her.” The older woman suggests, “I can put in a good word for you if you want.”

“Oh, that won’t be necessary.” Adora politely declines.

“Otherwise, my brother, Micah, is also into that kind of thing too.” Castraspella says like she’s thinking, “But he has the strangest ideas for what a good contract is. Did you know, he once asked me to add a platter of bugs, and I’m not talking crustaceans from

the sea, but literal bugs to be present for anytime he was on site with a client."

Catra snorts out a laugh at that, Adora turns to her perplexed, "What? It's funny."

"Just think about it, Adora." Castaspella says, "Anyways, I'll send through this amended contract to you. And Catra, I know you're there, I'll have yours sent out in a few days. We'll need you to send through your licence and some other bits of information before we can offer you a contract too. Apparently, that's something important I have to check before I can just hire people. Absurd."

Chuckling, Catra shakes her head, "Let me know what you need and I can send it to you then."

"Great! Okay, I've got to get going. Melog is getting a little… restless…" Castaspella says before there's a sound of something breaking in the background, "So, I'll just have him dropped off to your building, Adora?"

That makes Catra laugh as she manages to say, "Just put him outside. He'll find his way back."

"No." The older woman simply says, "I'll drop him off once we catch him… Okay, gotta go! Bye!"

Before either of them can say anything, Castaspella has hung up and the sound of an email comes through on Adora's phone.

"Wow, that was really quick. Here." Adora holds her phone out to Catra, "Can you read through it?"

"Sure." Catra smiles as she takes the phone out of Adora's hand and opens up the email from Castaspella with the amended contract and starts to read through it.

"Well? What does it say?" Adora nudges her magicat after a few minutes of silence.

Catra continues to read and then hands the device back to Adora, a smile on her lips, “It says you don’t have to do the calorie thing anymore or submit your weight on a daily basis.”

“Seriously?” Adora skims through the contract before grinning and wraps her arms around Catra, bringing their lips together in an excited and giddy kiss, “This is… I can’t believe it!”

“Happy?”

Adora kisses Catra again reply, she can’t help smiling into it.

“Hey, let’s go celebrate.” Catra says as she rests her forehead on Adora’s, “Hunt’s going to make you the biggest sundae you’ve ever seen.”

“Stars.” Adora laughs.

“And Scorp is going to shout you shots until you can barely stand.” Catra adds with a smile.

“Can I invite my friends too?” Adora asks closing her eyes and leaning into Catra.

“You can invite anyone you want, princess.” Catra replies with another kiss to Adora’s lips, “More the merrier.”

“I can’t believe this.” Adora whispers, she can’t wipe the smile off her face.

“Believe it.” Catra chuckles, “Oh, there was one more thing on that contract though…”

“Hm?”

“You’re getting assigned a personal trainer and a meeting with a nutritionist slash dietitian quarterly.” Catra informs, “Guess you’re going to be getting buff, princess.”

That makes Adora laugh, “Well, we’ll just wait to see what your contract says. Maybe you’ll have to do all this with me too.”

“I don’t need to be buff to drive.” Catra replies grinning before she leans back against Adora’s car, “Besides, right now there’s nothing better than cars and calories.”

“And kisses. There better be kisses too.” Adora declares giggling and leaning back in for more of those kisses that Catra gladly gives.

Chapter End Notes

...and that's the end of this fic.
I hope you guys enjoyed it.
I'll be getting back to my other spop fics too, don't worry, I haven't forgotten them!

Thanks for reading, comments, kudos, subscribing and bookmarking!

End Notes

Thanks for reading!

I'm on tumblr: @masternoveller

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